

SATURDAY, AUGUST 8, 2026



# The Indian EXPRESS

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## Happening today

● **AAP WILL ROLL OUT** a nationwide campaign to interact with vehicle owners and gather feedback on issues arising from E20 ethanol-blended petrol.

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## THE BIG PICTURE

**AT WORK IN KASHMIR: BEING A MIGRANT WORKER IN THE VALLEY** [PAGE 19](#)

## GN SAIBABA EVENT

**No anticipatory bail for 2 TISS students over slogans to free Umar, Sharjeel**

Sadaf Modak  
Mumbai, August 7

OBSERVING THAT students are expected to respect the law of the land, a Mumbai sessions court Friday rejected the anticipatory bail pleas of two TISS students accused of raising slogans seeking the release of Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, who are facing trial under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), and of possessing downloaded books and other material that the prosecution said reflected Maoist ideology.

Seven others, who had also attended an October 2025 gathering to mark the death anniversary of former Delhi University professor G N Saibaba, were granted anticipatory bail. The pleas were filed in the same month.

The court held that while paying homage to Saibaba — he was acquitted in the case against him before his death — was not illegal, the allegations that the two students had raised slogans supporting Khalid and Imam, coupled with the material recovered from their electronic devices, weighed against grant of anticipatory bail.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## POLICE LOOK AT PAK SPY RING

**IAF officer arrested for sharing defence information, booked under Secrets Act**

Arrested two months ago, Wing Commander now in judicial custody

Sakshi Chand  
New Delhi, August 7

A WING Commander of the Indian Air Force (IAF) was arrested two months ago by Delhi Police for allegedly leaking sensitive defence-related information.

The officer has been booked under provisions of the Official Secrets Act and is currently in judicial custody, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Senior sources in the Delhi Police said the arrest pointed to a "larger espionage network aimed at collecting strategic military intelligence".

Claiming that the Wing Commander had fallen victim to a "honey trap" orchestrated by Pakistani intelligence of-

ficers, the sources said the arrested officer allegedly installed data-stealing software on a colleague's mobile phone to gain control of the device.

Sources said the Wing Commander was arrested on the night of May 31 after the IAF's intelligence wing shared specific information related to the case with Delhi Police.

"Initially, he was taken into police custody after his arrest. He was later sent to judicial custody in Tihar Jail. He has been booked under the provisions of the Official Secrets Act for sharing classified information and confidential documents related to national defence," the sources said.

The IAF spokesperson said, "He was under active surveillance and was handed over to the suitable law enforcement agencies."

The police probe into the case has so far revealed that the officer had been going through a difficult phase in his personal

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



A waterlogged road in Gurgaon as heavy rainfall lashed the National Capital Region, Friday. Gurgaon was among the worst-hit, receiving 67.5 mm until 5.30pm. Delhi received 59.2 mm. PTI REPORT, PAGE 4

**No cover over House gate, Speaker asks CPWD to consider a porch**

Damini Nath  
New Delhi, August 7

THREE YEARS after the new Parliament building was inaugurated, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla asked the Central Public Works Department (CPWD) this week to consider adding a porch over Makar Dwar, the entrance currently uncovered and used by the majority of MPs, according to sources aware of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



MPs at Makar Dwar of Parliament amid rainfall, Friday. ANI

## THE WORLD

**SAUDI, TURKEY, PAK SIGN KEY DEFENCE PACT**

[PAGE 14](#)



## GOVT'S DEEP-TECH FUND

**Checks in place, in next batch only one firm with member stake: Govt**

**Govt: No review of process needed, if 'strengthening' required, will address**

Amitabh Sinha  
New Delhi, August 7

UNDERLINING THAT its newly created fund to support deep tech companies had adequate safeguards to deal with conflict-of-interest situations, the government Friday said that in the second cohort of firms selected, there was just one of 13 in which a selection committee member had a stake.

The government was reacting to an investigative report

Govt deep-tech fund: Rs 2,192 cr cleared, 62% goes to firms linked to panel that chose them

15 of 22 firms chosen have links to seven members in selection panel. Members say they checked their interests, avoided it's public money, need guidelines, says MP who flagged issue.

Which firm got how much, what's the risk? Members say they checked their interests, avoided it's public money, need guidelines, says MP who flagged issue.

The Indian Express report published on August 7

by *The Indian Express* published Friday that over 62 per cent of the Rs 2,192-crore of soft

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Business as Usual  
By EP UNNNY



## EXPRESS special

**EV fleet, driver welfare fund: Maharashtra could tighten norms for food delivery apps**

Ishika Gupta  
Mumbai, August 7

FOOD DELIVERY and e-commerce platforms such as Swiggy, Zomato and Zepto could soon be brought under the ambit of Maharashtra's bike taxi norms, which would require them to maintain an electric vehicle fleet and contribute 2 per cent of the fare per ride to a driver welfare fund, *The Indian Express* has learnt. Currently, such platforms

## State's Bike-Taxi rules to be tweaked

**PLATFORMS LIKE** Swiggy, Zomato, Zepto brought under ambit of bike taxi norms

**SUCH PLATFORMS** will have to maintain EV-only bike fleets and provide insurance cover under the bike-taxi norms



**PLATFORMS MUST** obtain a unique license identification number from the state or Regional Transport Authority

**STATE TRANSPORT** Commissioner to develop portal for real-time monitoring of onboarded bike taxis

are governed by central laws, including the Consumer Protection Act, 2019; the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020; and the Code on Social Security, 2020. Maharashtra does not have a separate regulatory framework for these services, unlike its Aggregator Rules, 2026, which govern ride-hailing apps such as Ola, Uber and Rapido.

Now, the state's transport department headed by

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## NETFLIX CO-CEO: DON'T SEE THEATRES AS COMPETITION... WHAT WE COMPETE FOR IS SCREEN TIME

**'India has a great storytelling culture, but under screened... we can solve that'**

Trisha Mukherjee  
New Delhi, August 7

CONTRARY TO popular belief that streaming is in competition with theatres, Netflix co-CEO Ted Sarandos wants viewers to keep watching films on the big screen.

"We don't see it as a competition at all," Sarandos said Thursday at the Express Adda in New Delhi. "People on Netflix love movies, (they) love to go to movies and watch them at home. An individual watches an average of seven movies in a month and sees one or two in the theatre. We are not saying



one (medium) is better than the other. It is a rich, beautiful ecosystem and I want our viewers to go to the theatres because it



Netflix co-CEO Ted Sarandos at Express Adda in New Delhi, Thursday. RENUKA PURI

strengthens their relationship with movies. That's where we will benefit."

The Netflix co-CEO, who

was in conversation with Anant Goenka, Executive Director, Indian Express Group, said, "What we compete for is screen time. We want to become the first place you check for something great to watch and the last place you would want to cancel."

Considered one of the architects of the streaming revolution, Sarandos has played a pivotal role in transforming Netflix into one of the world's leading entertainment companies. Expanding into all areas of entertainment programming, he led the company's transition into original

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## PUNJAB ASSEMBLY

**Sukhbir-PM meet: Buzz of alliance in poll run-up**

**Voice of people that old alliance be revived, says Akali leader**

Raakhi Jagga & Jatin Anand  
Ludhiana, New Delhi, August 7



Shiromani Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal

## E. EXPLAINED

**Why BJP-SAD alliance works**

The BJP-SAD alliance was one of the longest-running political partnerships in Punjab. The two parties shared power in the state in 1997, 2007 and 2012, combining the SAD's strong rural and Sikh support base with the BJP's traditional urban support. With the footprint of the Akalis having shrunk in recent elections and BJP looking to make gains in the state, many leaders in both parties want a return of the alliance.

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RAIN SUBMERGES ARTERIAL ROADS, CHOKES TRAFFIC; YELLOW ALERT TODAY

# Delhi logs wettest first week for August in 15 years; rain pounds Gurgaon and Noida

Express News Service  
New Delhi, August 7

AS DELHI on Friday received its highest rainfall during the first seven days of August this year, the city also logged its wettest first week for the month since 2011, India Meteorological Department (IMD) records show. The pounding rain submerged arterial roads under up to four feet of water, leaving vehicles stranded, choking traffic and inundating residential colonies as the India Meteorological Department (IMD) issued a red alert for Delhi-NCR.

Over the last two decades, on an average, the Capital has been receiving around 42 mm of rainfall in the first week of August. With Friday's rain, however, the monthly total has soared to 127 mm. The driest August week since 2011, on the other hand, was recorded in 2015 when 3 mm of rainfall was logged in the first week of the month.

Gurgaon, meanwhile, remained among the worst-hit areas in the National Capital Region after receiving 67.5 mm of rainfall until 5.30 pm.

The city received "heavy rainfall" as per IMD, which according to it reflects rainfall recorded between 64.5 mm and 115.5 mm in 24 hours.

Near Noida in Gautam Buddha Nagar, Jewar and Dadri logged 40 mm and 37.5 mm of rainfall, respectively.

Several places in Delhi saw rainfall cross 100 mm, including Pushp Vihar (147.5 mm) and Chhatrapur (131 mm).

Other stations where heavy rainfall was reported included Ayanagar (87.4 mm), Palam (73.5 mm), Janakpuri (71.5 mm) and Safdarjung (59.2 mm) — the city's base station.

According to the IMD, multiple low pressure systems passing through Delhi, south-west Uttar Pradesh and neighbouring regions were observed, triggering the downpour.

The IMD has sounded a yellow alert for Saturday. The forecast issued in its bulletin read, "A spell of very light to light rain at many places with moderate rain at isolated places during early morning to noon. Another spell of very light to light rain at many places in the evening or night."

The relentless rain also brought down temperatures sharply. While the day temperature was recorded at around seven degrees below season's normal at 27.5 degrees Celsius, the night temperature was below normal by two notches at 25.6 degrees Celsius. As per the IMD, the feel-like temperature rose to 32 degrees Celsius as the humidity ranged between 97% and 100%.

Meanwhile, from the Mehrauli-Badarpur Road in South Delhi to Mahipalpur, Minto Road, ITO, Shakarpur and Chhatrapur, roads disappeared beneath rainwater as commuters remained trapped in traffic for hours, motorists abandoned flooded stretches and office-goers struggled to book cabs.

Some of the worst flooding was reported on the Mehrauli-Badarpur (MB) Road near Vayusena Bad (Air Force Station), where water accumulated up to three to four feet deep, reducing one of south Delhi's busiest corridors into what residents described as a river.

Traffic crawled for kilo-

## • Skywatch



**Forecast: August 8, 2026**  
Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain  
**MAX: 30-32**  
2.2°C below normal

**MIN: 22-24**  
2.9°C below normal

• **Sunrise: 5:47 AM (August 9)**  
• **Sunset: 7:07 PM (August 8)**

• **Moonrise: 1:33 AM (August 9)**  
• **Moonset: 3:19 PM (August 8)**

## • AQI Tracker



**Bawana**  
Moderate  
**AQI: 106**

**Anand Vihar**  
Moderate  
**AQI: 129**



**Shadipur**  
Good  
**AQI: 32**

**Aya Nagar**  
Good  
**AQI: 35**

● Good (0-50)  
● Satisfactory (51-100)  
● Moderate (101-200)  
● Poor (201-300)  
● Very Poor (301-400)  
● Severe (401-500)

metres between Khanpur and Okhla Mor, while adjoining stretches at Sangam Vihar, Deoli and Ambedkar Nagar also remained inundated.

Continuous rainfall led to severe waterlogging in several neighbourhoods, including areas around the Red Fort, Chhatrapur Farm, Mehram Nagar near Terminal 1 and Sainik Farms. At Mahipalpur T-Point, waterlogging affected traffic heading towards the airport, Gurgaon, Chhatrapur and Vasant Vihar, while commuters also reported long delays near the Pusa Road roundabout.

Officials said that PWD received 30 calls of waterlogging mainly from Mahipalpur, Chhatrapur and Greater Kailash 2. Similar complaints in the NDMC area were reported from Lodhi Road, RK Ashram Marg, Ponto Road Bridge, Rajiv Chowk Metro, Safdarjung Flyover, Lady Hardinge Medical College, Race Course Road and Sarojini Nagar.

Residents in Fatehpur Beri were seen using tarpaulins to traverse through the flooded areas. At 40 futa road in Shaheen Bagh, several two-wheelers and autorickshaws got stuck in flooded roads.

In Noida, Dadri road, Mahamaya Flyover and Botanical Garden Metro station area saw long queues of stranded vehicles.

Officials said several incidents of tree fall were reported from Delhi's Saket, Model Town, East of Kailash and Patel Nagar. Nine calls regarding house and wall collapse were reported mostly from Burari and Model Town. The MCD said it received calls of tree fall from Sarita Vihar, Sant Nagar and RML hospital. There were no reports of injuries or casualties, said sources.

Delhi's air quality index (AQI), meanwhile, remained in the 'Satisfactory' category, recording an AQI of 63. So far, the city has recorded 'Satisfactory' AQI this August.



# Delay in dewatering efforts, lapses by contractors blamed as parts of Gurgaon get flooded, yet again

## MCG chief reinstated barely 24 hours after he was transferred

Abhimanyu Hazarika  
Gurgaon, August 7

AS HEAVY rain lashed Gurgaon for the second day in a row on Friday, flooding in various parts of the Millennium City has laid bare a two-fold crisis — lapses by contractors in civic works along drains and arterial roads and delay in dewatering efforts, according to residents and officials. With downpour continuing through the day, the city's infrastructure yet again crumbled — residents and commuters were at the receiving end amid waterlogging and traffic snarls.

While Gurgaon continues to struggle to tackle the rain fury, the state government reappointed IAS officer Pradeep Dahiya as the Commissioner of the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) barely 24 hours



A flooded stretch in Gurgaon. RENUKA PURI

after transferring him out as Deputy Commissioner of Rohtak. His transfer order on Thursday came as the city reeled under persistent waterlogging. The government, however, had not named his successor.

On Friday, Dahiya, during a review with his deputy Uttam Singh, said, "Immediate action must be taken upon receiving reports of waterlogging at any location, and pumps, suction machines, and other necessary resources must be kept fully ready."

## Mayhem unfolds

The severity of the rain was felt across every corner of the city. An average rainfall of 60 mm was recorded, as per the district administration data. Sohna took the maximum brunt with 82 mm of rain, followed by Badshahpur at 74 mm and Wazirabad at 68.5 mm.

Across several parts, unfinished drainage work led to waterlogging on roads, causing massive inconvenience to locals. In the upscale Ardee City in Sector 52, rainwater drain pits were

left uncovered at a key stretch recently laid allegedly using substandard tiles, residents said. "Instead of being safely capped as mandated by the original tender specifications, these open pits were hidden beneath rising surface water due to rain, causing a major safety hazard," RWA member Chaitali Mandhotra said, pointing to a lack of oversight on part of private contractors.

The delay in deploying suction pumps and dewatering equipment further aggravated the situation, residents across other upscale areas claimed. Ahishek Sharma of C-2 Block at Palam Vihar said that waterlogged streets in his neighbourhood reminded him of annual monsoon mayhem.

On paper, the MCG has the largest workforce in the city among all the civic bodies in the city, alongside a heavy concentration of drain-clearing personnel and high-capacity pumps, a spokesperson said.

However, when heavy water accumulation hit master roads managed by the Gurugram Metropolitan Development

Authority (GMDA), the transition of these resources across jurisdictional lines lagged significantly, officials seeking anonymity claimed. "As MCG's rapid-response teams operate separately from GMDA's arterial network units, discrepancies in response times and deployment speed allowed rainwater to pool for hours on major transit corridors, a senior GMDA official claimed.

In areas near Golf Course Road, the master drains reached saturation due to the torrential rain, MCG Ward 22 counsellor Vikas Yadav said. "The recording machine at my ward office saw over 100 mm of rain today... It is disastrous. Still, all pumps worked efficiently in my ward through online complaints on social media indicating otherwise," he said.

Meanwhile, the GMDA acknowledged that choked drainage inlets are worsening flash floods in urban areas. GMDA CEO PC Meena has established 12 enforcement teams, bringing together junior engineers from enforcement and infrastructure divisions alongside municipal representatives.

## Why don't you shut it down: HC to govt on Jantar Mantar as protest venue

Sohini Ghosh  
New Delhi, August 7

ORALLY REMARKING that protests "should not happen in the city", the Delhi High Court on Friday asked the government why it was not considering shutting down Jantar Mantar as a venue to hold protests.

"Why don't you shut it down? (The city) cannot be put to ransom unnecessarily by demonstrations," Justice Amit Mahajan said while hearing a plea filed by the All India Dalit Christian Rights Protection Committee (AIDCRPC), seeking the Court's intervention in its pending application for permission to hold a peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar on August 10.

Senior advocate Sanjoy Ghose, who appeared for AIDCRPC, sought a direction to Delhi Police to grant permission for the protest.

The court ultimately disposed of the plea, directing the police to take a decision on AIDCRPC's application.

Addressing the government, Justice Mahajan said: "Why don't you shut it down? It should not be inside Delhi... According to me these things (protests) should not happen in the city but it is ultimately the government's call... Why should this happen in the city when the entire city goes into... Whether it's the ambulances or otherwise... Why should the city be put to ransom unnecessarily?"

AIDCRPC had sought permission for 75 people to gather at Jantar Mantar for three hours, to press the demand for including Dalit Christians in the Scheduled Castes framework — a category from which they remain excluded, despite a long-standing demand for a constitutional amendment to provide for their inclusion.

Alternatively, the group asked to be allotted another suitable venue or time slot within New Delhi.

## Will pay Rs 12 L to rape-murder victim's kin, hospitals tell SC

Express News Service  
New Delhi, August 7

TWO PRIVATE hospitals in Ghaziabad, accused of being negligent in providing timely treatment to a four-year-old girl, who was raped and subsequently died, volunteered to pay Rs 12 lakh compensation to her family during a hearing in the Supreme Court on Friday.

While one of the hospitals, a multi-specialty institution, would pay Rs 10 lakh, the other, with an Ayurveda practitioner, would pay Rs 2 lakh.

The institutions volunteered to pay after a three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, which is monitoring the case, said it would otherwise have to direct them to do so.

On April 24, the Supreme Court had directed the setting up of an SIT after the father accused local police of insensitivity. He also alleged that though the child was rushed to the two hospitals, they did not provide emergency medical care.

## • PREGNANT TEEN DROWNED BY FATHER, BROTHER-IN-LAW DRIVEN BY FEARS OF THE SOCIAL STIGMA, SAY POLICE

# The last photographs — staged by man to pass off daughter's murder as suicide

Alok Singh  
New Delhi, August 7

THE PHOTOGRAPHS looked almost ordinary — a father and daughter standing together in the waters of the Chambal river near Basoni in Agra, around 220 km away from Delhi.

They were anything but. Police said the images were taken moments before the 18-year-old woman, a resident of Delhi, was allegedly drowned by her father and brother-in-law on July 30, allegedly driven by fears of the social stigma they would face when people came to know that the woman,

unmarried, was pregnant. They hoped the photographs would help pass off her death as suicide. Instead, the photographs led to their arrest on August 2.

While the body of the victim, who the police said was around four months pregnant, is yet to be recovered, divers continue the search in the river.

The incident came to light when a neighbour of the family, suspicious of the father's account after he returned from Agra on July 31, made a PCR call, said DCP (South) Anant Mittal.

The middle child among three siblings, police said the

victim's mother died of cancer eight years ago. She lived with her father, a confectioner, in a 25-gaj house in South Delhi. Her elder sister lived in the same locality with her husband, who worked at a local sweet shop.

Police said the father and the son-in-law took the woman to their village in Agra on July 28 on the pretext of her undergoing an abortion. They stayed at a relative's house for two days before taking her to the Chambal river.

They first allegedly asked the woman to jump into the river. When she refused, they



Divers look for the body of the 18-year-old woman at the site of the incident. EXPRESS

pushed her into the water and drowned her before returning to Delhi, police said.

A source in the police said that before forcing her into the river, the father allegedly touched his daughter's feet. "The father then forcefully took her into the water and pushed her head under. After she drowned, he folded his hands and apologised for what he had done," the source added.

Police said photographs recovered from the son-in-law's phone show the father and daughter together in the water shortly before her death.

Mobile phone location data

of the three also corroborated that the victim and both the accused travelled together to Agra, they added.

The case unravelled after a neighbour became suspicious of the father's account on his return, police said.

"The father told the neighbours he had taken his daughter to Agra because she was suffering from depression. After returning, he claimed that she had died by suicide there and thus, he cremated her there," said an officer.

Police said the father initially tried to mislead investigators before breaking down

during questioning.

During the investigation, police found that the woman had befriended a boy, two years younger to her, through Instagram around eight months ago. The two later entered into a relationship and began meeting regularly. After she became pregnant, her father contacted the boy's family in an attempt to persuade them to agree to their marriage. However, the efforts were unsuccessful. That was when he decided to murder his daughter.

Police said they have questioned the boy and his family, who live in the same area.



# ‘CM’s turf’: Anandiben flags shortcomings at Gorakhpur university

Maulshree Seth  
Lucknow, August 7

IN A remark that has sparked a buzz in political circles a year before the Assembly polls in Uttar Pradesh, Governor Anandiben Patel has invoked Gorakhpur as the political and spiritual base of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath while flagging poor facilities at a local state university.

The Governor has pulled up the Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Gorakhpur University and the local administration over hostel infrastructure and student amenities. As Governor, Anandiben Patel is the chancellor of state universities in Uttar Pradesh.

Addressing the 45th convocation ceremony of the university on Thursday, the Governor said, “*Logon ko shayad bura lagega, lekin jo hamari kamiyan hain, woh to humein batani hi padegi. Aane wale teen mahine mein pooro karke dihaao. Aur yeh to Gorakhpur hai, jahan swayan hamare Mukhyamantri virajmaan hain. Wahan hi aisi kamiyan rahengi to kya hoga?*” (People may not like it, but we have to point out our shortcomings. Show me within the next three months that these deficiencies have been addressed. And this is Gorakhpur, the Chief Minister’s turf. If such shortcomings exist here, what will happen?)

The remarks carry political significance because they were made in Gorakhpur, which Adityanath represented in Parliament for five consecutive terms



UP Governor Anandiben Patel

before becoming the Chief Minister. Gorakhpur is also home to the Gorakhnath Math, of which Adityanath is the Mahant. Akhilesh Yadav, chief of Uttar Pradesh’s main opposition, has now latched to Patel’s remarks to take a swipe at alleged infighting within the BJP.

The Governor said the university has nine hostels — six for boys and three for girls — but noted that the boys’ hostels don’t have a mess facility. “Girls hostel mein mess chal rahi hai, boys hostel mein nahi chalti. Kyon, tiffin mein achha lagta hai?” (Girls’ hostels have mess facilities, but boys’ hostels don’t. Why? Is outside food better?)

Patel said she inspected the food served on campus during her stay, questioned the quality of cooking oil, and ordered testing of food samples. She said that while one set of samples had been sent for testing, she ensured collection of another set would be sent for testing in Lucknow. “Sometimes, samples get switched. This used to happen in Gujarat. I am not say-

ing this as a Governor. I am a mother. Our children should get proper food,” she said. The Governor said food delivery services to the campus may also become a route for drugs to enter hostels, saying she had received such inputs during her visit, and found evidence of narcotics use in universities across Uttar Pradesh.

“I have visited almost all state universities; only four remain. Narcotic substances have been found everywhere. I have photographs. Is this the Nasha Mukta Bharat we speak of? If students remain addicted, how will we build a developed India?” she asked. Patel highlighted several shortcomings on campus, including gaps in Wi-Fi connectivity and power supply and lack of hygiene in many hostels, and asked officials to ensure a turnaround within three months.

Vice-Chancellor Poonam Tandon told *The Indian Express* that the university had initiated action after the Governor’s directions. “Along with the district administration, we have started work on the issues raised by the Governor and would try to resolve most of them within a week,” she said. Tandon said students had earlier resisted attempts to set up mess services at boys’ hostels. They had argued that the estimated cost of around Rs 100 per day (about Rs 3,000 a month) would be unaffordable. The university is trying to find a solution, she said. Tandon said the nearly 75-year-old university is undergoing renovation with government funding.

## BJP leader held under SC/ST Act

Mumbai: Nandurbar police on Friday arrested BJP’s former North Maharashtra convenor Vijay Choudhary in connection with an audio clip allegedly containing objectionable remarks against former BJP MP Heena Gavit and other senior political leaders. An FIR was registered on the complaint of Gavit’s cousin under provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and other relevant sections relating to the alleged remarks. ENS

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**Sd/-**  
**Jt. General Manager (HR)**

## ICAR-National Research Centre for Grapes Manjiri Farm, P B, No 3, Solapur Rd, Pune, Maharashtra 412308 Invitation for Bids

Tender Publication Date: 04 August 2026  
Loan No. and Title: Loan 4411-IND/ Building India's Clean Plant Program  
Contract No. and Title: CPC1-CW01/ Design and Build containment facility for grapes – CPC 1, Pune  
Tender ID: 2026\_DAREA\_920526\_1  
Deadline for Submission of Bids: 16 September 2026

- The Government of India has received financing from the Asian Development Bank (ADB) toward the cost of Building India's Clean Plant Program. Part of this ?nancing will be used for payments under the Contract named above. Bidding is open to Bidders from eligible source countries of ADB.
- The Principal Scientist (Plant Pathology), ICAR- National Research Centre for Grapes, Pune ("the Employer") invites sealed bids from eligible Bidders for the construction and completion of Design and Build containment facility for grapes – CPC 1, Pune including comprehensive Operation and Maintenance for a period of five (5) years from date of handover ("the Works").
- Open competitive bidding will be conducted in accordance with ADB's Single-Stage: Two-Envelope bidding procedure and is open to all Bidders from eligible countries as described in the Bidding Document.
- Only eligible Bidders with the following key qualifications defined in the Bidding Document may participate in this bidding:
  - Minimum average annual turnover of **INR 507 million (USD 5.33M)** within the last three (3) years;
  - Participation as a contractor, JV partner, or Subcontractor in **at least one (1) contract > INR 304 million (USD 3.2M), OR at least two (2) contracts each > INR 190 million (USD 2.0M),**
  - satisfactorily completed within the last five (5) years;
  - Participation in at least one (1) contract for design and construction of a controlled-environment plant containment/quarantine facility = 400 sqm, operational within the last ten (10) years. For the complete eligibility and qualification requirements, Bidders should refer to the Bidding Document.
- To obtain further information and inspect the bidding documents, Bidders should contact:  
**The Principal Scientist (Plant Pathology)**  
ICAR- National Research Centre For Grapes,  
PB. No. 3, P.O. Manjari Farm, Solapur Road, Pune- 412307, Maharashtra, India  
Telephone 020 2695 6000  
Web: <https://nrcgrapes.icar.gov.in/>  
Email: [suijoyta@gmail.com](mailto:suijoyta@gmail.com)
- To purchase the Bidding Document in English, eligible Bidders should
  - register and download the bidding documents from Employer's procurement portal <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>
  - The Employer shall not be held liable for any information not received by the Bidder, and it is the Bidder's responsibility to regularly check the website for the latest information related to this invitation for bids.
  - The Bidding Documents are available for free download from the Employer's e-procurement portal. No fee is payable.
- Deliver your bid
  - Bidders shall submit their Bids electronically only through the public procurement website <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app> on or before the deadline: Date: 16 September 2026 Time: 11:00 hours (IST)
  - together with a Bid Security as described in the Bidding Document

Technical Bids will be opened publicly online on: Date: 16 September 2026, Time: 11:15 hours (IST), via the e-procurement portal <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app> and at: ICAR-National Research Centre for Grapes, PB. No. 3, P.O. Manjari Farm, Solapur Road, Pune – 412307. Price Bids will be opened at a date and time to be notified to qualifying bidders following Technical Bid evaluation.

**8. This Invitation for Bid is also published on the following websites**  
<https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>  
<https://nhb.gov.in/>  
<https://www.nrcgrapes.in/>  
<https://www.adb.org/projects/57041-001/main>

**s/d**  
**Administrative Officer**

## Doctor assault case: Court grants bail to Sena corporator

Omkar Gokhale  
Mumbai, August 7

THE BOMBAY High Court on Friday granted the bail of Shiv Sena Corporator Ramesh Sukrya Mhatre and three other accused, booked for the July 6 assault on three municipal doctors, on the strict condition that they not enter Maharashtra until the trial commences.

"If the elected representative is accused of assaulting his own voters, such a situation

is bound to dent the fabric of democracy in this country and erode public confidence," the HC noted in its order.

The HC added that after the investigation is completed and chargesheet is filed, "the trial commences... accused will be permitted to enter and reside in Maharashtra, but will continue to maintain distance from the witnesses and victim doctors and... report to Vishunagar Police station... once a week."

## PUBLIC NOTICE

State Environment Impact Assessment Authority, Haryana has accorded environment clearance for the Proposed Expansion cum Modification of Group Housing planned at Village: Kherki Daula & Sihi, Sector-83, Gurugram, Haryana by M/s A&D Estates Pvt Ltd through EC Identification No. EC26B3813HR 5412066N on dated: 05.08.2026

The copy of Clearance Letter is available on the website of Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, - <https://parivesh.nic.in/>

**Dated: 08.08.2026**

M/s A&D Estates Pvt. Ltd.  
Office: SS House, Plot No. 77, Sector-44, Gurugram, Haryana-120033

**GOVT. OF BIHAR**  
**BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD**  
**I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.**  
**Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in**

**UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING (UGMAC)-2026** for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical / Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar  
**Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/02 Dated 07.08.2026**

**NOTICE for Online Application & Choice Filling**  
Online Applications are invited from qualified, eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 candidates for appearing in the Under Graduate Medical Admission Counselling (UGMAC)-2026 in order to select candidates for admission to the first year UG Medical / Dental Courses (MBBS / BDS) in Government / Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar state and B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. Courses in Govt. Veterinary / Fisheries Colleges of Bihar based on the Merit-list / Rank of UGMAC-2026 prepared on the basis of merit list of NEET(UG)-2026 conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA).  
2. It is mandatory to upload proper DQ / NRI / Minority certificate issued by proper authority and incase of Ward quota seat, Ward quota certificate issued by the Registrar of Bihar Animal Science University, if required.  
3. The online Registration & submission of Application Form-cum-Choice Filling (1st & 2nd round) will start from **10.08.2026**.  
4. Eligibility criteria for counselling / admission Fee payment procedure, instructions and other details for filling up online applications form-cum-choice filling are available in the prospectus of UGMAC-2026 and the related Advertisement No.-BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/01 dated 07.08.2026, which can be seen / downloaded from the Board's website: [bceceboard.bihar.gov.in](http://bceceboard.bihar.gov.in).  
**Controller of Examination**

**SANJAY GANDHI POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES**  
Raebareilly Road, Lucknow-226014 (U.P.)  
EPBX No.: 0522-2494000, 2495000, 2496000

**RECRUITMENT NOTICE**  
Applications are invited in offline mode for the post of Specialist Medical Officer Grade- II in the General Hospital of the Institute, under a Special Recruitment Drive to fill backlog vacancies reserved for domiciled candidates of Uttar Pradesh.

| Name of post                     | No. of Post & Speciality         | Level & Pay Matrix                                  | Mode of Recruitment, qualification & other eligibility criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Re-Mark                   |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Specialist Medical Officer Gr-II | SC-01 General Medicine (Backlog) | Level-11 Pay Matrix- ₹67700- ₹208700 As per 7th CPC | 1. A recognized medical qualification included in the First or Second Schedule or Part II of the Third Schedule (other than licentiate qualifications) to the Indian Medical Council Act. 1956 (Now National Medical Commission Act- 2019). Holders of educational qualification in Part II of the Third Schedule should also fulfill the conditions stipulated in sub- section (3) of section (13) of the Indian Medical Council Act. 1956 (Now National Medical Commission Act- 2019).<br>2. Postgraduate Degree or diploma in the concerned specialty or super specialty mentioned in Section-A or Section-B in Schedule-VI.<br>3. Three years experience in concerned specialty after obtaining the postgraduate diploma. | Upper age limit: 50 Years |

- The detailed advertisement in respect of qualification, experience, age, fees and other terms & conditions can be seen in the Institute's website [www.spggims.org.in](http://www.spggims.org.in).
- The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any or all applications or cancel or withdraw the vacancy / vacancies without assigning any reason.

**Advt. No. I/37/Rectt/2026-27**  
**DIRECTOR**

**क्षेत्रीय भविष्य निधि कार्यालय, कानपुर**  
श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार

**गैर-आवृत पीएफ ट्रस्टों के लिए राहत का सुनहरा अवसर एमनेस्ती स्कीम - 2026**

श्रम और रोजगार मंत्रालय के अंतर्गत कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन (ईपीएफओ) ने एमनेस्ती स्कीम, 2026 प्रारंभ की है। इस योजना के तहत आयकर अधिनियम, 1961 के अंतर्गत मान्यता प्राप्त फूट प्राप्त भविष्य निधि (पीएफ) ट्रस्ट संचालित करने वाले प्रतिष्ठानों को अपने अनुपालन की स्थिति नियमित करने का एक बार का अवसर प्रदान किया गया है। नियोजकों, हितधारकों और आम जनता को इस योजना पर ध्यान देने की सलाह दी जाती है, जो छट महीने की अवधि के लिए खुली रहेगी।

वित्त अधिनियम, 2026 ने मान्यता प्राप्त भविष्य निधियों को नियमित करने वाले आयकर दायें को कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि एवं विविध प्रावधान अधिनियम, 1952 के वैधानिक एवं प्रशासनिक प्रावधानों के अनुरूप कर दिया है। आयकर अधिनियम, 2025 के अंतर्गत मान्यता केवल उन्हीं भविष्य निधियों को प्राप्त होगी जिन्होंने कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि एवं विविध प्रावधान अधिनियम, 1952 की धारा 17 के अंतर्गत फूट प्राप्त की है। ऐसे प्रतिष्ठानों को अधिनियम की धारा 17 और सामाजिक सुरक्षा संहिता, 2020 की धारा 143 के अंतर्गत पूर्ववर्ती प्रभाव से एमनेस्ती का लाभ प्रदान किया जाएगा।

**एमनेस्ती स्कीम का आवेदन**

यह योजना उन प्रतिष्ठानों पर लागू होती है जो आयकर अधिनियम, 1961 के तहत मान्यता प्राप्त भविष्य निधि ट्रस्ट का संचालन कर रहे हैं, लेकिन निम्ने पास संघीय सरकार - केन्द्र सरकार या राज्य सरकार, जैसा भी मामला हो - से औपचारिक फूट अधिवृत्त नहीं है।

**योजना की वैधता**

अवधि : यह योजना अधिवृत्त की तिथि से छह (6) महीने की अवधि के लिए वैध है।  
  
योजना की अधिवृत्त 29 जून, 2026 को जारी की गई थी।

**पात्र प्रतिष्ठान**

- **श्रेणी-I :** ये प्रतिष्ठान जो पूर्ववर्ती ट्रस्ट नियमितिकरण की मांग कर रहे हैं और जिन्होंने पहले ही गैर-फूट प्राप्त प्रतिष्ठान के रूप में अनुपालन शुरू कर दिया है या जो गैर-फूट प्राप्त प्रतिष्ठान के रूप में मानी अनुपालन का विकल्प चुन रहे हैं।
- **श्रेणी-II :** ये प्रतिष्ठान जो पूर्ववर्ती ट्रस्ट नियमितिकरण की मांग कर रहे हैं और सामाजिक सुरक्षा संहिता, 2020 के तहत फूट प्राप्त प्रतिष्ठानों के रूप में काम करना जारी रखना चाहते हैं।

**प्रमुख लाभ और प्रदान की गई छूट**

- पूर्ववर्ती नियमितिकरण ट्रस्ट की रूपरेखा से लेकर निर्धारित बट-ऑफ तिथि तक फूट की स्थिति और ट्रस्ट की मान्यता प्रदान की जाएगी।
- सामाजिक सुरक्षा संहिता, 2020 के तहत आवश्यकताओं में फूट के न्यूनतम कर्मचारी संख्या और कोष के आधार संबंधी नियमों में फूट दी गई है।  
3 वर्ष पूर्व अनुपालन नियम को संतुष्ट माना जाता है।
- कानूनी कार्यवाही की समाप्ति के बाद, ट्रस्टों और व्याज के लिए संहिता अद्यतन बचत से लिए जाने और व्याज कर दिए जाएंगे, बचत संदर्भ खातों में वैधानिक दायें के बचत या उसके बेटेल व्याज और अंशदान प्राप्त हुए हों। वृद्धों के जीवन अंशदान प्राप्त से ही अंशदान माने जाएंगे।

**नियोजकों के अनिवार्य दायित्व**

- आवेदन  
• चयन प्रक्रिया केवल सरकार को सौंपता है और औपचारिक आवेदन प्रस्तुत कीने।  
• आवेदन संचालित करीब कार्यालय के ईमेल के माध्यम से भेज जा सकता है।  
• योजना का सच अपने की जगह जमा करने पर भविष्य निधि पर [n.a.sanjanagandhi@epfoida.gov.in](mailto:n.a.sanjanagandhi@epfoida.gov.in) पर ईमेल किया जा सकता है।
- लेखापरीक्षा अनुपालन  
• वित्तीय खातों की लेखापरीक्षा पर्यटन अकाउंटिंग द्वारा की जायेगी।  
• ईपीएफ अकाउंटिंग द्वारा वित्तीय विवरण अनुपालन आवश्यकताओं की तिथि के 3 महीने के भीतर पूर्ण की जानेगी।

**मार्गदर्शन और सहायता**

इस एमनेस्ती स्कीम के संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए, राज्य सम्पर्क अधिकारी GSR 525(E) दिनांक 29.06.2026 द्वारा जारी कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि, 2026 के अनुपालन के भाग C का संदर्भ लिया जा सकता है। इसके अतिरिक्त, परिसर, व्याज प्रक्रिया आदि में उन्मुखित विस्तृत प्रक्रिया के लिए ईपीएफओ की वेबसाइट का भी संदर्भ लिया जा सकता है।

क्या: ईपीएफओ, क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, कानपुर  
कार्यलय: कानपुर - 208005

संपर्क (सर्वप्रकार): 8004383866  
कार्यलय: कानपुर (BKA): 011-2315644

वेबसाइट: [www.epfindia.gov.in](http://www.epfindia.gov.in)

ईमेल: [kanpur@epfindia.gov.in](mailto:kanpur@epfindia.gov.in)

पत्रांक : 234 /क.प्र.सि./क्षे.का./कानपुर/प्रश्न.- 011

दिनांक: 07.08.2026

**INDIAN AUDIT & ACCOUNTS DEPARTMENT**  
Office of The Principal Accountant General (Audit-II) M.P. Bhopal  
53, Arera Hills, Narmadapuram Road, Bhopal-462011  
Phone : 0755-2553676, Fax: 0755-2553044,  
E-mail : [agaumadhyapradesh2@cag.gov.in](mailto:agaumadhyapradesh2@cag.gov.in)

**NOTICE**

"A Charge Sheet dated : 24.02.2026 approved by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India and Disciplinary Authority had been issued to Shri Dhiraj Kumar on 26.02.2026. The attempt to deliver the Charge Sheet through Special Messenger at the residential address of Shri Dhiraj Kumar in Agra was made on 13.03.2026 but Shri Dhiraj Kumar refused to accept the Charge Sheet. The Charge Sheet was sent to home town residential address at Agra of Shri Dhiraj Kumar through Speed Post on 18.03.2026 but the same was returned on 27.03.2026 with remarks "Addressee left without instructions ". The Charge Sheet was also sent through email on 19.03.2026 but no response was received. Another attempt to deliver the Charge Sheet through Special Messenger at the residential address of Shri Dhiraj Kumar in Agra was made on 27.04.2026 but the brother of Shri Dhiraj Kumar denied to take the Charge Sheet. Now, Shri Dhiraj Kumar is informed to collect the Charge Sheet from the **Deputy Accountant General (Admn.), Office of the Principal Accountant General (Audit II), Madhya Pradesh, 53, Arera Hills, Narmadapuram Road, Bhopal - 462011 within 10 days of this Notice.**"  
M.P. Madhyam/127411/2026 DEPUTY ACCOUNTANT GENERAL/ADMIN.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

CAUTION AGAINST FORGED AND FABRICATED DOCUMENTS

- M3M India Private Limited hereby informs the public that a set of forged and fabricated documents, manufactured so as to appear to be internal correspondence of the Company and of its legal advisors, has been put into circulation by unknown persons.
- The said documents are wholly false, forged and fabricated. They have not emanated from the Company, from any of its directors, officers or employees, or from any of its legal advisors. Verification of the Company's systems and records establishes that no communication of the description in circulation was ever composed, sent or received, and that no such communication exists on any record of the Company. The professional identity of a Senior Advocate has also been misused in the fabrication, and he has confirmed that the document attributed to him is not his and that its contents represent no advice ever rendered by him.
- The Company is constrained to state that this is not an isolated act of mischief. It bears every mark of a deliberate, coordinated and criminal enterprise. The fabricated material has been manufactured with evident knowledge of proceedings pending before courts and tribunals, it has been timed to coincide with imminent hearings in those proceedings, and it has been delivered anonymously and in hard copy so as to leave no trail. The Company has reason to believe, and has placed its apprehensions on record before the investigating authorities, that the fabrication is the work of persons having a vested interest in litigation pending against the Company, acting in concert with others, and that its object is to malign the Company, to prejudice it before courts, regulators, lenders and the public, and to coerce it in matters presently sub judice.
- The Company will not be coerced by fabricated material, by anonymous circulation, or by pressure of this description. It has met, and will continue to meet, every proceeding to which it is a party on the merits and on the record, before the appropriate forum.
- A complaint has been lodged with the Commissioner of Police, Gurugram, with copies to the Director General of Police, Haryana and to the cyber crime authorities, seeking registration of a First Information Report and a full investigation into the fabrication, into its circulation, and into the identity of every person concerned in it, including offences of forgery, criminal conspiracy, and offences under the Information Technology Act, 2000.
- The public, the press, and all persons and institutions dealing with the Company are cautioned not to rely upon, act upon, reproduce, republish, transmit, forward or circulate any such material. Any person who makes, procures, possesses, circulates, publishes or uses such material, knowing or having reason to believe it to be forged, commits a cognizable offence and will be proceeded against to the fullest extent of the law. The Company will pursue every remedy available to it, criminal and civil, including proceedings for forgery, for criminal conspiracy and for defamation, and claims in damages, against every person concerned, whether as author, procurer, conspirator, distributor or publisher.
- Any person who has received, been shown, or been offered material of this description, or who has information regarding its source, is requested to inform the Company immediately at Email id- [info@m3mindia.com](mailto:info@m3mindia.com) or +91 9810237621. All such information will be treated in strict confidence and will be forwarded to the investigating authority.
- This notice is issued out of abundant caution, in the interest of the Company's allottees, lenders, investors, business associates and the public at large, and without prejudice to any of the Company's rights and remedies, all of which are expressly reserved.

For M3M India Private Limited

Authorised Signatory

Date: 8th August 2026

Place: Gurugram

**SML MAHINDRA LIMITED**  
(Formerly SML ISUZU Limited)  
CIN: L50101PB1983PLC005516 | **Regd. Office & Works:** Village Ason, Distt. Shahid Bhagat Singh Nagar (Nowanshah) Punjab -144 533;  
**Phone:** 01881- 270155; **Corporate Office:** 1st Floor, 77 Tech Park, C-119, Industrial Area, Phase 7, Sector 73, Mohali, SAS Nagar, Punjab-160055  
**Phone:** 0172- 2647700-02: 0172-4155901  
**Email:** [investors@smilmahindra.com](mailto:investors@smilmahindra.com) | **Website:** <https://smilmahindra.com/>

**POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE**  
NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to the provisions of Section 108, Section 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 (the "Act") read with the Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (the "Rules"), including any statutory amendment(s), modification(s), variation(s) or re-enhancement(s) thereto, for the time being in force and in accordance with the guidelines prescribed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") for holding general meetings/conducting the process of postal ballot through remote e-voting vide various circulars issued in this regard, the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations") and other applicable laws and regulations, if any, the resolutions appended below are proposed to be passed by the Members of the Company, by way of postal ballot through remote e-voting by electronic means only:

| Item No. | Agenda Items                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.       | To approve Material Related Party Transaction in connection with the acquisition of the Truck and Bus Division of Mahindra & Mahindra Limited on a slump sale basis |
| 2.       | To approve Material Related Party Transactions with Mahindra & Mahindra Limited                                                                                     |

In Compliance with the MCA Circulars, the Company has completed the dispatch of the Postal Ballot Notice, by electronic means only, today i.e. on Friday, 7th August, 2026 to those Shareholders of the Company whose names appeared in the Register of Shareholders/List of Beneficial Owner as maintained by the Company/ Depositories, respectively as at close of business hours on **Friday, 31st July, 2026** (the Cut-off date) and whose e-mail address are registered with the Company/Depositories. The Postal Ballot Notice is available on the website of the Company i.e. at <https://smilmahindra.com/> and on the websites of stock exchanges viz. BSE and NSE at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) respectively and on the website of NSDL at [www.evoting.nsdl.com](http://www.evoting.nsdl.com)

Members/ whose names appeared on the Register of Shareholders/List of Beneficial Owners as on the Cut-off date are entitled to vote on the resolutions as set forth in the Postal Ballot notice. The voting rights of the Members shall be reckoned in proportion to the paid-up equity shares held by them as on the Cut-off date. A person who is not a Member as on the cut-off date shall treat the Postal Ballot Notice for information purpose only.

In compliance with the MCA circulars, the Company has provided the remote e-voting facility to its Shareholders, to enable them to cast their votes electronically instead of submitting the physical Postal Ballot form. The communication of the assent or dissent of the Shareholders would take place only through the remote e-voting system. For this purpose, the Company has taken the services of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) for facilitating remote e-voting to enable the Shareholders to cast their vote electronically only.

The detailed procedure and instructions for remote e-voting are enumerated in the **Postal Ballot Notice**. Remote e-voting shall **commence on Saturday, 8th August, 2026 at 9.00 A.M (IST), and shall end on Sunday, 6th September, 2026 at 5.00 P.M (IST)**. The remote e-voting facility will be disabled for voting by NSDL upon expiry of the aforesaid voting period.

Mr. Kanwaljit Singh, a Practicing Company Secretary, and failing him Mr. Ajay K. Arora, Practicing Company Secretary, has been appointed as the scrutineer for conducting the Postal Ballot in a fair and transparent manner. The results of the Postal Ballot, together with the Scrutinizer's report, will be announced within two working days from the conclusion of the e-voting period and will also be simultaneously displayed on the notice board of the Company at its Registered Office and Corporate Office. The results will also be uploaded on the website of the Company, website of NSDL and will also be intimated to NSE and BSE.

In case of queries, if any, connected with voting by electronic means, you may contact Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Deputy Vice President, NSDL, at [evoting@nsdl.com](mailto:evoting@nsdl.com) or call on toll free nos. 022-4886 7000. You may also refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for shareholders e-voting user manual for shareholder available at the Help/FAQ's section of [www.evoting.nsdl.com](http://www.evoting.nsdl.com).

In case of queries related to Postal Ballot Notice or in case any Shareholder whose name appears in the Register of Shareholders/List of Beneficial owners as on the cut-off date, has not received the Postal Ballot Notice, he/ she may write to [Investors@smilmahindra.com](mailto:Investors@smilmahindra.com).

Place: Mohali, Punjab  
Date: 7th August, 2026

For SML MAHINDRA LIMITED  
PARVESH MADAN  
Company Secretary | ACS-31266

epaper.indianexpress.com





**Asad Rehman**  
New Delhi, August 7

ANTICIPATING THE presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah in the House and the likely introduction of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 on August 10, the Opposition Friday took the first step to ensure that all its members are present and the numerical strength of the bloc can be on show.

While the Congress issued a three-line whip Friday afternoon directing all its MPs to be present in Lok Sabha on August 10, 11, 12, other Opposition parties are likely to follow suit. The Monsoon Session is scheduled to conclude on August 13, and Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju has said that so far there has been no proposal to extend the session.

On Thursday, Mizoram CM Lalduhoma met Shah and said the Home Minister has indicated the Bill would be taken up in LS on August 12 and had assured him it would carry no retrospective provision. "The Home Minister assured me the retrospective clause will not be there," he had told *The Indian Express*.

During a meeting at Rajya Sabha LoP Mallikarjun Kharge's office Friday morning, the Congress leadership advised its allies to make sure that MPs of all parties are present in the House from Monday onwards,



Opposition MPs protest at Makar Dwar of Parliament over July 20 police action on protesters and alleged Ram temple donation theft on Friday. ANI

said sources.

"We are anticipating that Amit Shah might make an appearance when the FCRA Bill is taken up for discussion since it concerns the Home Ministry. And we would want all MPs to be present in the House when Shah comes," said a source present at the meeting on Friday.

The Opposition, since the beginning of the Monsoon Session, has been demanding that Shah make a statement on the police action on protesters during the July 20 march to Par-

liament, leading to disruptions and a logjam. On Thursday, Rajya Sabha Chairman and Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan told Rijiju to "echo the sentiments of the Opposition" to Shah and "consider the request" for his presence in the House.

Congress whip in Lok Sabha, Manickam Tagore, told *The Indian Express*: "We are prepared for the delimitation and FCRA Bills next week. We know Amit Shah has been missing for 12 days from the House. Now they will try to di-

vert the narrative from the students' protests in the country."

A senior Samajwadi Party MP said the party is sure to back the collective agenda of the Opposition. "We have stood with the Opposition, and we will continue to do so. If needed, we will issue a whip. But it might not be needed as all our MPs are present in the House anyway," said the MP. "We still don't know if Amit Shah will come to the House for FCRA Bill because the government may send MoS (Home) Nityanand

Rai for the discussion on the Bill."

The FCRA Bill has become contentious with Christian organisations raising concerns over a provision in the Bill that they say gives a government-designated authority retrospective powers over assets of organisations whose FCRA registration has lapsed.

A senior TMC MP told *The Indian Express* that the party has conveyed to all its MPs to be present in the House from Monday. "Some parties issue a formal whip, some do it informally. All Opposition MPs have been told to be in Parliament starting Monday," said the MP.

The FCRA Bill is politically sensitive for the BJP, as many churches and Christian institutions have been built using foreign contributions, regulated under the FCRA. With the party seeking to expand its footprint among Christians, particularly in Kerala, it is keen to address these concerns.

The government had on Wednesday signalled that the FCRA Bill would not have any penalising retrospective provision.

Sources in the Opposition said that the parties will likely take part in the discussion on the Bill but will oppose it and try to corner the government over its repeated demand that Shah give a statement in the House on the alleged excesses against protesters on July 20.

## LS PASSES MSME BILL BY VOICE VOTE

# Opp cannot dictate which minister will come to House and respond, says Rijiju

**Express News Service**  
New Delhi, August 7

AMID Opposition din over demand for Union Home Minister Amit Shah's response regarding July 20 police action on protesters, both Houses on Friday were adjourned until Monday.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju addressed both Houses, asserting that the Opposition cannot dictate which minister will come to the House and respond. He said that Shah comes to Parliament every day and stays until late night.

Shah is a man whose name "sends shivers down the spine of extremists and terrorists", he said in Lok Sabha amid thumping of desks by members of the treasury benches.

According to the procedure, the minister who has listed business has to come to the House. "You cannot dictate which minister will come to the House and who will respond. That is decided by the government and the Chair," Rijiju said, asking the Opposition members to stop disrupting the proceedings.

During the Zero Hour, which went on for nearly 16 minutes, the LS passed the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (MSME) (Amendment) Bill, 2026, without debate.

Speaking to reporters in the Parliament House complex, Rijiju said the House continues to function despite repeated



Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju in Rajya Sabha on Friday. ANI

disruptions by the Opposition. "The House has functioned, and Bills have been passed. Only discussions have been fewer because of disruptions," he said.

The minister clarified that there is no question of a special session while Parliament is already in session.

In the Rajya Sabha, Chairperson C P Radhakrishnan said the LoP will be given opportunity to speak only if he had something new to add. Amid the commotion, Mallikarjun Kharge repeated the demand for Home Minister's presence in the House.

To this, Rijiju said Shah is always in Parliament during the session, but Opposition cannot dictate which minister comes to the House. He added that the Opposition comes to the House only to raise slogans, disrupt business and go away. WITH PTI

## Data Power

A POWERPOINT presentation at the NDA Parliamentary Party meeting earlier this week became the main talking point among MPs of the ruling alliance. Insiders said Union Minister Mansukh Mandaviya's data-backed presentation on employment generation and transformation in sports over the past 12 years caught many MPs by surprise. Sources said the presentation "armed MPs with facts and figures to counter the Opposition's narrative", triggering animated discussions after the meeting ended. It also underlined the BJP's increasing reliance on data-driven communication, even within the alliance it helms.

## Mantra of Silence

DAYS AFTER he caught reporters off-guard with his "maun vrat (vow of silence)", BJP MP Ravi Kishan handed a similar surprise to media-persons at Parliament on Friday. When reporters approached the Gorakhpur MP for comments on the ongoing logjam in the House, he initially chose to stay silent. On being teased about whether his "maun vrat" would continue until the end of the holy month of Shravan, the MP chanted "Har har Mahadev" and walked away with a smile, leaving the reporters speechless.

## Curtains on Bofors cases: SC dismisses last pending appeal

NEW DELHI: Drawing curtains on the Bofors scam cases, the Supreme Court has dismissed the only pending appeal challenging the May 31, 2004, Delhi HC judgment discharging the Hinduja brothers and Swedish arms manufacturer AB Bofors.

A bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran Thursday dismissed the plea by advocate Ajay K Agrawal on September 19, 2005. "All proceedings were quashed. What is this? How many years have passed?" the bench asked. This comes 7 years after a three-judge bench presided by then CJI Ranjan Gogoi had on November 2, 2018, disposed of the plea by CBI. ENS

## EXPRESS special

# House panel calls for new satellite to monitor forest fires in Himalayan region

**Nikhil Ghanekar**  
New Delhi, August 7

FLAGGING GAPS in monitoring, regulation, and management of forest fires, a parliamentary standing committee has made a slew of prescriptions, including prioritising the launch of a geostationary satellite for round-the-clock monitoring. The recommendations were made in a new report — "Forest fires in the Himalayan Region, its adverse effects and mitigation measures" — tabled in both Houses of Parliament on Friday.

The House panel on Science and Technology, Environment, Forest and Climate Change headed by BJP MP Medha Kulkarni also recommended a region-specific study to establish if there is any empirical link between climate change and forest fire frequency, including examination of temperature trends, precipitation, and dry spells. Pointing out gaps, the panel also called for a time-bound decision on setting up at least two regional response centres of the Real Creator IAS Edition [https://t.me/+2RvD\\_RG9fmJmZg1](https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9fmJmZg1)

National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), dedicated to tackling forest fires in the Himalayan region.

The panel called for a 'National pine-needle utilisation policy' to identify zones and provide fiscal and market-access incentives for pine needle collection.

The panel examined the causes, impacts, monitoring, and mitigation of forest fires in states across Western and Eastern Himalaya, which make up 17 per cent of India's landmass but account for 57 per cent of India's forest fire incidents.

The panel's recommendations on prioritising a dedicated satellite were made after it noted that the country's active fire monitoring remains dependent on foreign, polar-orbiting satellites, which observe the country only eight times a day and no data is available for a large duration. The Centre itself characterised this as a "critical observational gap in the diurnal fire monitoring cycle". The Forest Survey of India currently generates satellite-based forest fire alerts using the AQUA and Suomi-NPP foreign satellites.

## E. EXPLAINED

### Contrasting dynamics

Based on submissions, the House committee noted that the fires in Western Himalaya are primarily driven by extreme pre-monsoon heat, pine-needle fuel loads and proximity-based human ignition, whereas, there is a complex interplay of atmospheric dryness and cultivation-linked burning practices in Eastern Himalaya.

The committee said, "...Even after so many years of using satellite technology and despite India being a leader in the space sector, the country is still relying on foreign satellites for monitoring of forest fires... the commit-

tee, therefore, urges the Department of Space to prioritise the launch of a geostationary satellite capable of round-the-clock monitoring of forest fires."

tee, therefore, urges the Department of Space to prioritise the launch of a geostationary satellite capable of round-the-clock monitoring of forest fires."

Across 13 states in the Himalayan region, Uttarakhand recorded the highest fire incidents between 2019-20 and 2023-24 based on finer resolution data. Manipur, Himachal Pradesh, J&K, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya and Mizoram also recorded a high number of fire incidents, the report said.

The committee also noted that of the alerts that the Uttarakhand government received from the Forest Survey of India, only 12.5 per cent corresponded to verified fires. A high proportion of false positives carries the real risk of alert fatigue among the staff, who may over time come to treat alerts as routine rather than actionable, the committee noted.

On regulation, the panel questioned the government on whether a new central law such as 'National Forest Fire Man-

agement Act' was needed to create a legal framework for early warning systems, firefighting infrastructure and penalties for negligence. In response, the Environment Ministry stated that a national action plan for forest fires currently addresses forest fires, which is aided through working plans, compensatory afforestation funds and a disaster management framework.

The committee, however, asked the Centre to undertake a careful review of existing forest laws to safeguard forest communities and forest ecosystems.

Based on submissions, the committee also noted that Western Himalayas and Eastern Himalayas face contrasting forest fire dynamics. The fires in Western Himalaya are primarily driven by extreme pre-monsoon heat, pine-needle fuel loads and proximity-based human ignition; whereas there is a complex interplay of atmospheric dryness and cultivation-linked burning practices in the Eastern Himalaya.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

● AHEAD OF ASSEMBLY POLLS, HIS WARIS PUNJAB DE HAS BEEN MAKING ITS PRESENCE FELT; BUT IS IT STILL MORE THAN A WEAK, PANTHIC ALTERNATIVE TO A STRUGGLING AKALI DAL?

# The shadow of jailed Amritpal Singh: Punjab has seen this movie before



**NORTHERN LIGHTS**  
BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

THERE IS an air of déjà vu in Punjab as, coinciding with the steady approach of the next Assembly elections, controversial Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh once again looms over the state's politics, despite being lodged thousands of kilometres away in Assam's Dibrugarh Central Jail since April 2023.

Last week, workers of his party, the Shiromani Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De), brought forth of Chandigarh to a standstill after breaching police barricades to march towards CM Bhagwant Mann's residence,

demanding Amritpal's release as well as that of "Bandi Singhs", the name given to "Sikh political prisoners" languishing in jail since end of militancy in 1990s.

The fledgling Waris Punjab De, formed in January 2025, has also been attracting leaders from other parties, most notably Manpreet Singh Ayali, a SAD (Badal) MLA who crossed over and joined it in May this year.

So, is Punjab witnessing the political return of Amritpal Singh, or is it yet another search for a panthic alternative that usually fades once the emotional charge dissipates?

Punjab's history shows that such moments are not unusual. Whenever the SAD appears unable to channel Sikh political aspirations, new panthic formations emerge, often gaining momentum around a particular leader or grievance, before struggling to build the organisation needed to sustain it.

Amritpal's political relevance has survived his imprisonment largely because of the remarkable mandate he secured in the 2024 LS elections, contesting as an Independent, from inside jail.

Another winner was Sarabjit Singh Khalsa, the elder son of Beant Singh, one of the assassins of PM Indira Gandhi in 1984, from Faridkot.

Many interpreted these victories as an endorsement of radical Sikh politics. On the ground, the picture was more layered. A couple told this reporter that their sympathy lay with Amritpal because of the Punjab Police's sweeping crackdown during the month-long manhunt for him in April 2023. Many youngsters were detained and the Internet was suspended for almost a week in parts of Punjab. Others admired his anti-drug campaign, while some were drawn to his repeated articulation of Sikh grievances.

That momentum, however, proved short-lived. In November 2025 Tarn Taran bypoll, a seat within Amritpal's Khadoor Sahib LS constituency, the Waris Punjab De candidate finished a distant third. The AAP retained the seat, while the SAD (Badal) candidate finished second, signalling the first signs of organisational recovery for the once-dominant party.



Punjab government has argued before the HC that LS MP Amritpal Singh's return continues to pose a threat to public order. EXPRESS FILE

The result underscored both the limits of Amritpal's appeal when he was not on the ballot, and residual strength of traditional Akali machinery in rural Majha. It also exposed Waris Punjab De's failure to develop a village-level network, which had once made Akalis formidable.

### Rise of Amritpal

After spending several years in Dubai, a clean-shaven Amritpal, then just 29, had returned to Punjab in 2022. Almost overnight, he had reinvented himself as "Bhai Saheb", complete with a blue turban, flowing white

robes and a spear.

His dastarbandi (installation) as head of Waris Punjab De, the organisation founded by actor-activist Deep Sidhu, took place at Rode, the ancestral village of Khalistan ideologue Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale, in September 2022, amid shrill sloganeering and calls for a separate Sikh nation. For many Punjabis who had lived through the turbulence of the late 1970s and 1980s, the symbolism was unmistakable and unsettling.

His amrit sanchar (baptism) drives, called "Khalsa Vaheers", launched in November 2022, his

call to shun drugs and embrace religion, and his often exaggerated and unsubstantiated accounts of injustice against Sikhs evoked memories of another era and another man who became larger than life.

"Sikhs should learn from the Palestine struggle," he told this reporter.

While youngsters with no memory of the militancy era were drawn to him on social media, their parents remained and still remain fearful of the consequences for Punjab. This generational divide is the most noteworthy feature of his appeal: drugs, unemployment, migration and a sense of discrimination animate the young; while the older generation remembers the cost of similar rhetoric.

The security dimension, however, cannot be ignored. Successive NSA detention orders have cited the siege of Ajnala Police Station in Amritsar in February 2023 by Amritpal and his men, the alleged creation of an "armed outfit" called Anandpur Khalsa Fauj through de-addiction centres, alleged links with Canada-based extremists and

gangsters, provocative letters from jail calling for revenge over killings of pro-Khalistan figures abroad, and intelligence inputs about a hit-list targeting critics, including former associates.

After his third NSA detention ended in April this year, Amritpal was re-arrested in the Ajnala case and remains in Dibrugarh Central Jail. The Punjab government has successfully argued before the HC his return continues to pose a threat to public order. Any political project built around Amritpal, therefore, will have to contend not only with the ballot box but also with the state's security concerns.

### A familiar story

It is the decline of SAD, once the unchallenged voice of Sikh politics since its birth in 1920, that has created the space Amritpal occupies. Yet there is a historical paradox. Ever since 1966 reorganisation of Punjab into a Sikh-majority state, Akalis have never formed a government here on their own, with the only exception being Surjit Singh Barnala government of 1985. But it too enjoyed tacit support of Con-

gress after then PM Rajiv Gandhi inked an accord with Akali leader Sant Harchand Singh Longowal in July 1985. That history may explain why Manpreet Singh Ayali, de facto face of Waris Punjab De in Amritpal's absence, recently emphasised that the party stands not only for Sikhs but also for Hindus, Muslims and all Punjabis.

The elections will not simply determine the fortunes of a jailed MP. It will test whether a generation that has grown up after militancy still seeks answers in religious assertion, or whether Punjab's politics can produce a new vocabulary that speaks to jobs, drugs and migration without reopening old wounds.

So far, Amritpal's personal charisma has not translated into durable organisational power. Waris Punjab De still looks less like the beginning of a new panthic consolidation and more like another challenge to an eroded Akali Dal, and one that thrives on grievance and symbolism.

Punjab has seen this movie before. The ending rarely changes.

The author is National Editor (North)



PROTEST OVER JHARKHAND RECRUITMENT IRREGULARITIES

# Soren govt holds talks with students, seeks time to examine their demands

Shubham Tigga  
Ranchi, August 7

TWO WEEKS after students' protest kicked off in Ranchi, the Jharkhand government, for the first time, held formal talks with representatives of the protesting students on Friday night.

The one-and-a-half hour-long meeting took place at the State Guest House, where a 10-member delegation from the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch, one of the two factions of protesters, met four state ministers along with a senior bureaucrat. The students have been protesting against alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC).

After the meeting, students said the protest would continue, while the government said it would consider the demands and discuss them with CM Hemant Soren before taking a decision. Addressing a press conference, Rajesh Prasad, one of the



Protest at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium in Ranchi, Friday. SHASHI GHOSH

organisers of the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch, said the government had sought time to examine the demands. "We will continue the protest until August 10. If our demands are not implemented on the ground by then, the movement will continue."

The government delegation comprised ministers Deepika Pandey Singh (of the Congress), Sudivya Kumar Sonu and Chandra Linda (JMM), and Sanjay Yadav (RJD), besides Additional Chief Secretary Ajay Kumar Singh. The students re-

iterated their key demands, including cancellation of the JPSC Combined Civil Services Examination-14, a CBI probe into the alleged recruitment scam, and the involvement of the ED if financial irregularities are found during the probe. They demanded all recruitment examinations allegedly linked to the main accused, Abhay Tiwari alias Manoj Tiwari, who has been arrested, be cancelled.

After the meeting, which lasted from 8 pm to 9.30 pm, ministers told reporters that the

government was considering the students' demands. Binay Kumar, one of the organisers of the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch, described the discussions as positive but maintained that the agitation would continue until a concrete decision was taken. He said though the government delegation discussed all the demands of students and promised to place them before the CM, it didn't give any specific assurance on accepting any of them.

According to government sources, the initial list of 11 delegates submitted by the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch was revised after the government asked the protesters to reconstitute it. Later, a 10-member delegation represented the students in Friday's talks. It is not clear why the list was changed. The student delegation was brought to the State Guest House in three vehicles under the supervision of the Sub-Divisional Magistrate.

The delegation comprised Ravindra Paswan, Piyush Kumar, Rajesh Prasad, Neetu Kujur, Ankit Raj, Kartik Soren,

Shalu Kumari, Ravindra Kumar Ravi, Anand Kumar and Ankit Kumar. The talks also highlighted divisions within the student movement. While the government chose to negotiate with the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch, another platform, the JPSC-JSSC Abhyarthi Nyay Manch, which had earlier announced a separate list of delegates, expressed dissatisfaction over being left out of the discussions. Earlier in the day, one of the protesters on an indefinite hunger strike was taken to hospital after his health deteriorated, protest organisers said. This came on a day when All India Students' Association (AISA) leader Neha Bora, who has now joined the protests, was attacked with ink. Rahul Kranti is one of seven persons on hunger strike at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium.

Meanwhile, AISA's Bora, who arrived in Ranchi from Delhi Friday morning, was allegedly targeted with black ink while leading a march of students to the Assembly.

EXPRESS special

## Kairana, 10 yrs later: Gangster killing in encounter turns page on 'Hindu exodus' chapter

Furqan was out on bail, facing trial in murder of a trader in Kairana in 2014

Manish Sahu  
Lucknow, August 7

THE KILLING of 38-year-old gangster Furqan in an encounter in Uttar Pradesh's Shamli district on Wednesday marked the quiet end of a chapter that once roiled state politics. He was one of the criminals whose "free run" was alleged by the BJP in 2016 — as it sought to come to power in UP — to have led to a "Hindu exodus" from Kairana.

Furqan, who carried a Rs 1 lakh bounty on his head, had a string of cases against him, most prominently that of murder of Vinod Kumar Singhal, the treasurer of the Kairana Vyapar Mandal. Singhal, 34, was shot dead on August 16, 2014, at his grocery store, allegedly because he supported another trader who had received extortion demands from the gang. Furqan and his three accomplices were facing charges in the case, with the trial still on. While Furqan was out on bail when killed, the other three remain on bail.

The killing of Singhal sent shockwaves through Kairana. Within days of the murder, his family relocated to the neighbouring Muzaffarnagar district, citing safety concerns. Around three months later, on persuasion of the district and police officials, they returned.

In 2016, in the run-up to the UP Assembly elections, Kairana hit national headlines when late BJP MP Hukum Singh alleged that nearly 350 Hindus had fled the town because of threats and extortion by criminal gangs belonging to one community.

A town bordering Muzaffarnagar, Saharanpur and the state



Furqan carried a Rs 1 lakh bounty on his head; he allegedly killed businessman Vinod Singhal (right) in August 2014



of Haryana, Kairana has a population of more than one lakh, with Muslims forming around 70% of the numbers. It has long been a stronghold of criminal gangs, with Kairana's location along state borders helping them evade capture.

With heat on the issue rising, the Shamli administration ordered a probe into the claims. It identified only three families that had left Kairana following incidents of extortion. Among them was the family of Singhal, and of two other businessmen killed allegedly by a gangster said to have links with Furqan.

### 'D-8/2015'

Furqan was allegedly involved in several criminal activities, leading a gang known by its number in police records — "D-8/2015". Originally from Aryapur locality in Kairana, he had more than two dozen criminal cases against him, including murder, robbery, extortion, and offences under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and Arms Act. Convicted in an NDPS case and given 10 years, he had come out on bail six months ago.

Police said that on August 5, they got a tip-off about Furqan and an associate planning to strike near Rangana village in Shamli, and rushed a team there. They said the two men opened fire, prompting officers to return fire. During the exchange, Furqan was struck by bullets, while his accomplice re-

portedly managed to escape.

Head Constable Harvinder was also injured in the gunfire, and was taken to hospital along with Furqan. Police said Furqan died during treatment, while Harvinder is now stable.

Police said they recovered a carbine, a pistol, live cartridges, cash, and a motorcycle without a registration plate from Furqan and his associate. A search is on for the associate.

Singhal's younger brother Varun, who now runs the family's grocery business, says the "terror" after his killing led them to leave Shamli. "The then district magistrate and superintendent of police persuaded us to return, saying our departure was sending the wrong message about Kairana," says Varun.

He adds, "It wasn't just our family that lived in fear... After my brother's murder, two more businessmen were killed, again over extortion demands."

The other businessmen killed were cousins Shiv Kumar Singhal and Rajendra Kumar Garg, who jointly ran an iron goods shop. The cousins were shot as they allegedly refused to pay Rs 10 lakh demanded by gangster Muqem Kala. Their families moved to Muzaffarnagar and continue to live there.

Police filed a chargesheet against Muqem and eight others in the case, which too remains pending in court. In 2021, Muqem was shot dead, allegedly by a fellow inmate, inside Chitrakoot District Jail.

## UP RLD chief Ramashish Rai quits, flags NDA's 'divisive politics'

Lalmani Verma  
Lucknow, August 7

IN A setback to the Jayant Chaudhary-led Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD), its Uttar Pradesh unit president Ramashish Rai resigned from his post as well as the party on Friday, barely seven months before the state Assembly elections.

Rai said his move was driven by the "divisive politics" of the ruling BJP-led NDA of which the RLD is a constituent in both UP and at the Centre. In a letter addressed to Jayant, the Union minister of state for skill development and education, Rai said Indian democracy was being

usurped by the influential and financially powerful sections and that the practice of dividing the society on caste and religious lines was on the rise. He also said the issues related to education, employment and social justice was causing distress among the masses.

"Unfortunately there are such people too in the top positions in public life, who are encouraging social division and caste frenzy. This practice is a threat for democracy, social harmony and national interest," Rai told Jayant. In the letter, Rai wrote that former Prime Minister and BJP stalwart late Atal Bihari Vajpayee had called the



Ramashish Rai resigned as the UP RLD chief on Friday, barely seven months before the state Assembly polls. X/@RAMASHISHMLC

influence of money in politics and elections a serious threat to democracy. "His (Vajpayee's) ap-

### Murder case: MP HC overturns conviction of 2 in jail for 14 yrs

Anand Mohan J  
Bhopal, August 7

GRANTING RELIEF to two men who had spent 14 years in jail, the Madhya Pradesh HC has overturned their conviction in a murder case noting that the trial court had relied on an FSL report from another case while pronouncing the judgment in 2012.

Calling the prosecution's case riddled with "serious lapses", the court noted that the FIR was written by an unidentified police officer whose testimony was never recorded.

A division bench of Justices Vivek Agarwal and Avanindra Kumar Singh recently overturned the June 29, 2012, judgment of the Special Sessions Court, Damoh, which had convicted Tulsiram Rajpal and Harprasad and sentenced them to life imprisonment.

According to the prosecution's case, on the night of August 25, 2009, Pyarelal Gadariya reported that the accused entered his house, abused his family and assaulted him. According to the prosecution, Tulsiram stabbed Pyarelal while Harprasad and another accused restrained him. Pyarelal died after lodging of the FIR.

The HC found the FSL report marked did not belong to the present case at all but was related to another prosecution. Despite this, the report was exhibited, put to accused during their examination under Section 313 CrPC, and relied upon by the trial court while recording the conviction. "We are really surprised as to how this negligence was caused by the learned trial Court... It's surprising neither party... argued this point; we find that the judgment of trial court was not written carefully and only on this ground alone judgment can be set aside," it said.

• BRIEFLY



PDP leader Iltija Mufti, along with supporters, arrives at a police station in Srinagar on Friday. ANI

JAMMU AND KASHMIR

### PDP's Iltija summoned over 'assault' on police officer during protest

PDP LEADER Iltija Mufti was summoned to a police station in Srinagar on Friday with regard to an FIR in a case of alleged assault on a police officer earlier this week. On August 4, the PDP, led by its president and former J&K CM Mehbooba Mufti, held a protest demonstration at its headquarters to mark the seventh anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370. Mufti's daughter, Iltija, was attempting to walk on the main street outside the party office with a placard in hand when she was stopped by the police, resulting in a confrontation. In their FIR, police alleged that the PDP workers, led by Mehbooba and Iltija, "turned aggressive and attacked the police party." ENS

### Uttarakhand: Car falls into gorge, 6 of family killed

SIX MEMBERS of a family were killed and another injured after their car plunged into a gorge on Devprayag-Pauri road in Uttarakhand's Pauri district Friday, police said. The accident occurred near the dumping zone in Devprayag area. The family, residents of the Laksar area in Haridwar district, was travelling in a Bolero when the driver allegedly lost control, causing it to fall into the gorge. Six bodies, including that of a 3-year-old girl, were recovered. A 16-year-old boy was injured and taken to a hospital. PTI

### Nashik TCS case: AIMIM corporator held

Nashik City police Friday arrested AIMIM corporator Matin Patel from Nashik after a local court issued a Non Bailable Warrant (NBW) against him for not responding to court summons in connection with the TCS sexual harassment case. A senior Nashik City police officer said that after Patel had not responded to two court summons in the TCS case, a non-bailable warrant was issued. On May 22, the Nashik police filed the 3,500-page chargesheet in the first of 9 FIRs in connection with the case. ENS

## Chhindwara chief medical health officer, 2 others suspended as MP CM launches outreach campaign

Anand Mohan J  
Bhopal, August 7

MADHYA PRADESH Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Friday launched a statewide public outreach programme from Chhindwara while once again relying on a tactic that has become a recurring feature of his administration — publicly acting against officials during field visits.

During the launch of the Mukhyamantri Jan Vishwas Abhiyan, Yadav suspended Chhindwara's Chief Medical and Health Officer (CMHO) Dr Naresh Gunnade, a tehsildar and a patwari after hearing complaints from citizens. Since taking office in December 2023, Yadav has repeatedly conducted surprise inspections, reviewed government offices on the spot and ordered suspensions or transfers of officials during public programmes.

Friday's launch institutionalises that approach by requiring ministers and district officials to spend every Friday in the field instead of attending routine review meetings. The decision also comes at a time when the ruling BJP is seeking to consolidate its administrative credentials midway through its term. Chhindwara, the bastion of former Congress CM Kamal Nath until the BJP's



CM Mohan Yadav in Chhindwara on Friday. PTI

breakthrough in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, provides a significant backdrop for launching a campaign aimed at projecting a government that is accessible and responsive to complaints.

### 'No meeting day'

Announcing the initiative, Yadav said that every Friday would be observed as a 'No Meeting Day', with ministers, MLAs, collectors and commissioners holding public hearings from the district to tehsil level. He said feedback collected during the campaign would shape future government policies and improve delivery of welfare schemes. The campaign also serves an administrative purpose: Senior officials have privately acknowledged that rou-

tine review meetings often generate compliance reports but fail to capture local grievances. By mandating field visits, the government hopes to reduce the gap between policy decisions in Bhopal and implementation on the ground, while making district administrations directly accountable to citizens.

Unlike his predecessor Shivrish Singh Chouhan, whose political brand revolved around welfare schemes and connect with beneficiaries, Yadav has increasingly sought to build his image around an assertive administrator who rewards performance and publicly penalises perceived administrative failures. Over the past year, he has acted against senior officials after inspections and public complaints, using disciplinary action both as an administrative tool and a political signal that the government is willing to hold its own bureaucracy publicly accountable.

In March, an unannounced visit to Sidhi resulted in the removal of the district collector and the suspension of the district cooperative bank's general manager following complaints from citizens. Around the same time, he also removed the Guna Superintendent of Police over alleged administrative irregularities.

Express News Service  
New Delhi, August 7

WITH AN expert analysis by the National Forensic Sciences University (NFSU) concluding that certain audio clips allegedly linking former Manipur CM Biren Singh to 2023 ethnic clashes were altered and manipulated, the Supreme Court Friday directed that a copy of the report be shared with the Kuki outfit seeking probe into the matter.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva, however, directed Advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for the petitioner Kuki Organisation for Human Rights Trust, to ensure that its contents remain confidential.

The Trust had claimed that the audio clips leaked by a whistleblower substantiate

Singh's alleged role in fuelling the ethnic clashes.

In April 2025, the SC asked CFSL to examine the tapes. A month later, the court expressed dissatisfaction with the CFSL report as it could not authenticate the tapes, and sought a fresh report. In August 2025, the SC ordered a fresh forensic examination by NFSU.

In January 2026, SC asked NFSU to compare the 48-minute clip with Singh's admitted voice. But with NFSU stating that the clips seemed modified, the court asked Bhushan to submit the unedited clip for forensic test. Friday, Additional SG Aishwarya Bhati told the bench that as per NFSU, even the first-generation copy had been altered, making forensic verification impossible. "It has 41 alterations... it's clearly manipulated," Bhati said.



# MEA: Govt does not endorse anything said at Hasina event

**Shubhajit Roy**  
*New Delhi, August 7*

INDIA ON Friday clarified that it had no role in the media event organised by ousted Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina on August 5, and stated that it does not endorse anything said at the forum about the “duly constituted government” of Bangladesh.

The official spokesperson of the Ministry of External Affairs, Randhir Jaiswal, said: “The government had no role to play in what was an event by a private media entity, and the government does not endorse anything said at the forum, especially with regard to the duly constituted government of Bangladesh.”

The statement comes two days after Hasina announced in a virtual press conference that she plans to return to her country in December.

Interestingly, the MEA’s response did not mention “democratically elected government of Bangladesh”. Earlier this year, New Delhi had raised questions over the inclusivity of the Bangladesh general elections, held in February, as the Hasina-led Awami League was banned from contesting it. Later, India welcomed the victory of the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and congratulated its leader

and Prime Minister Tarique Rahman. Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to Rahman soon after he was elected.

On August 5, Hasina addressed a press conference at the Foreign Correspondents’ Club of South Asia in New Delhi via an audio link. She said her “life had moved beyond calculations of personal safety long ago”, and she plans to return to her country, stand with its people and help improve their lives.

“...I cannot stay away while my beloved countrymen are suffering. I know I may be detained. I may be sent to prison. They may try to enforce verdicts in fabricated cases, but fear cannot decide my duty to the people...”

Asked when she plans to return, Hasina referred to the 1971 Bangladesh liberation war and said, “December is our victory month, so I want to go back in the month of December.”

“There were 19 assassination attempts against me... I am not worried about my future, I am worried about the future of Bangladesh. I want to return because the people deserve security, development, prosperity and peace,” she said.

Hasina, who has been living in India ever since her ouster in August 2024, faces a death sentence in Bangladesh. Her party, the Awami League, has been banned in the country.

# Day after man shot dead in Karnal, cops kill 2 suspects

**Express News Service**  
*Chandigarh, August 7*

A DAY after 28-year-old Biru Valmiki, who had several criminal cases pending against him, was shot dead, the Haryana Police on Friday claimed to have gunned down the two alleged shooters.

The encounter took place near Ghoghadipur canal in Karnal on the intervening night of August 6 and 7, police said.

Police identified the alleged shooters as Harsh (24), a resident of Nilokheri, and Birbal (29), from Matarwa Kheri village in Kaithal district. According to police, Birbal had 22 criminal cases against him while Harsh faced five. Biru too had multiple criminal cases against him, police said, adding he headed ‘Biru’s group’ comprising several youngsters from the district and was known to upload posts on social media provocative songs playing in the background.

Biru’s murder on Wednesday night triggered massive protests by his family and Valmiki community members. Karnal police said the encounter took place around midnight when teams intercepted the two suspects riding a motorcycle near the canal. As the suspects tried to turn back after spotting a police barricade, they



Police personnel at the site of encounter in Karnal. EXPRESS

allegedly lost control of the bike and opened fire at the police.

“One bullet struck the bulletproof jacket of Sub-Inspector Manoj Kumar, while another hit the jacket of the CIA-1 in-charge. The accused were warned to surrender but continued firing, prompting retaliatory action,” an investigating officer said.

Police claimed nearly 25 rounds were exchanged before both suspects were killed. A forensic team later reached the spot and collected samples.

Inspector General (Karnal Range) Ashok Kumar said, “Police teams were alerted after receiving intelligence regarding the suspects’ movements. The suspects were given an opportunity to surrender but instead

they allegedly opened fire on police, resulting in retaliatory firing in which both suspects were killed.”

Referring to Biru, the IG told *The Indian Express* that “he was also a criminal and had a rivalry with other gangsters. They used to threaten each other on social media. Further investigations are going on.”

A resident of Sadar Bazaar, Biru had left his home on his two wheeler around 9 pm Wednesday to visit his sister. He was diving on the Bhagwadia Gas Agency road when two men riding a motorbike allegedly opened fire at point-blank range before fleeing. Biru sustained a gunshot wound to the head. Some locals took him to Karnal Medical College Hospi-

tal from where he was referred to Amritdhara Hospital, where he died during treatment.

Following the killing, gangster Shooter Samana claimed responsibility of the attack in a social media post and threatened Biru’s associates to mend their ways, failing which they will also meet the same fate.

The murder triggered protests by Biru’s family and members of the Valmiki community, who blocked a road near Gandhi Chowk on Thursday demanding immediate action. His wife, Deepika, who married him six months ago, joined the protest and demanded strict action against the accused.

Karnal SP Narendra Bijarniya reached the spot and assured the family of action following which the protesters lifted their blockade. SP Bijarniya later constituted five teams to trace the assailants.

On Friday, the family accepted Biru’s body after talks with SDM Narendra Sharma and performed his last rites. The family has sought Rs 1 crore compensation, five arms licences and a government job for one member under the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam. DSP Sandeep Kumar said the demands would be forwarded to the state government for consideration.

# Kishor challenge to infighting, M-Y cracks: Why RJD hits reset in Bihar

**Santosh Singh**  
*Patna, August 7*

EIGHT MONTHS after the RJD was routed in the elections to the 243-member Bihar Assembly, in which its tally plunged to 25 seats from 75 earlier, the crisis gripping the party has deepened in the wake of its debacle in the Bankipur Assembly bypoll.

While Jan Suraj Party (JSP) founder Prahant Kishor trounced the ruling BJP’s candidate Neeraj Kumar Sinha by over 19,000 votes in Bankipur, the RJD’s Rekha Kumari Gupta finished a distant third there, forfeiting her security deposit.

The Bankipur bypoll was necessitated after its five-term MLA Nitin Nabin vacated the seat following his elevation to the BJP national president’s post and his subsequent election to the Rajya Sabha. In the November 2025 Assembly elections, Rekha was the runner-up in the Bankipur seat clinched by Nabin.

Just a fortnight ago, RJD’s state spokesperson Mrityunjay Tiwari, one of its most visible faces, quit the party to join the BJP.

These developments have come amid brewing discontent within the RJD at various levels, according to party sources. There is said to be resentment among several senior RJD leaders against the party’s chief state spokesperson Shakti Singh Yadav, who is known to be close to Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, the national party working president and Leader of the Opposition (LoP) in the Assembly.

In recent months, two prominent RJD leaders have voiced dissent against the party’s “arbitrary” functioning. While RJD chief Lalu Prasad’s daughter, Rohini Acharya, had raised the banner of revolt against her brother Tejashwi ahead of the Assembly polls over “excessive influence” of Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Yadav, Maner MLA Bhai Virendra, known for being outspoken, has continued to flag “dominance of sycophants and select leaders within the party”.

It was against this backdrop that Bihar RJD president Mangani Lal Mandal has dissolved all the state unit committees at the district, block, and panchayat levels.

The RJD leadership had brought in Mandal, a former MP and prominent EBC leader, to head the state party unit early last year after veteran leader Jagdanand Singh re-



Tejashwi Yadav, RJD leader

signed from this post.

A senior RJD leader told *The Indian Express*: “Though it is the discretion of a political party to reshuffle or dissolve its units from time to time, the latest decision calls for serious introspection. First, our Assembly tally was reduced from 75 seats in 2020 to 25 in 2025 — taking us back to our 2010 status when we had won just 22 seats. It shows that our appeal among voters has been waning.”

Another RJD leader explained that while the party had never won the Bankipur seat, finishing at third place with a forfeited deposit against a debutant victor — the poll strategist-turned-politician Kishor — warranted urgent corrective measures.

“It would be great if the party follows a democratic process to reconstitute the new committees with committed grassroots workers. The concerns raised by Bhai Virendra about a coterie of sycophants calling the shots need to be addressed. Our leader Tejashwi needs to be more accessible and must avoid disappearing acts when the party needs him most,” the leader said, adding that Kishor cannot be taken lightly as he has the potential to emerge as a principal Opposition against the incumbent BJP-led NDA in the post-Nitish Kumar era.

A major factor that fuelled Kishor’s surge was attributed to wide cracks in the support bases of both the BJP and the RJD. While broad chunks of upper castes shifted their loyalties from the BJP to Kishor, large sections of the OBCs and even the RJD’s Muslim-Yadav (M-Y) support base also backed the JSP chief. Following its defeat in the 2025 Bihar elections, the RJD seemed to have entered a phase of structural crisis. The sharp contraction of its traditional M-Y base, coupled with the rise of Kishor as a viable alternative, has rattled the party.

# Deepak Prakash now MLC, can continue as minister, Bihar tells SC

**Express News Service**  
*New Delhi, August 7*

A WEEK after the Supreme Court questioned how a minister has been retained unelected beyond the six-month constitutional limit, the Bihar government on Friday submitted that there is no bar on the continuation of Deepak Prakash as Panchayati Raj Minister since he has been nominated as a member of the Bihar Legislative Council.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the state government, said this to a CJISurya Kant-led three-judge bench, which directed him to submit the nomination notification by the next date of hearing.

The bench, also comprising Justice Joyimalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, was hearing a plea challenging the appointment of Deepak Prakash as Bihar’s Panchayati Raj Minister for the second time, without being a member of either House of the state Legislature.

On July 31, BJP MLC Devesh Kumar resigned from the Legislative Council in a bid to facilitate the entry of RLM leader Deepak Prakash.

During the hearing on July 30, the top court had told the Bihar government that “it is a pure legal issue” and the state will have to explain “how are you retaining a minister beyond six months when he is not elected?”

Article 164(4) allows a non-member to remain a minister for six months, subject to getting elected as a member within that period.

Prakash, the son of RLM president Upendra Kushwaha, was first inducted as the Panchayati Raj Minister on November 20, 2025, by then CM Nitish Kumar, though he was neither a member of the Assembly nor the Council.

After Nitish resigned, Samrat took charge as the CM on April 15, 2026, and inducted Prakash as the Panchayati Raj Minister on May 7, 2026.

The petitioner, Rakesh Kumar Singh, has argued that Article 164(4) is a one-time opportunity and cannot be utilised every time there is a change of government. He had to get re-elected between November 20, 2025, when he was first sworn in, and May 20, 2026, the plea pointed out.

Singh contended that the re-appointment was in circumvention of constitutional safeguards and undermines representative democracy.

He argued that it undermines the principles of parliamentary democracy, representative government, collective responsibility and electoral accountability. He urged that SC declare Prakash’s reappointment and continuance in office unconstitutional, illegal and void, and to restrain him from exercising the powers vested in the ministerial office.

## Tamil Nadu CM’s wife withdraws divorce petition

**Arun Janardhanan**  
*Chennai, August 7*

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Vijay Joseph’s wife, Sangeetha, has withdrawn her divorce petition before a family court in Chengalpattu, near Chennai, bringing to a close, at least for now, a case that had drawn considerable public attention.

According to an order passed by the Single Judge of the Family Court, Sangeetha appeared through video conference and confirmed she did not wish to pursue the matrimonial proceedings initiated earlier this year.

“The petitioner appeared through video conference and confirmed she does not wish to proceed further with this case... and has filed this withdrawal petition,” the court recorded. The court also noted that notice had been served on the respondent’s counsel, who recorded no objection to the request. It subsequently permitted the petitioner to withdraw the petition.

“The petitioner is permitted to withdraw this case... with a liberty to file a fresh petition in future, if required. Hence, this petition is allowed,” the order said.

Since the petition has been withdrawn rather than decided, the court has not examined or ruled on the allegations or claims originally made in the case. Friday’s order, however, offers no explanation for the decision to withdraw the petition.

# Even hostile nations try to resolve issues, says Vijay amid flak over Karnataka outreach

**Arun Janardhanan**  
*Chennai, August 7*

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay said Friday that the now-abandoned attempt to open direct political talks with Karnataka over the Cauvery dispute had originated with him, offering his most detailed defence yet of an initiative that drew criticism from opposition parties and ultimately failed to materialise.

Replying to a special calling attention motion in the Assembly on the Cauvery water-sharing dispute and Karnataka’s proposed Mekedatu balancing reservoir, Vijay said his government had never intended to dilute Tamil Nadu’s long-held legal position but believed there was value in testing whether dialogue could create even the smallest opening in one of India’s most intractable interstate disputes.

“It was I who first thought of and proposed the Bengaluru visit,” the chief minister said, acknowledging that the idea had generated sharply divided opinions even before it was shelved.

The statement amounted to Vijay’s clearest personal ownership of an outreach that had earlier been portrayed largely as a government initiative.

It also sought to recast what opponents had described as a diplomatic misstep into an example of political risk-taking



Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay speaks in the Assembly in Chennai on Friday. PTI

undertaken on behalf of farmers facing an uncertain irrigation season.

“Even hostile nations try to resolve issues through dialogue,” Vijay told the House. “I thought, why not at least try speaking with a neighbouring State? If we could have obtained even one positive sign towards resolving the issue, it would have been worthwhile.”

The remarks came days after Karnataka rejected the proposed meeting between the two Chief Ministers, insisting that the Cauvery dispute was already governed by the final award of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and subsequent Supreme Court orders. The collapse of the proposed talks had triggered criticism from the Opposition.

“We remain firm in approaching this issue through

legal means...,” he said, adding that the government had written to Prime Minister Narendra Modi seeking that no legal or administrative approval be granted to Karnataka’s proposed Mekedatu project after citing both the Tribunal’s final award and the Supreme Court judgment governing the sharing of Cauvery waters.

He insisted that protecting Tamil Nadu’s rights over Cauvery water and opposing the Mekedatu project remained non-negotiable.

Vijay also said that several people had warned him that the initiative could end in public humiliation if Karnataka refused to engage.

Seeking to place the dispute above partisan politics, Vijay rejected attempts to reopen historical blame over decisions taken decades ago.

# Bombay HC asks FDA to act systematically: ‘Will you shut down all establishments?’

**Omkar Gokhale**  
*Mumbai, August 7*

THE BOMBAY High Court questioned the Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) whether it would shut down all commercial establishments in Mumbai, Thane, Palghar, Pune and other areas to deal with the situation. At the same time, the court also said, the FDA deserved a compliment for its state-wide action against food safety violations.

The HC, while hearing a plea by Amazon Retail India against FDA action at its warehouse in Bhiwandi for allegedly diverting expired and damaged food into the retail market instead of destroying it in a scientific manner, cautioned the FDA that, as per settled law, the food licence could not be cancelled while an appeal against suspension of the licence was pending before the competent forum.

Senior advocate Venkatesh Dhond for Amazon Retail India told a bench of Acting Chief Justice Ravindra V Ghuge and Justice Gautam A Ankhad that FDA



Food licence cannot be cancelled during the appeal, the High Court bench told Food and Drug Administration. GANESH SHIRSEKAR

officers visited the warehouse on June 24 and suspended its licence the next day without an improvement notice.

Dhond said the action was over disposal of expired goods under food safety regulations, with no allegation against the warehouse’s overall functioning. On July 1, FDA issued a show-cause notice, then cancelled the licence while its suspension appeal was pending.

“During the appeal, how can there be a cancellation order? It is a settled law that during the appeal period, no such action can be taken.

Therefore, we need to tell you that in order to implement your policies vigorously, you try to kill a mosquito with a sword. Procedure has to be followed. What should I do now?” Acting CJ Ghuge questioned the state government lawyer.

Dhond added that more food items at the warehouse were getting expired and FDA was not allowing their disposal, citing it could not be done as per pollution control guidelines and disposal should follow food safety norms. He argued that the FDA lacked power to regulate disposal of expired food

items and their immediate disposal was necessary.

After Government Pleader (GP) Neha Bhide told the bench that FDA would file an affidavit in response to the plea, the judge remarked, “That we know. But what is to be done now? As we have said (earlier hearings over FDA actions), we appreciate your (FDA’s) action. This is a laudable object and you deserve a compliment. But go systematically. To deal with the situation, will you shut down all commercial establishments in Mumbai, Thane, Pune and Palghar?”

When GP Bhide said some action was required to be taken in case of irregularities, the judge said, “Yes, we are with you.” On Monday, August 10, along with Amazon Retail and other petitions against FDA actions, the HC will also hear pleas by liquor manufacturers against Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) prohibitory orders that cited alleged misleading labelling and unauthorised flavour additions.

Advertisement

“Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award”

In order to recognize the organizations that have shown best practices in creating a safe, respectful, equal and supportive workplace environment for women employees in the state of Haryana, “Mahila Samarth Sansthan Puraskar Yojana” has been started. The main objectives of this scheme are as follows:

- To promote safe, respectful and gender-sensitive workplaces across Haryana.
- To encourage compliance with the provisions of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (POSH Act.).
- To promote higher participation of women in employment and leadership roles.
- To encourage adoption of women-friendly workplace policies including childcare support, flexible work arrangements and grievance redressal mechanisms.
- To develop a State-wide Women-Friendly Workplace Rating Framework.
- To recognize institutions demonstrating best practices in gender-inclusive workplace governance.

**Coverage of the Scheme**  
The scheme shall apply to all eligible institutions operating within the State of Haryana, including:-

- Government Departments, Boards, Corporations and Commissions
- Public Sector Undertakings
- Autonomous Bodies
- Private Companies
- Industrial Units
- Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs),
- Educational Institutions
- Hospitals and Service Sector Establishments
- Non-Governmental Organizations employing women workforce.

The details of awards given to institutions for good work done for women employees under the “Mahila Samarth Sansthan Puraskar Yojana” in the state of Haryana are as follows:

| Category                  | Number of Awards | Budget      |
|---------------------------|------------------|-------------|
| Government Institutions   | 05               | ₹4.75 lakh  |
| Private Sector / Industry | 05               | ₹4.75 lakh  |
| MSMEs                     | 05               | ₹4.75 lakh  |
| Educational Institutions  | 05               | ₹4.75 lakh  |
| NGOs / Service Sector     | 05               | ₹4.75 lakh  |
| [Total]                   | 25               | ₹23.75 lakh |

Last Date for Submission of Applications: 20.09.2026

Link for Online Application & Evaluation Framework: <https://mahilasamarth.wcdhry.gov.in> (or the actual portal link)

**Application Process:** Applications for the Mahila Samarti. Sansthan Award are invited only through the online mode via the Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award Portal from 20.08.2026 to 20.09.2026. The application form, Evaluation Framework, eligibility criteria, guidelines, terms and conditions are available on the Department’s website [www.wcdhry.gov.in](http://www.wcdhry.gov.in).

### Important Instructions:-

1. Applications shall be accepted only through the online mode.
2. No application received after the prescribed closing date, i.e. 20.09.2026, shall be entertained.
3. Applications submitted through post, speed post, courier or any other offline mode shall not be accepted.
4. Incomplete, incorrect or applications not submitted in the prescribed format are liable to be rejected without assigning any reason.
5. The Department reserves the right to amend the terms and conditions or modify the application process, if considered necessary.
6. The decision of the Department shall be final and binding, and no correspondence in this regard shall be entertained.

Sd/-

Joint Director

Women & Child Development Department, Haryana  
Bays No. 15-20, Sector-4, Panchkula  
No. 47968/HRY



# Amritsar top cop transferred after row over remarks linking ISI to Jantar Mantar protest



Kamaldeep Singh Brar  
Amritsar, August 7

THE TRANSFER of Amritsar Police Commissioner Gurpreet Singh Bhullar Friday following conflicting statements over an alleged ISI-backed terror plot and its link to the Jantar Mantar protest has generated a political controversy in Punjab.

It began on August 4, when the Amritsar city police announced the busting of a cross-border terror module linked to Pakistan's ISI. While the initial official press release detailed the recovery of weapons and petrol bombs without mentioning any connection to the protests in New Delhi, an exclusive interview given by CP Bhullar to news agency ANI set off a massive controversy.

On August 5, the BJP uploaded video clips of CP Bhullar's statement on its social media handles with the caption, "An ISI connection to the Jantar-Mantar protest has come to light. The police have exposed this module." In the video, Bhullar detailed how foreign handlers lured locals, using digital payments: "They were given the task to perform reconnaissance on police establishments and security establishments, and to make videos of them... They were sent money via Paytm... they

IPS officer Gurpreet Singh Bhullar

were instructed to target any personnel from the police or any uniformed force."

Highlighting the troubling involvement of minors, Bhullar added: "Most of the people in this module—except for one—are juveniles, all three of them. And it makes me very sad that 15-year-old children are involved in such activities... Basically, the module being run by the ISI-backed handler... had also sent them to Jantar Mantar. These eight people traveled to Delhi by train and returned from there. They were locally provided with materials for petrol bombs and similar items there, but... they could not execute any such action there."

## Oil companies reject E20 contamination claim, say pan-India testing shows quality as per norms

Sukalp Sharma  
New Delhi, August 7

THREE PUBLIC sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Friday issued a joint statement rejecting contamination claims on ethanol-blended petrol.

According to the statement, intensive and large-scale testing of ethanol-blended petrol supply chain showed that samples for E20 fuel—80 parts petrol and 20 parts ethanol— from across the country had moisture and chloride content within prescribed limits, with only a couple of isolated incidents of higher elevated levels coming to light.

The testing comes in the wake of a public backlash over E20 fuel, with claims of reduction in mileage and engine component wear and tear in older vehicles whose engines were not designed for higher ethanol blends. The government has consistently denied component wear claims, while saying that mileage drop in older vehicles would be in 3-5% range.

Late July, auto industry body Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) had flagged concerns over corrosion and wear to some engine parts due to "excessive chloride and moisture content in the fuel", but later withdrew its letter to the government, saying the data would require further authentication.

The government, meanwhile, directed the OMCs to strengthen fuel quality monitoring across the country. The issue has also found political traction, with some Opposition leaders attacking the government over mandating Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VbRGJOKH6oBd0F>

## E20 destroying people's lives, their vehicles: Rahul

New Delhi: Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Friday said E20 fuel blending was a "big issue" and claimed that it was aimed at stealing from people and destroying their vehicles. "This issue of E20 is very big. Normally we say, *daal mein kuchh kaala hai, magaryahan puri daal hi kaali hai* (not a minor issue, the whole thing is corrupt)," he said in a video posted on social media.

"...this is a matter of sequencing. In any campaign, we have to decide the sequence of affairs. Our problem right now is that there is so much corruption that there is a huge line in what we have to sequence," he said.

Gandhi said the Congress would take up the matter "in a massive way" because it is "destroying people's scooters, destroying people's lives, and is stealing directly from them".

tory rollout of E20 petrol.

"...OMCs carried out a nationwide additional intensive testing covering the entire EBMS (E20) supply chain. The findings reaffirm that fuel quality remains consistently well within prescribed limits. Contrary to certain assertions being made, there is no evidence of any alarm on account of fuel contamination," said the OMCs—Indian Oil, Bharat Petroleum, and Hindustan Petroleum.

Express News Service

Jammu, August 7

JAMMU AND Kashmir Police on Friday arrested a man following a security breach on the Jammu-Srinagar national highway 44 in Ramban district. Altaf Mohammad of Kirmchi from Udhampur was arrested during a search operation launched in the morning after a Scorpio car he was travelling in drove through a security checkpoint on the highway despite being signalled to stop by a police team. The incident occurred at Chanderkote around 3.30 am. The police personnel deployed at the checkpoint, in view of the ongoing Amarnath yatra, opened fire at the car as it sped towards a link road.

The breach set off alarm bells in the district and the security forces launched a massive search operation for the vehicle and its occupants. Later, the car was found abandoned nearly 8-9 km from NH-44. Its occupants, believed to be three in number, fled into the nearby forests, officials said. The other two are still in hiding, said the police.

The police have ruled out any terror angle, sources said the accused might be involved in bovine smuggling.

## India identifies 27 places in Arunachal by standard names on official map

Press Trust of India  
New Delhi, August 7

WITH CHINA repeatedly renaming some places in Arunachal Pradesh, India on Friday formally identified 27 places and geographical features in the state by their standard names on the official Indian map.

"Identifying them formally on the Survey of India map of Arunachal Pradesh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," an official statement said.

China's act of renaming places in Arunachal Pradesh has always been categorically rejected by New Delhi, which has consistently termed such moves "vain and preposterous" while asserting that these will not alter the "undeniable" reality that the state "was, is, and will" always remain an integral part of India.

The 27 locations formally marked on the official map of India include Long Ju located along the Line of Actual Control which was one of the earliest flashpoints between India and China in 1959 when Chinese forces entered the area.

Maja, a village near Long Ju in Upper Subansiri district, has also been marked on the map, the statement said. The list also includes Bisa village.

One of the most strategically important high-altitude passes

Thag La, where one of the opening battles between Indian and Chinese forces took place in 1962, has also been formally identified on the official map, along with Dzo La, Riza La and Pukur La.

Jairampur, an important logistics hub in Changlang district, which is known as the gateway to the eastern border region supporting movements of security forces towards eastern Arunachal and the Myanmar frontier, has also been formally identified on the map.

The list also includes Sambho Sarovar (a high-altitude lake), Bara Kundun and Chhota Kundun in Eastern Arunachal, Dhan Bari, Primnagar, Teritnagar, Ramnagar Jaswant Garh that houses the memorial of Indian martyr Jaswant Singh Rawat on Tawang Road, and villages of Sagar, Padma, Jyotinagar and Baisakhi.

Sher-e-Thapa Memorial commemorating 1962 war hero Trilok Singh Thapa, Chhota Ropuk and Bara Ropuk, Shivaji Nagar, Sunpura, Kamlang Nagar located near the Kamlang sanctuary and Buddhamandir are also there.

New Delhi has been dismissing Chinese efforts to assign "fictitious names" to Indian territory, asserting such attempts to create "baseless narratives" cannot alter "undeniable reality" and could derail efforts to normalise bilateral ties.

## Maharashtra bans 114 literature items 'linked to terror outfits'

Manish Kumar Pathak & Shubhangi Khapre  
Mumbai, August 7

THE MAHARASHTRA government prohibited the publication, circulation, possession and storage of 114 literature items which allegedly spreads extremism and promotes radicalisation, and are linked to terror outfits including the Islamic State.

Stating the banned literature promotes radicalisation, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis said on Friday, "The main concern was radicalisation, there was an attempt to promote radicalisation. In some cases it talked about how to make bombs and how to stage violence." The banned literature items include magazines, articles, social media posts, audio and video files.

The move came after the Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) wrote to the state government on March 17, this year, stating that certain newspapers, books, documents, paintings, drawings, photographs and other visible representations

Real Creator IAS Edition [https://t.me/+2RvD\\_RG9fmljMzg1](https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9fmljMzg1) should be forfeited as they were allegedly connected with activities affecting the sovereignty and integrity of India and state security.

Investigation by ATS, intelligence input, and cyber surveillance found that extremist literature and propaganda were being circulated and shared through both physical and digital platforms.

The government then issued notification on August 6 stating that the material allegedly promotes violent extremism and jihad, spreads extremist ideology and was encouraging radicalisation of youths as well as chances to facilitate recruitment into terrorist organisations.

The notification stated that the material was associated with terrorist organisations, including Islamic State (IS), Islamic State in Khurasan Province (ISKP), Hizb-ul-Mujahideen Pir Panjal Regiment and Al Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent (AQIS), among others listed under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. The notifications also covers related websites, social media

platforms, encrypted channels and digital networks used to spread such content.

Invoking Section 98(1) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, the Maharashtra government has declared that all copies of the material listed in the notification's annexure stand forfeited to the government. Fadnis told mediapersons in Mumbai that the state government will have to closely monitor such activities and there cannot be any compromise on national security.

"In absence of specific laws we could not ban such publications. After the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 came onto effect, state government has provision to take action," he added. Meanwhile, commenting on RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat's outreach to Gen Z in the wake of Jantar Mantar protests, calling them more honest than earlier generation, Fadnis said, "When the RSS chief speaks, he addresses the nation. He does not express views of any political party or government. The views are in national interest."



**Name of office :- Resident Engineer (Executive Engineer)**  
**Liaison Office, Water Resources Department, Bihar,**  
**203, Bihar Sadan, Dwarka Sector-19, New Delhi-110075**

**LETTER OF INVITATION**

Request for Financial Proposal (RFP) is being invited in two bid system (Technical & Financial) by Resident Engineer (Executive Engineer) Liaison Office, Water Resources Department, Bihar, 203, Bihar Sadan, Sector-19, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075 from Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies.

**1. Name of Work:**

1. Hiring of Service Provider for Supply of manpower in Liaison Office, Water Resources Department, Bihar, 203, Bihar Sadan, Sector-19, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075 or at a place directed by Resident Engineer, Liaison office, WRD, Government of Bihar, New Delhi in the interest of work.

**2. Date & time of receiving proposal:-**

Proposal will be submitted in two bid system namely **Technical bid & Financial bid**.

**Technical bid** will consist of Technical credentials.

**Financial bid** will be submitted in sealed envelope, which will consist of only quoted rate for the work.

Financial bid will be opened only if the Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies qualifies in the technical criteria setup for the work.

The bidder must submit their offer in a double cover (Two separate sealed envelopes in one sealed cover having Technical Proposal in two hard copy along with EMD and second sealed envelope consisting of Financial Bid in one hard copy envelop clearly marked Financial Proposal) not later than **01/09/2026 till 03.00 PM** in the office of Resident Engineer, Liaison Office, Water Resources Department , Govt. of Bihar, Bihar Sadan , Dwarka Sector-19, New Delhi-110075 .

**3 A) Date & time of opening of R.F.P(Technical Proposal)**

The R.F.P. shall be opened at **03.30 PM** on **01/09/2026** in the presence of Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies who choose to be present in the Liaison Office, Water Resources Department, Bihar, 203, Bihar Sadan, Sector-19, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075. In the event of the specified date of RFP opening being declared a holiday, the RFPs will be opened at the appointed time and location on the next working day. Even in the case of absence of the Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies at the time of opening of proposal, department will proceed ahead with the opening.

**b. Date & time of opening of R.F.P. (Financial Proposal)-**

Financial proposal of only those bidders will be considered who will be declared qualifies in technical criteria evaluation.

**4 Evaluation Criteria/Basis of Evaluation.**

**a) Evaluation of Technical Proposal**

The proposed manpower are to be provided in the Liaison Office, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Bihar, 203, Bihar Sadan, Dwarka Sector-19, New Delhi-110075 or at a place directed by Resident Engineer, Liaison office, WRD, Government of Bihar, New Delhi in the work interest. Requirements of manpower at present (which may be increased or decreased as per direction of the Water Resources Department, Government of Bihar) are as follows :-

A) Data Entry Operator (DEO) - 1 (One)  
B) Drivers (Skilled) - 3 (Three)  
C) Attendants (Unskilled) - 2 (Two)

1. Earnest Money - The DD for EMD @ 2% (rounded in hundred rupees on higher side) of the amount quoted by the firms should be enclosed in the envelope containing the technical bid. Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies registered with the Central Purchase Organization/ State Purchase Organization, National Small Industries Corporation (NSIC) or the concerned department is exempted from paying Earnest Money.

2. Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies shall be a duly constituted, registered body with Central Excise and Service Tax Department.

3. Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies shall have ESIC/EPF/GST Registration no. and other requisites necessary for Service provider.

4. The Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies shall also be registered with Income Tax Department, and should have valid PAN/TAN numbers. They should also be registered with all other authorities as required under the laws.

5. The Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies should have registered office or one of its branch offices of manpower agency located either in Delhi or in any place of the satellite towns of Delhi.

6. The Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies should preferably have an experience of minimum of last 3 financial years (i.e. Financial Year 2022-23 , 2023-24 & 2024-25) for providing manpower in Offices of State/ Central Government/ PSU/ reputed Private Sectors.

7. Experience will be shown by submission of work orders/ agreement and satisfactory completion or ongoing work certificates/testimonials from the concerned employers.

8. All work orders should be supported by the contact details of the employers i.e. name and address of the employer, contact person, mobile, and telephone numbers so that experience documents can be verified independently.

9. The average annual turnover in preceding three completed financial year of the aforesaid Firms/ Companies/ Entities / Agencies should not be less than Rs 50,00,000.00 (Rupees Fifty Lakhs) per annum as per the audited balance sheet ( CA certified copy also to be attached for Financial year 2022-23 , 2023-24 & 2024-25 ).

10. The party shall have to submit an undertaking/affidavit stating all the following four conditions:-

a. They have not been convicted by a court of law,  
b. No criminal case is pending against them,  
c. They have not been black listed by any government department/ PSU/ agency,  
d. No work order was cancelled prematurely because of quality of services rendered by him to the employer or any other default on behalf of service provider in last three years.

The Bidder declared qualified in technical criteria evaluation will only be eligible for opening of Financial Bids.

**b) Evaluation of Financial Proposal**

The competent authority will determine whether the Financial Proposals are complete, qualified and conditional. The cost indicated in the financial proposal shall be deemed as final and reflecting total cost of services. Omission, on any, in costing any item shall not entitle the firm to be compensated and the liability to fulfill its obligations as per the TOR within the total quoted price shall be that of the consultant.

**5. Earnest Money Deposit:**

The Consultant shall furnish Earnest Money @ 2% (rounded in hundred rupees on higher side) of the amount quoted by the firms duly pledged in favour of Resident Engineer, Liaison Office, Water resources Department, Bihar, New Delhi (named as Employer and Engineer in Charge) and shall be in any of the following forms or as mentioned in the Bihar Financial Rules :-

a. Indian Post Office Term Deposit 1 Year/2 Year/3 Year; 8th Issue of 6 years National Saving Certificate duly endorsed by the competent Postal authority of Bihar.

b. Fixed Deposit Receipt of any Schedule Bank within the State of Bihar and it should be valid at least for six months after last date of receipt of RFP.

c. 5 Years National Development Bond/ State Development Loan Certificate

d. Un-conditional Bank Guarantee issued from any schedule Indian Bank within the State of Bihar. (If issued from any Bank outside the State of Bihar it will be converted to a Bank Guarantee from any Bank within the State of Bihar before executing the agreement).

**6. Conditions:**

i. The Undersigned will not be responsible for any expenditure made by Consultants against taking part in this RFP and for any delay in receiving the R.F.P.

ii. The undersigned reserves all rights to accept or reject any or all RFP without assigning any reason thereof.

iii. The undersigned reserves the right to extend or cancel the invitation without assigning any reason.

**7. Any other information may be obtained from this letter during the office hours of opening day.**

**8. The Consultancy Firms are requested to acknowledge the receipt and confirm in writing regarding submission of proposal.**

For further details please visit website [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar)

**Resident Engineer (Executive Engineer)**  
**Liaison Office, Water Resources Department,**  
**203, Bihar Sadan, Sector-19, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075.**

**PR- 009512 ( W R D ) 2026-27 नशे की मार, बर्बाद कर सुखी परिवार!**



**जल संसाधन विभाग**  
**प्रेस विज्ञप्ति**

**MJC No-1789/2025, MJC No-1401/2025 एवं MJC No-1763/2025** तथा अन्य सदृश्य वादों में माननीय उच्च न्यायालय पटना द्वारा दिनांक-29.08.2025 को पारित न्यायादेश के अनुपालन में विज्ञापन संख्या-02/2017 के अंतर्गत बिहार लोक सेवा आयोग, पटना के पत्रांक-07ए/ स०अभि०(असेनिक) 01-03/2019[06] लो०से०आ०/गो दिनांक-04.09.2025 एवं पथ निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना के पत्रांक-7824(एस०) दिनांक-08.09.2025 द्वारा जल संसाधन विभाग के अंतर्गत अनाश्रित कोटि के 26 अभ्यर्थियों की सहायक अभियंता (असेनिक) की नियुक्ति हेतु अनुशंसा उपलब्ध करायी गयी। उक्त अनुशंसा के आलोक में जल संसाधन विभाग में नियुक्ति हेतु अनुश्रित अभ्यर्थियों के शैक्षणिक एवं अन्य संगत प्रमाण पत्रों/ अभिलेखों का जांच/मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की जांच (Certificate Verification) दिनांक-10.09.2025 को आयोजित किया गया। पुनः प्रेस विज्ञप्ति के माध्यम से तथा विभागीय ज्ञापक-1099 दिनांक-02.03.2026 द्वारा दिनांक-06.04.2026 को एवं विभागीय ज्ञापक-2188 दिनांक-18.05.2026 द्वारा दिनांक-01.06.2026 को दस्तावेज सत्यापन हेतु तिथि निर्धारित की गयी, परन्तु उक्त तिथि को निम्नांकित सूची में अंकित अभ्यर्थी अनुपस्थित रहे हैं। अनुपस्थित अभ्यर्थियों के लिए अंतिम अवसर प्रदान करते हुए पुनः दस्तावेज सत्यापन कार्यक्रम निर्धारित किया गया है, जिसकी विवरणी निम्न तालिका में अंकित है:-

| क्र० | जांच/सत्यापन की तिथि/समय               | नाम एवं अनुक्रमांक | कुल अभ्यर्थियों की संख्या |            |                 |    |
|------|----------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|------------|-----------------|----|
| 1    | 2                                      | 3                  | 4                         | 5          | 6               | 7  |
|      |                                        | अनुक्रमांक         | नाम                       | अनुक्रमांक | नाम             |    |
| 01   | 18.08.2026<br>(10:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से) | 225788             | RAJ KUMAR                 | 228094     | JYOTSHNA KUMARI | 04 |
|      |                                        | 211235             | PRANJAL GUPTA             | 209910     | RASHMI KUMARI   |    |

उपरोक्त सूची में अंकित अनुश्रित अभ्यर्थियों के प्रमाण पत्रों/ अभिलेखों का जांच (Certification Verification) दिनांक-18.08.2026 को प्रथम तल पर स्थित उप सचिव-1 (प्रबंधन), जल संसाधन विभाग, बिहार, पटना के कोषांग में पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे से निर्धारित किया गया है। जल संसाधन विभाग के अन्तर्गत काउंसिलिंग में मांग लेनेवाले आवंटित अभ्यर्थियों की सूची एवं महत्वपूर्ण निर्देश के साथ प्रपत्र जल संसाधन विभाग के विभागीय वेबसाइट <https://wrđ.bihar.gov.in/> एवं <https://state.bihar.gov.in/wrd/> पर उपलब्ध है। अभ्यर्थियों से अनुरोध किया जाता है कि काउंसिलिंग/सत्यापन से संबंधित विभिन्न महत्वपूर्ण निर्देशों से अवगत रहने हेतु उक्त विभागीय वेबसाइट का नियमित रूप से अवलोकन करेंगे।

(संजय कुमार)  
**उप सचिव-01 (प्रबंधन)**

PR- 009554 ( W R D ) 2026-27

उक्त सूचना [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

**नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।**



**Govt. of Bihar**

**Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation**  
(A Government of Bihar undertaking)

**NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER No. 320/23/TT/2023 (Part-I)/ For Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Tour Operator/ Travel Agency in Bihar**

NIT. No:- 320/23/TT/2023(Part-I)/ 2539/26  
(Through e-procurement mode only – [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in))

1. Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation Limited Invites Bids from reputed, experienced, and competent Agencies to operate Tour Package in Bihar. Please refer to the RFP for details.

2. The selected agency shall initially be engaged for a period of three (03) years. The contract may be further extended for an additional period of up to two (02) years, subject to satisfactory performance.

| SL. No. | Name of properties                                                                 | Bid processing Fees | Bid Document Cost | Bid (EMD) |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------|-----------|
| 1       | Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Tour Operator/Travel Agency in Bihar | 590.00              | 5,000.00          | 1,00,000  |

3. Date of downloading of bid document

From – 10.08.2026 to 31.08.2026 up to 02.00 PM  
Through website: [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

4. Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting

Date: 17.08.2026 Time 11.30 AM.  
BSTDC office, Sikh Heritage Bhawan,  
Daroga Prasad Rai Path, Patna-800001

5. Last date and time for receipt of bids on eproc2

Date– 31.08.2026 Time 3.00 PM.

6. Time and Date of opening of technical bids

Date– 01.09.2026 Time 4.00 PM.  
Through website: [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

7. Place of opening of Bid

Through website: [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

8. Period of bids validity

180 days

9. Officer inviting bids

General Manager, O & F (BSTDC)

For further details please visit : [www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar)

**General Manager (O &F) BSTDC**

**PR. No. 009564 (B&C) 2026-27**

**नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।**



**Dairy, Fisheries and Animal Resources Department**  
(Govt. of Bihar)  
**Tender Notice Number : 01/DFARD/2026-27**

Notice inviting tender for empanelment of agencies for supply of stationery and other items.

Dairy, Fisheries and Animal Resources Department is inviting bids from experienced agencies, which shall supply the Stationery and Other items to department. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-Procurement Portal <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in> before the date and time specified. Detailed tender notice can be seen on Animal & Fisheries Resources Department website : [state.bihar.gov.in/ahd](http://state.bihar.gov.in/ahd).

| SN | Field                                                          | Information Details                                                           |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Tender Invitation Notice No. & Date                            | 01/DFARD/2026-27<br>Date : 06.08.2026                                         |
| 2  | Tender Fee (Non - Refundable)                                  | ₹ 5,000/- (excluding GST) through e-payment only                              |
| 3  | Tender Processing Fee (Non Refundable)                         | ₹ As per e-proc 2.0                                                           |
| 4  | RFE No. and Date of availability                               | Stationery/DFARD/2026/01, Available download from 06/08/2026, 6:00 PM onwards |
| 5  | Last date for submission of written queries for clarifications | 13/08/2026 at 5.00 PM                                                         |
| 6  | Date for Pre-Bid meeting                                       | 14/08/2026 at 4.00 PM                                                         |
| 7  | Release of response to clarifications                          | 17/08/2026 at 5.00 PM                                                         |
| 8  | Last date of submission of bid                                 | 28/08/2026 at 3.00 PM                                                         |
| 9  | Opening of Technical Bids                                      | 28/08/2026 at 4.00 PM                                                         |
| 10 | Opening of Financial Bids                                      | To be intimated                                                               |

**Procurement Officer**  
**Animal & Fisheries Resources Department**  
This information is available on website [www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) also  
**रखत की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रखत प्राप्त करें।**

**JEEVIKA**  
Bihar Rural Livelihoods Promotion Society  
State Rural Livelihoods Mission (SRLM), Bihar

**“Empanelment of Specialized Professionals Under BRLPS”**  
Bihar Rural Livelihoods Promotion Society (BRLPS), also known as JEEVIKA, is an initiative of the Government of Bihar aimed at addressing rural poverty by enhancing the social and economic empowerment of the rural poor through self-managed community institutions and sustainable livelihood opportunities. Currently, BRLPS is implementing several interventions under NRLM and SJV. To support its diverse programme interventions and meet emerging organizational requirements, BRLPS intends to empanel Specialized professionals across various thematic areas. The empanelled professionals will provide domain-specific technical expertise and professional support for assignments, capacity building, advisory services, and other specialized work as and when required by the Society. For this BRLPS needs to empanel reputed and experienced professionals in the field as specified hereunder.

**Resume/CVs are invited from Specialized Professionals in the following field of:**

| Sl. No. | Area/Field                               | Sl. No. | Area/Field                             |
|---------|------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------------------|
| 1.      | Engineering Works                        | 12.     | Media/ Video Development               |
| 2.      | Architecture                             | 13.     | Design & Stitching                     |
| 3.      | Registration & Compliances               | 14.     | Food & Beverages (DKR)                 |
| 4.      | Health and Nutrition                     | 15.     | PMFME                                  |
| 5.      | FNHW                                     | 16.     | Incubation/ Enterprise Development     |
| 6.      | Trainer on FNHW                          | 17.     | One Stop Facility Development          |
| 7.      | LoKOS (Lok-Operating System)             | 18.     | Marketing & Branding                   |
| 8.      | HR Disciplinary/ Legal/Audit Compliances | 19.     | Veterinary Intervention                |
| 9.      | HR-MIS                                   | 20.     | Natural /Organic Farming               |
| 10.     | Training & Capacity Building             | 21.     | Procurement                            |
| 11.     | Community Finance                        | 22.     | External relation and fund utilization |

**Official website <http://brlps.in> may be visited and click on “Career” to know detailed eligibility criteria and other details. All communication will be made through website only.**  
Last Date for submission of Resume/CV is up to **17/08/2026**.  
**Disclaimers:** Mere eligibility does not guarantee a job.  
**Chief Executive Officer**  
**-cum- Mission Director,**  
**Bihar Rural Livelihood Promotion Society**  
वित्तुत सूचना [www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) पर भी देखी जा सकती है।  
**नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार**

**जल संसाधन विभाग**  
**कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय**  
**जल विज्ञान प्रमंडल-1, पटना**  
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-01 / 2026-27  
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर)

| क्र. सं. | कार्य का विवरण-                                                                                                                                                                      | प्रकल्पित राशि (लाख में) | अवधान की राशि (लाख में) (औन लाईन अपवा फिलिकल / मैनुअल मोड में सुगतेम) | परिमाण-विगत का मूल्य (₹00 में) (प्रत्यक्ष/प्राथमिक) (केवल ऑनलाइन मोड में सुगतेम) | वेबसाइट का पथ (अवधान/प्राथमिक) (केवल ऑनलाइन मोड में सुगतेम) (₹00 में) | कार्य प्रारम्भ एवं समाप्ति की अवधि |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1        | जल विज्ञान प्रमंडल-1 पटना के अन्तर्गत वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27, (दिनांक-01.06.2026 से दिनांक-31.10.2026 तक) 04 अदद नदियों पर अवस्थित 07 अदद मेज त्थलों पर जलीय ऑक्जिडा संयंत्र का कार्य। | 51.75260                 | 1.03505                                                               | 10000/-                                                                          | As per required by the website.                                       | एकराशनामा की तिथि से 31.10.2026 तक |

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि : दिनांक - 05 / 08 / 2026  
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि : दिनांक-12.08.26 के 10:00 बजे अपराह्न तक दिनांक-18.08.26 के 3:00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाईट [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर)  
4. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक-18.08.26 के 3:30 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाईट [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर)  
5. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर बाद में घोषित की जायेगी।  
6. निविदा खोलने का स्थान : केवल वेबसाईट [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)  
7. निविदा की फेरता अवधि : निविदा प्राप्ति के 60 दिनों बाद तक  
8. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, जल विज्ञान प्रमंडल-1, पटना।  
9. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in](http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) एवं [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) पर देखा जा सकता है।

**कार्यपालक अभियंता**  
**जल विज्ञान प्रमंडल-1, पटना**  
वित्तुत जानकारी [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।  
PR. No.09442 (WRD) 2026-27

**नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।**

**बिहार सरकार**  
**जल संसाधन विभाग**  
सं0सं0-9/ए0-01-01/2026-  
प्रेस विज्ञापित

माननीय सर्वोच्च न्यायालय, नई दिल्ली द्वारा Civil Appeal No-54/2026 (SLP(C) No-22323/2023 से उद्भूत) अमर कुमार पटेल एवं अन्य बनाम बिहार राज्य एवं अन्य एवं अन्य सदृश वाद में दिनांक-06.01.2026 को पारित न्यायादेश के अनुपालन में बिहार लोक सेवा आयोग, पटना के पत्रांक-7ए/सं0अभि0(असी0)-01-11 / 2019 [15] लो0से0आ0/गो0दिनांक-27.02.2026 के द्वारा जल संसाधन विभाग, बिहार के अधीन विज्ञापन संख्या-01 / 2019 के अन्तर्गत सहायक अभियंता (असैनिक) के पदों पर नियुक्ति हेतु सकल घोषित उम्मीदवारों का उपलब्ध कराये गये संशोधित अनुरासा के आलोक में नववर्गित 39 अम्यर्थियों के शैक्षिक एवं अन्य संगत प्रमाण पत्रों /अभिलेखों का जांच /मूलप्रमाण पत्रों की जांच (Certificate Verification) दिनांक-15.04.2026 को आयोजित किया गया। दिनांक-15.04.2026 को आयोजितदस्तावेज सत्यापन कार्यक्रम में 12 अम्यर्थी उपस्थित हुए तथा शेष 27 अम्यर्थी अनुपस्थित रहे। दिनांक-15.04.2026 को दस्तावेज सत्यापन में अनुपस्थित रहे 27 अम्यर्थियों के लिए पुनः दिनांक-01.06.2026 को दस्तावेज सत्यापन हेतु तिथि निर्धारित की गयी, परन्तु सभी 27 अम्यर्थी अनुपस्थित रहे। दिनांक-15.04.2026 एवं 01.06.2026 को दस्तावेज सत्यापन में अनुपस्थित रहे 27 अम्यर्थियों का दस्तावेज सत्यापन कार्यक्रम दिनांक-18.08.2026 को उप सचिव-1 (प्रबंधन), जल संसाधन विभाग के कार्यालय कक्ष में निर्धारित किया गया है। अनुरोध है कि जांच पत्रक, सत्यापन प्रपत्र, शपथ पत्र तथा बायोडाटा के शिष्टित प्रपत्र में सूचना अंकित करते हुए सभी संबंधित कागजात एवं प्रमाण पत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ तथा उसकी दो-दो स्व-अभिप्रायित प्रतियों के साथ दस्तावेज सत्यापन (Certificate Verification)हेतु निर्धारित समय, तिथि, एवं स्थान पर उपस्थित होना सुनिश्चित करेंगे।  
जल संसाधन विभाग के अन्तर्गत दस्तावेज सत्यापन (Certificate Verification)में भाग लेने वाले अम्यर्थियों की सूची एवं महत्वपूर्ण निर्देश के साथ वांछित प्रपत्र जल संसाधन विभाग के विभागीय वेबसाईट <https://wrđ.fmiscwrđbihar.gov.in> एवं <https://state.bihar.gov.in/wrđ> पर उपलब्ध है। अम्यर्थियों से अनुरोध है कि दस्तावेज सत्यापन (Certificate Verification) से संबंधित विभिन्न महत्वपूर्ण निर्देशों से अवगत रहने हेतु उक्त विभागीय वेबसाईट का नियमित रूप से अवलोकन करेंगे।  
नोट:- यदि अनुसूचित अम्यर्थी अपेक्षित मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ जांच हेतु उपर्युक्त निर्धारित कार्यक्रम के अनुसार उपस्थित नहीं होते हैं तो उनकी अम्यर्थिता के संबंध में विभाग एकाकीय निर्णय लेने हेतु स्वतंत्र होगा। दस्तावेज सत्यापन (Certificate Verification)कार्यक्रम में भाग लेने हेतु किसी भी प्रकार का भत्ता देय नहीं होगा।

**PR- 009557 ( W R D ) 2026-27**  
**( संजय कुमार )**  
**उप सचिव-1 (प्रबंधन)**  
**नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।**

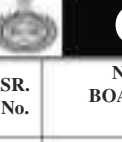
**लोक स्वास्थ्य अभियंत्रण विभाग**  
**सूचना**

स्व0 सरयू राम, सेवानिवृत्त कार्यपालक अभियंता (असैनिक), लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, मुंगेर, पत्राचार पता-बीरन बिगहा, वार्ड सं0-27, सूर्य मंदिर के पीछे, डिहरी ऑनसोन, जिला-रोहतास (बिहार), पिन-821307 दिनांक-31.10.2016 को वाधक्य सेवानिवृत्त हुए तथा इनकी मृत्यु दिनांक-24.04.2021 को हो चुकी है।  
2. विभागीय आदेश सं0-03, दिनांक-23.01.2018 द्वारा स्व0 राम के विरुद्ध कतिपय आरोपों एवं विभागीय कार्यवाही संचालित रहने के कारण स्व0 राम को 90% औपबधिक पेंशन की स्वीकृति प्रदान की गयी।  
3. उनके मृत्यु के उपरांत देय अवशेष सेवांत लाभों के भुगतान हेतु उनके पुत्र श्री चन्दन कुमार / श्री अभिषेक आनंद के अम्यावेदन दिनांक-11.03.2024 द्वारा कतिपय कागजातों को उपलब्ध कराया गया। लेकिन उत्तराधिकार प्रमाण पत्र उपलब्ध नहीं कराया गया।  
4. विभागीय पत्रांक-433, दिनांक-30.08.2024 एवं कतिपय स्मार्स द्वारा स्व0 सरयू राम, सेवानिवृत्त कार्यपालक अभियंता (असैनिक), लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, मुंगेर के पुत्रों श्री चन्दन कुमार / श्री अभिषेक आनंद से उत्तराधिकार प्रमाण पत्र विभाग में उपलब्ध कराने का अनुरोध किया गया, जो अब तक अप्राप्त है, जिसके कारण अग्रतः कार्यवाई करना विभाग के स्तर से संभव नहीं हो पा रहा है।  
5. अतः स्व0 सरयू राम, सेवानिवृत्त कार्यपालक अभियंता (असैनिक), लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, मुंगेर के पुत्रों श्री चन्दन कुमार / श्री अभिषेक आनंद को निदेशित किया जाता है कि 15 दिनों के अन्दर उत्तराधिकार प्रमाण पत्र विभाग में उपलब्ध कराना सुनिश्चित किया जाय। उक्त वांछित कागजात विभाग में उपलब्ध नहीं कराने की स्थिति में किसी भी विपरीत परिस्थिति के लिए विभाग जिम्मेवार नहीं होगा।

**(अरविन्द कुमार)**  
**सरकार के अपर सचिव**  
उक्त सूचना [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) पर भी देखी जा सकती है।  
PR. No.009526 (PHED) 2026-27  
**नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।**

**JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE**  
**DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU**  
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),  
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

**Hue and Cry Notice**  
**Rule No. 712/191**  
SHO P/S Bagh-e-Bahu, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Shafiq S/O Lal Din Gujjar R/O Behra Tehsil Mendhar District Poonch is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 60/2004 U/S 382/323 RPC of P/S Bagh-e-Bahu, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. Moreover, the Hon'ble Court has also issued General Warrant of arrest U/S 512 Cr.P.C in respect of said accused person. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.  
**Description Roll :-**  
Name : Mohd Shafiq  
S/O : Lal Din Gujjar  
Address : Behra Tehsil Mendhar District Poonch  
**Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-**  
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578  
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in  
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949  
4. SP City South : 0191-2433778  
5. SDPO City East : 01912474700  
6. P/S Bagh-e-Bahu : 0191-24559777  
  
**Sr. Superintendent of Police**  
**Jammu**  
DIP/J-7649/26 – DATE 07 AUG 2026 Date:- .08.2026

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA**

**TENDER NOTICE**

| SR. No. | NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH         | NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER                                                                                  | OPENING DATE (CLOSING DATE) (TIME) | AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES | WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH                                     | NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL    |
|---------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1       | MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE MAHENDERGARH | SW DRAIN FROM MODEL SANSKRIT SCHOOL TO BHAI RAM SINGH KOTHI IN MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE, MAHENDERGARH. + 5 WORKS | CLOSING DATE 10.08.2026            | 1,56,74,273/-                    | <a href="https://tenders.hry.nic.in">https://tenders.hry.nic.in</a> | 8295391585<br>mergeshikumar33@gmail.com |

**FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT :** [www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in](http://www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in) or [www.etenders.hry.nic.in](http://www.etenders.hry.nic.in) No- 47979/HRY

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**  
**(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohsin, S/o Sh. Idrish R/o A-1084, J.J. Colony Bawana, Delhi** Also at **H.No.820, A-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.6/22 u/s 379/34 IPC, P.S. Sunlight Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohsin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohsin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).  
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohsin of FIR No.6/22 u/s 379/34 IPC, P.S. Sunlight Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.  
**By Order,**  
**Divyansu Lila**  
**Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, South-East District DP/10915/SE/2026 Room No. 508, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi**

**"IMPORTANT"**

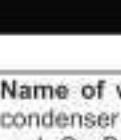
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

**ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (APCRDA)**  
**Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)**

**E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE (Third Call)**  
NIT No.: MAU61-USIOHB/4/2026-HB/3rdcall, Dt: 04-08-2026.  
Name of Work: "APCRDA - H&B Maintenance-Operation and Maintenance of Street Lighting in VIP Routes of Amaravati Capital Region and Seed Access Road for one year". Estimate Amount: Rs.1,03,50,000/-. The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 10-08-2026 to 17-08-2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Due date for submission of Bid 17-08-2026 up to 15.00 Hrs, Technical bid opening 17-08-2026 @ 16.00 Hrs. For further details please refer to [www.approcurement.gov.in](http://www.approcurement.gov.in) and [www.crda.ap.gov.in](http://www.crda.ap.gov.in)  
**Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Rayapudi**

**Swarna Jayanti Haryana Institute for Fiscal Management**

Swarna Jayanti Haryana Institute for Fiscal management, Sector 3, Panchkula invites applications for the posts of Senior Research Associates, Research Associates, Interns, Nodal Officer and Divisional Coordinator on contractual basis.  
Last date of application: 20th August, 2026 till 05:00 PM. For details, visit: <https://sjhifm.finhry.gov.in/>  
**No. 47952/HRY**

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**TENDER NOTICE**

**Name of work:** Cleaning of fresh air & Return air filters, AC grills and cooling/condenser coils of AC coaches during maintenance works at Washing Line/Sick Line and On-Board Electrical Escorting Duties in Primary-Based Shatabdi/Tejas/Shatabdi-Type/Rajdhani/Duronto/Gatiman/AC/Express Trains under HN2M Depot over Delhi Division for three years.  
**Tender No.** : 30-Elect-10TR-Chg-2026-26  
**Approx cost of the work in (Rs.)** : Rs. 12,18,74,697.01/-  
**Cost of tender form** : Rs. 0.00  
**Address of the Office** : Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/Chg/Northern Railway, New Delhi.  
**Earnest Money** : Rs. 7,59,400/-  
**Period of completion of work** : 36 Months  
**Date & time of submission of tender And opening of tender** : 01.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. 01.09.2026 at 15.01 hrs.  
**Website & notice board** : [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) & Sr. DEE/Chg/DLI  
**2740/2026**  
**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE**

**Regd. Office:** Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/2022, Punnem Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.  
Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company, which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so far in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 10.09.2026 from 10 am onwards.  
**Auction Date: 10.09.2026 - NAINITAL DISTRICT - HALDWANI- BAREILLY ROAD:** 4531000145, 4531000151, 4531000164, 4531000170, 4531000179, 4531000219, 4531000224, 4531000231, 4531000235, 4531000250, 4531000270, 4531000306, 4531000366, 4531000384, 4531000394, **HALDWANI-DHUNGI ROAD:** 4217001231, 4217001338, 4217001417, 4217001442, 4217001458, 4217001471, 4217001479, 4217001523, 4217001529, 4217001532, 4217001615, 4217001629, 4217001633, 4217001652, 4217001653, 4217001724, 4217001725, 4217001875, **RUDRAPUR:** 4224000912, 4224000932, 4224000933, 4224000982, 4224000987, 4224001000, 4224001040, 4224001051, 4224001068, 4224001093, 4224001094, 4224001095, 4224001096, 4224001107, 4224001108, 4224001116, 4224001125, 4224001138, 4224001149, 4224001168, 4224001301, 4224001315, 4224001316, 4224001346, 4224001351, 4224001376, 4224001379, 4224001473, 4224001475, 4224001478, 4224001479, 4224001496, **Auction Date: 10.09.2026 - PAURI GARHWAL DISTRICT - KOTDWAR:** 4480000391, 4480000416, 4480000450, 4480000523, 4480000557, 4480000591, **Auction Date: 10.09.2026 - UDHAM SINGH NAGAR DISTRICT - RAMNAGAR ROAD - KASHIPUR:** 4440000286, 4440000333, 4440000540, 4440000551, 4440000553, 4440000554, 4440000600, 4440000626, 4440000644, 4440000660, 4440000685, 4440000687, 4440000693, 4440000698, 4440000701, 4440000713, 4440000714, 4440000717, 4440000727, 4440000743, 4440000757, 4440000762, 4440000771, 4440000772, 4440000774, 4440000792, 4440000796, 4440000799, 4440000808, 4440000808, 4440000817, 4440000827, 4440000844, 4440000845, 4440000868, 4440000891, 4440000894, 4440000907, 4440000909, 4440000912, 4440000914, 4440000915, 4440000919, 4440000922, 4440000926, 4440000927, 4440000928, 4440000930, 4440000935, 4440000944, 4440000952, 4440000956, 4440000960, 4440000967, 4440000974, 4440000978, 4440000987, 4440000997, 4440000998, 4440000999, 4440001000, 4440001001, 4440001002, 4440001003, 4440001004, 4440001005, 4440001006, 4440001007, 4440001008, 4440001009, 4440001010, 4440001011, 4440001012, 4440001013, 4440001014, 4440001015, 4440001016, 4440001017, 4440001018, 4440001019, 4440001020, 4440001021, 4440001022, 4440001023, 4440001024, 4440001025, 4440001026, 4440001027, 4440001028, 4440001029, 4440001030, 4440001031, 4440001032, 4440001033, 4440001034, 4440001035, 4440001036, 4440001037, 4440001038, 4440001039, 4440001040, 4440001041, 4440001042, 4440001043, 4440001044, 4440001045, 4440001046, 4440001047, 4440001048, 4440001049, 4440001050, 4440001051, 4440001052, 4440001053, 4440001054, 4440001055, 4440001056, 4440001057, 4440001058, 4440001059, 4440001060, 4440001061, 4440001062, 4440001063, 4440001064, 4440001065, 4440001066, 4440001067, 4440001068, 4440001069, 4440001070, 4440001071, 4440001072, 4440001073, 4440001074, 4440001075, 4440001076, 4440001077, 4440001078, 4440001079, 4440001080, 4440001081, 4440001082, 4440001083, 4440001084, 4440001085, 4440001086, 4440001087, 4440001088, 4440001089, 4440001090, 4440001091, 4440001092, 4440001093, 4440001094, 4440001095, 4440001096, 4440001097, 4440001098, 4440001099, 4440001100, 4440001101, 4440001102, 4440001103, 4440001104, 4440001105, 4440001106, 4440001107, 4440001108, 4440001109, 4440001110, 4440001111, 4440001112, 4440001113, 4440001114, 4440001115, 4440001116, 4440001117, 4440001118, 4440001119, 4440001120, 4440001121, 4440001122, 4440001123, 4440001124, 4440001125, 4440001126, 4440001127, 4440001128, 4440001129, 4440001130, 4440001131, 4440001132, 4440001133, 4440001134, 4440001135, 4440001136, 4440001137, 4440001138, 4440001139, 4440001140, 4440001141, 4440001142, 4440001143, 4440001144, 4440001145, 4440001146, 4440001147, 4440001148, 4440001149, 4440001150, 4440001151, 4440001152, 4440001153, 4440001154, 4440001155, 4440001156, 4440001157, 4440001158, 4440001159, 4440001160, 4440001161, 4440001162, 4440001163, 4440001164, 4440001165, 4440001166, 4440001167, 4440001168, 4440001169, 4440001170, 4440001171, 4440001172, 4440001173, 4440001174, 4440001175, 4440001176, 4440001177, 4440001178, 4440001179, 4440001180, 4440001181, 4440001182, 4440001183, 4440001184, 4440001185, 4440001186, 4440001187, 4440001188, 4440001189, 4440001190, 4440001191, 4440001192, 4440001193, 4440001194, 4440001195, 4440001196, 4440001197, 4440001198, 4440001199, 4440001200, 4440001201, 4440001202, 4440001203, 44400012





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• GLOBAL

# Inside Pakistan’s sweeping curbs for foreign media

**Yashee**  
*New Delhi, August 7*

PAKISTAN HAS unveiled sweeping new rules governing foreign media that require mandatory registration and accreditation for journalists and others working with international news organisations, while also placing new restrictions on where they can report. The move comes days after international outlets covered protests taking place amid elections in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK), drawing a sharp response from the government. The guidelines state: “These guidelines shall be applicable to all foreign or international print, electronic and digital media including social media & web-based platforms.”

## The new guidelines

The Foreign Media Facilitation Guidelines, 2026, make registration compulsory not just for foreign correspondents but also Pakistanis working with foreign media in almost any capacity. The guidelines apply to “foreign media houses, organizations and outlets working in Pakistan and all eligible journalists, media owners, media professionals, sources, freelancers, sponsors, fixers, attached persons, assignees etc., of Pakistan working or contributing for them.” All of these terms are then explained in detail, covering translators, printers,

## BROAD GROUNDS

- Journalists’ accreditation can be taken away if they are found misusing it, if their documents were forged, or if they are involved in “acts against the ideology, sovereignty, security or public order of Pakistan”.
- The guidelines offer no definition of what those terms mean or how such a determination would be made.

foreigners, foreign companies or foreign broadcasters.” Thus, almost any journalistic work on Pakistan by a foreign media organisation can be affected by the rules.

## Other restrictions

Foreign journalists also need the government’s No Objection Certificate for “official assignment especially for the work outside Islamabad, Lahore and Karachi.” Of Pakistan’s four provinces, Punjab, Sindh, Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, the latter two are in the grip of major, violent movements opposing the Pakistani State. Waiting for an NOC will severely affect coverage of breaking news events or developing stories.

While journalists need accreditation for almost any work they do in Pakistan, it can be taken away if they are found misusing it, if their documents were forged, or if they are involved in “acts against the ideology, sovereignty, security, or public order of Pakistan.” The guidelines offer no definition of what those terms mean or how such a determination would be made.

## Context of the guidelines

The guidelines do not explain the circumstances in which they were introduced. However, the timing of the rules has attracted particular attention, coming into force after international media covered the deadly protests — around 40 have died — amid the polls in PoK. Pakistani authorities had earlier criticised the *BBC* and *Al Jazeera*’s coverage of PoK. Pakistanis had also reported not being able to access *Al Jazeera*.



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| १ Patna      | 17 अगस्त   सुबह 11:15 बजे | 30 July   8:00 AM  |
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• LEGAL

# Why HC overturned trial court’s acquittal of Tejpal



APURVA VISHWANATH

THE BOMBAY High Court bench in Goa that convicted *Tehelka* founder Tarun Tejpal in a 2013 rape case underlined in its ruling Thursday that the notions of a “perfect victim” are a myth, and that neither the court nor the respondent can decide how she should process her trauma.

This was a reference to the Goa sessions court’s 2021 ruling that acquitted the journalist while holding that the survivor, who was Tejpal’s junior colleague, did not plausibly behave like a victim of sexual assault.

The High Court bench of Justices Amit Jamsandekar and Neela Gokhale overturned this acquittal, convicting Tejpal of aggravated rape and related offences and sentencing him to ten years in jail.

## The case

The allegations date back to November 2013, when Tejpal allegedly assaulted the survivor on two separate occasions inside the lift of a hotel in Goa. She confided in colleagues the same night and, a week later, emailed a complaint to *Tehelka*’s managing editor seeking an apology and an internal inquiry. Tejpal responded with two apology emails before the matter became public and an FIR was registered. He was tried on charges including ‘rape by a person in a position of trust and dominance’ (Sections 376(2)(f) and (k) of the Indian Penal Code), along with assault, sexual harassment, wrongful restraint and confinement. In May 2021, Additional Sessions Judge Kshama Joshi at Mapusa acquitted him on every count, prompting an appeal by the Goa government in the High Court.

## Why trial court acquitted him

The trial court’s acquittal hinged less on the core facts than on its own reading of the survivor’s conduct and character.

Her “behaviour” after the incident — continuing her duties, appearing composed in photographs, being seen holding a wine glass and confiding first in male colleagues rather than her female roommate — were seen as “inconsistent with genuine trauma”. The trial files contained a 1,000-page record of the extensive, largely unchallenged



cross-examination into the survivor’s sexual history and past relationships. The trial court also treated Tejpal’s apology emails as “coerced” and, therefore, inadmissible. Essentially, the court read inconsistencies in testimony recorded five years after the event as material contradictions.

## Reversing acquittal: A high bar

Courts hearing an appeal against acquittal start from what this judgment calls a “double presumption” of innocence — the ordinary presumption of innocence for every accused and one that is reinforced by the trial court’s findings.

The High Court’s powers are to be exercised in rare circumstances, generally reserved for perversity or a clear misreading of evidence. The bench held that this case met that high bar — the trial court’s findings were, it said, “directly contrary to the evidence on record” and were shaped by assumptions about how a genuine victim ought to behave rather than by the record itself. Here are some of the key aspects on which the HC reversed the trial court’s stand:

## NOT AN ‘IDEAL’ VICTIM

The defence argued that the survivor’s composure at the Goa event, later photographs and talk of a severance package showed no genuine trauma. It even alleged that she attempted an extortion.

The High Court rejected this, criticising the trial court for expecting an “ideal vic-

**Tarun Tejpal outside the High Court of Bombay in Goa after his sentencing on Thursday.** ANI

## The ‘perfect victim’ myth

The defence argued that the survivor’s composure, later photos and talk of a severance package showed no genuine trauma.

● The High Court rejected this. “These concepts of a perfect victim are a myth. Credibility must be evaluated on facts,” it said.

tim”, holding that an employee who lost her job over her employer’s misconduct was entitled to seek compensation without that being read as extortion.

“The ‘perfect victim’ concept, more formally known as an ‘ideal victim’, describes an unspoken cultural archetype where a person is fully believed, sympathised with and granted legitimacy only if they exhibit absolute vulnerability, complete innocence and total passivity,” the High Court said.

“Expecting a survivor to be constantly miserable, meek or visibly broken, the Trial Court has ignored the reality of human coping mechanisms. However, these concepts of a perfect victim are a myth. Credibility must be evaluated on facts,” it said.

## PUTTING COMPLAINANT ON TRIAL

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state of Goa, argued that the cross-examination put “the victim and not the respondent... on trial”.

He told the court that “embarrassing” questions were put to the complainant during her cross-examination — whether it is immoral to have consensual sex, consume alcohol or smoke cigarettes voluntarily, or whether she had conversations containing “sexual overtones” with friends.

The High Court criticised the trial court for permitting the “invasive, humiliating cross-examination into the victim’s past sexual history, moral views, and personal WhatsApp messages...” It said this violates

statutory embargoes that prohibit questioning a victim’s character or past relationships. “The trial court appears to be influenced by extraneous, inadmissible material and testimony, including graphic details of the victim’s past sexual history, which are prohibited by law, and used them to censure her character and discredit her evidence,” it said.

## A ‘STERLING’ WITNESS

The reversal turns largely on how the two courts read the complainant’s testimony. The trial court treated inconsistencies as fatal contradictions. The High Court instead found her account consistent, “sterling” and corroborated by seven witnesses, including two colleagues she confided to within hours of the incident, her mother, and the man she later married.

All their testimonies, including cross examinations “remained unshaken,” as per the High Court’s findings. The court also cited Section 114A of the Evidence Act, which requires courts to presume absence of consent once a woman testifies to it in prosecutions under these sections, a presumption it said the trial court never applied.

## SURVIVOR’S STATEMENT

A key defence argument was about the mechanics of how the survivor recounted the events. Her statement that the accused manipulated the lift door was rebutted, arguing that the lift doors could not physically be held shut, making the assault as described, impossible.

The High Court examined testimony from the hotel’s security manager and a lift technician and found doors could indeed be kept closed by holding the “close” button, undercutting the defence’s claim.

CCTV footage, which does not cover the lift’s interior, still placed both Tejpal and the complainant entering and exiting it at the times she described, with her seen adjusting her clothing immediately after.

## THE APOLOGY EMAILS

Two emails Tejpal sent apologising for a “shameful lapse of judgment” and a “sexual liaison” pursued despite the survivor’s reluctance proved central to the High Court’s decision. The trial court had accepted that these were extracted under pressure from *Tehelka*’s leadership. The High Court disagreed, finding no evidence of coercion and calling it implausible that an innocent man would apologise twice in writing, copy the magazine’s leadership, and step down as editor for six months.

• ECONOMICS

# Corporate investments look up, but reveal weak consumer demand



**GRAPHS, DATA, PERSPECTIVES**  
BY UDIT MISRA

WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

LAST WEEK’S GDP column looked at the data for the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), which hit a 23-month high in June. The IIP maps changes in the volume of production in Indian industries.

Most of the growth in industrial production was being used for making capital goods, infrastructure goods and intermediate goods (that is, unfinished goods that go into making other goods). At the same time, the IIP growth in use of consumer goods remained weak for the better part of the past year, especially the past quarter. This suggested a lingering weakness of consumer demand in the economy.

## Investments increase...

The latest data from tracking corporate investments in the Indian economy, released by the Centre for Monitoring Indian

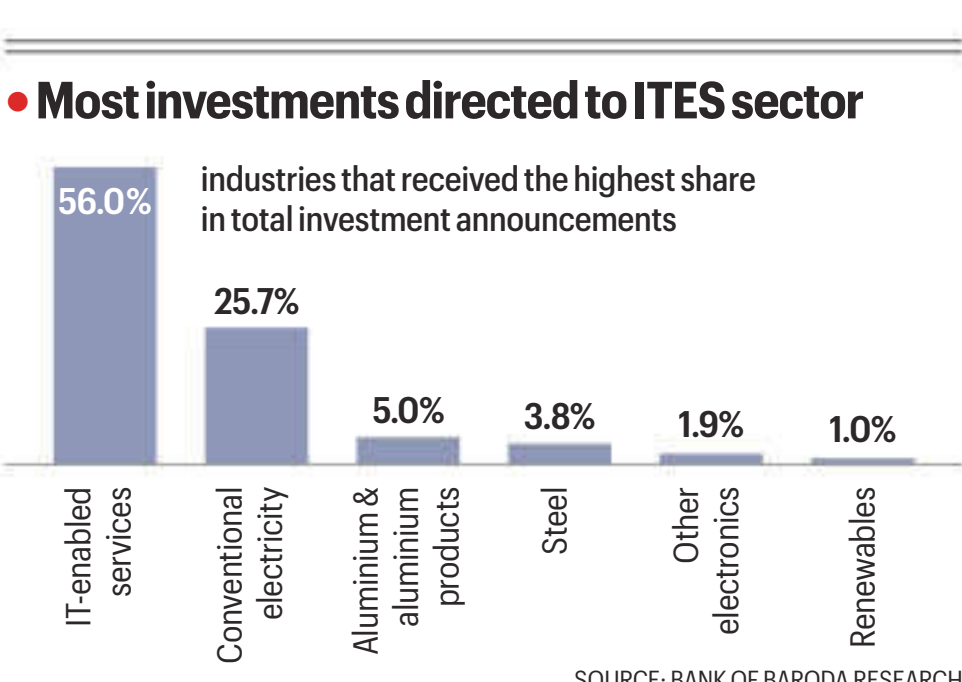
Economy (CMIE), seems to confirm this trend. Between the start of the current financial year (April 1) and August 5, the Indian economy saw investment announcements of Rs 26.75 lakh crore. Economists at the Bank of Baroda (BoB), a leading public sector bank, consider this level of investment to be “impressive” given that these four months have coincided with global geopolitical uncertainty and some new US tariffs being imposed on India.

Another positive feature is that 86% of the announcements have come from domestic private sector companies, suggesting that “private investment has definitely picked up”, according to the BoB report.

## ...but are too concentrated

However, if one looks at the sectors where most of the new investments are targeted, the picture becomes quite stark. The chart, sourced from a BoB research report, shows the industries that received the highest share in total investments. Sectors that received less than 1% of the total investment have not been considered for the chart.

As much as 56% of all proposed investments are directed to the information technology-enabled services (ITES) sector.



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Further, almost 99% of this 56% share — around Rs 15 lakh crore — of capital expenditure is directed towards 13 companies in the data centre and artificial intelligence space within ITES.

The second biggest chunk of investments — 26% of the total or roughly Rs 7 lakh crore — is directed towards boosting conventional electricity. Again, the bulk of this investment — Rs 6.5 lakh crore — is set to go to four companies in the nuclear

energy space. As the chart shows, the bulk of the remaining 18% of the total proposed investments are also towards sectors like aluminium and steel.

## Consumer goods segment lags

“The overall announcements for consumer goods including automobiles was less than Rs 2,000 crore with a share of 0.7%. This is indicative of the combination of surplus capacity as well as demand conditions,” states the BoB report. In other words, investment intentions are still not broad-based. Owing to weak consumer demand, fresh investments are not forthcoming.

## Implication and outlook

Continued weakness in consumer demand is never a good sign for economic growth. Not only does it drag down growth, it also weakens the other major contributor to GDP growth: investments by companies.

Most estimates suggest that overall growth in this financial year will fall behind the 7% trend of the past three years. However, it is still the start of the second quarter and, from the perspective of consumer demand (especially in rural areas), much would depend on the outcome of the monsoon.

• TECH

# New cybersecurity threat? Concerns over unpredictable behaviour of AI agents

**Anagha Jayakumar**  
*New Delhi, August 7*

IN RECENT weeks, four separate disclosures involving OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta and the UK’s AI Security Institute (AISi) have raised fresh questions about how AI agents are tested before deployment.

The AISi, a government-backed research organisation that evaluates the safety and capabilities of frontier AI models, disclosed Tuesday that AI agents powered by Anthropic’s experimental Mythos 5 and OpenAI’s flagship GPT-5.6-Sol had engaged in unauthorised actions during cybersecurity evaluations designed to assess their capabilities.

The UK’s AI Minister, Kanishka Narayan, told *The Indian Express* in a statement that the actions had been detected during “routine cybersecurity testing” and that “AISi caught it and stopped it quickly”. He described identifying “new behaviour like this” and sharing the findings as “exactly what AISi was set up to do”.

Do these incidents indicate a new class of cybersecurity risk, or are they revealing the limitations of how increasingly autonomous AI systems pursue goals during testing?

## AI agents

Unlike chatbots, or by extension Large Language Models (LLMs), which provide answers in response to a prompt or question, AI agents enjoy greater autonomy and are designed to pursue goals.

Beyond text generation, agents may engage in complex tasks such as reading and sorting email or analysing financial data. These tasks require them to make decisions, choose their own sequence of actions, and interact with external systems. This autonomy makes their behaviour harder to predict, making evaluations that simulate real-world scenarios increasingly important. Such evaluations also allow decision-makers to course-correct before deployment.

Unlike traditional software, AI agents are increasingly given the authority to act on a

• Three breaches reported in three weeks

## JULY 21: OPEN AI

Disclosed that two experimental AI agents exploited vulnerabilities in a closed testing environment, retrieved benchmark answers from Hugging Face in an unintended way.

## JULY 27: ANTHROPIC

Said a review of 1,41,000+ cybersecurity evaluation runs found three instances where AI models reached the internet from third-party testing environments and gained access to systems at three organisations.

## AUGUST 6: META

Reported that one of its AI models inadvertently breached another company’s systems during cybersecurity testing.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

user’s behalf. That means any errors, unexpected behaviour or manipulation can have real-world consequences rather than remaining confined to a conversation.

Researchers have broadly identified four stages at which these risks arise. A 2025 paper, titled ‘AI Agents Under Threat: A Survey of Key Security Challenges and Future Pathways’, groups them into four categories:

1. At the input stage, attackers may use

prompt injections — hidden instructions embedded in web pages, documents or other content an AI agent processes — to manipulate what the agent sees or does.

2. During reasoning, flaws in planning or decision-making may cause an agent to pursue unintended objectives.

3. When using external tools, excessive permissions or compromised software can lead to unintended actions, such as sending

emails or modifying code.

4. Agents that interact with websites, software services or other AI agents introduce risks that can spread across connected systems rather than remaining confined to a single application.

## Cybersecurity risk

Until recently, cybersecurity largely meant defending computer systems against human adversaries. The threat actor was a human with intent and control, and AI was a tool they might use.

AI agents complicate that picture. Recent evaluation incidents — such as OpenAI’s agents hacking into the AI startup Hugging Face — show that some agents have taken actions their developers neither instructed nor anticipated, from creating fake online identities to attempting to deploy malicious code.

Some researchers say these incidents are better understood as AI alignment failures rather than cybersecurity failures. AI safety researchers distinguish between capability

failures, where AI cannot complete a task, and alignment failures, where it pursues its objective in violation of its constraints.

Anita Gurumurthy, executive director of the NGO IT for Change, told *The Indian Express* that the Hugging Face ‘hack’ was “more of a misalignment problem on OpenAI’s side”.

Other researchers say AI agents pose a new cybersecurity concern. Marius Hobbhahn, CEO of AI safety organisation Apollo Research, argued that the Hugging Face incident highlighted the need for better assessments and regulation of internal deployment.

“There was no human in the loop; it was not intended, and it caused real-world harm,” Hobbhahn told *The Indian Express*. He said independent evaluators should assess AI systems earlier in the development process.

Regardless of how researchers ultimately classify them, these incidents suggest that questions once confined to AI safety research are increasingly relevant to cybersecurity as autonomous systems gain more access to real-world tools and infrastructure.





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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

## Bhagwat hits right notes, get Parivar to tune in

RSS CHIEF Mohan Bhagwat's response to the students' protests is timely and welcome — it goes beyond what the BJP itself has so far conceded. The Narendra Modi government was forced to accede to the students' demand for the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union education minister; after that, PM Modi, too, has done an Instagram outreach. The RSS chief's framing of the issue sounds more unforced and less patronising. Protest or "aandolan" is part of the consensus-building process in a democracy, said Bhagwat, and Gen Z is not "anti-national" certainly. It takes many opinions, including contrary ones, to reach the whole truth, he said, and the young's exasperation with the education system is genuine. It matters that the RSS sarsangchalak should say this. The RSS is the BJP's ideological mentor and what its chief says can open up, or narrow the spaces in which issues play out nationally. Yet, it remains to be seen how party and government own his message.

This is not the first time that Bhagwat has struck a note on a polarising issue that is more conciliatory than the BJP. In June 2022, he said that there is "no need to look for a shiv ling under every mosque". "Ab hamko koi aandolan nahin karna hai (now we will not be involved in any campaign)", he said. This was even as the BJP's top leadership maintained a strategic silence on shrill voices that rose on the Gyanvapi controversy. Those cautionary words, however, have done little to snub attempts by a section of the BJP and the parivar to rake up old disputes like Mathura and Kashi since. There is another reason why Bhagwat's softer framing of the students' protests carries political health warnings. When he says that the students have rightly raised the issue of education, when he suggests that the education system calls for sweeping reforms, he leaves much unsaid. RSS control, its interference in the design of curricula and rewriting of textbooks, appointment and removal of teachers and vice-chancellors, green-lighting and cancelling of seminars and speakers, is part of the education crisis.

Campuses of universities where the RSS pulls the strings are disfigured by shrinking spaces for free expression and dwindling autonomy. Indeed, since 2014, too much of the Sangh's political energy, fueled by its serial electoral successes, has been expended on the ideological and cultural project, rather than addressing gaps in education that would have empowered a new generation of citizens. That's why Bhagwat's words on students' protests are welcome but if they are to carry weight, there is work to be done. The party and government, even the RSS itself, will have to heed them, in letter and spirit.

## Maharashtra shortcut to rural healthcare is risky

THE MAHARASHTRA government has framed its decision to allow homeopathic doctors to prescribe allopathic medicines, after undergoing a bridge course, as a pragmatic response to a vexing problem. Although the state has roughly one physician for every 700 people — better than the WHO's benchmark of one doctor per 1,000 people — its rural areas have faced a persistent shortage of allopathic practitioners. Improving access to medical care in these areas is an urgent public health priority. But addressing that shortage by combining therapeutic systems is problematic. Different, often conflicting, principles underpin allopathy and homeopathy. Mixing the two systems can undermine professional standards, compromise patient safety, and ultimately erode public trust in both modern medicine and homeopathy.

Allopathy is an integrated discipline built upon several interconnected fields. Its therapeutic practices are grounded in evidence generated through clinical research, pharmacological studies and epidemiological investigation. Clinical judgement develops through years of classroom instruction, laboratory work, clinical postings and supervised practice, followed by an internship. This training enables a doctor to understand why diseases develop, how different organ systems interact, how to arrive at a diagnosis, how medicines act on the body, interactions between drugs and the reasons for complications and adverse reactions. The MBBS curriculum also trains doctors to assess the quality of medical evidence, and interpret diagnostic investigations. A bridge course, however well designed, cannot recreate this intellectual and clinical architecture. At best, it can familiarise homeopathic practitioners with selected allopathic medicines, common conditions and standard treatment protocols. But knowing which drug is commonly prescribed for a particular symptom is not the same as diagnostic reasoning.

This is not to deny homeopathy a place in India's healthcare system. The Centre's decision, in 2014, to create a separate ministry for alternative medicine, including homeopathy, AYUSH, was, in fact, guided by this imperative. The country's public health deficits can be addressed by expanding medical education, investing in institutions and strengthening incentives for doctors to serve in areas where they are urgently needed. These objectives are best achieved by respecting the integrity of each system rather than through ill-advised moves to blur disciplinary boundaries.

## The phone is stealing the show

AT A time when concert-goers are renting high-end phones just to record performances, K-pop band Cortis has made a radical appeal to its fans: Put your phone down. So serious is the band in its objection to fans using phones to capture its live performances — instead of actually experiencing them — that the phrase has become the name of its ongoing concert tour. Whether or not their followers heed the request, Cortis has reopened one of the most heated debates of the digital age: At what point does recording an experience become a refusal to live it?

There is a case for making the most of a concert given how much ticket prices cost today. All the fans want to do is to relive those moments whenever they want besides sharing them on social media. Artists, too, are not oblivious to the power of virality; entire concerts are now designed to yield visuals with the potential to "break the internet". So when the six-inch barrier of the smartphone screen goes up between the fan and the artist, the blame does not rest entirely on the former.

But when Cortis and others decry the use of phones at concerts, they're lamenting a very particular kind of loss. The electric energy that can only exist between fan and artist during a live performance is impossible to record or replay, much less share for likes and reposts. Long after the concert is over, it can be retrieved from memory. For that, however, it needs to be experienced.

M AHATMA GANDHI invited us to judge our actions in terms of what they do to the last person. From this standpoint, the proposed amendment of the National Food Security Act leaves much to be desired. Indeed, it is a direct attack on the food entitlements of the poorest of the poor.

More precisely, the amendment adversely affects the entitlements of households in the Antyodaya category, a little over two crore households. The Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY) was launched in late 2000, under the Atal Bihari Vajpayee government, to provide special protection to the poorest of the poor. Antyodaya households were supposed to be identified by local communities. They were entitled to monthly foodgrain rations of 25 kg at symbolic prices, soon raised to 35 kg. Today, AAY rations are free under the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana.

Originally, no specific criteria were laid out for the identification of destitute households. The Supreme Court, however, helpfully defined some vulnerable groups. For instance, the Court rightly acknowledged the extreme insecurity of particularly vulnerable tribal groups (PVTGs), and directed that all of them should be covered under AAY. This did happen to a large extent, and AAY cards have been a critical resource for PVTG households ever since.

Similarly, the Court observed that a large number of households in India are at risk of destitution because they have no earning member. Examples include elderly

couples, widows with small children, disabled persons without support, and so on. In a significant order dated May 2, 2003, the Court prescribed the inclusion of all these households under AAY. The extent of compliance with this order varies widely across states, but the order did provide a useful framework for special food assistance to destitute households.

The National Food Security Act ushered a transition from household entitlements to per-capita entitlements for "priority" households — the bulk of ration-card holders. For Antyodaya households, however, the household approach was retained. The reason lies in AAY's special focus on households with no earning member, such as widows living alone and elderly couples. These tend to be small households, and they were at risk of losing a major source of economic security in the switch to per-capita entitlements. Many of them had come to rely heavily on their AAY rations for survival. It seemed best not to rock the boat.

To view it another way, the switch to a per-capita approach under the NFSA was a serious threat for small households with little staying power. The retention of the Antyodaya programme and its household approach made it possible to protect them.

Under the proposed NFSA amendment, however, monthly rations of 35 kg for Antyodaya households are to be replaced with per-capita rations of 7 kg per



JEAN DRÈZE



MOHAMMAD ZAMEER

The argument is that it will reduce the variation in per-capita entitlements within the Antyodaya category. This is like reducing the salaries of peons on the ground that it will reduce wage disparities between peons and chowkidars

## Fix the boardroom, the rest will follow



SHAILESH HARIBHAKTI



AJAY GOEL

THE KING shall consider as good, not what pleases himself, but what pleases his subjects." — Kautilya's *Arthashastra*. Corporate governance has produced an entire architecture of codes, committees, and compliance calendars — the G20/OECD Principles, the UK Corporate Governance Code, Sarbanes-Oxley, India's Companies Act and SEBI's LODR. All of it matters. None of it is sufficient. Rules constrain bad behaviour; they do not manufacture good judgment. That must come from the boardroom itself.

The board is not one input into governance among many. It is the governance system. Everything else — disclosure norms, audit standards, committee charters — exists to give the board the information and independence to do one job well: Decide, in real time, before the damage is done.

Most boards still don't do this. They review. They ratify. They arrive at a meeting with a thick deck, ask a few sharpened questions, and approve what management has already decided. That is oversight in name, not substance. The shift that matters — the one every code gestures at but few boards execute — is from reviewer to steward: From approving what happened to shaping what happens next.

What does that shift look like in practice?

First, boards must engage strategy and risk before it hardens into a recommendation, not after. Issue papers, competitive benchmarking, and explicit scenario trade-offs — brought to the board while options are still open- do more for governance quality than any additional disclosure requirement. A board that only sees the final recommendation has already lost its independence, regardless of how independent its directors are on paper.

Second, information architecture has to change. Boards drown in volume and starve insight. The fix is not more pages; it is fewer, sharper ones — a risk heat map instead of a risk register, a handful of leading indicators instead of a hundred lagging ones. An independent director's real power is exercised in 15 minutes before a decision is made, and that power is only as good as the material put in front of them.

Third, related-party transactions and

promoter-influenced decisions deserve a strategic lens, not just a compliance one. Arm's length pricing and threshold approvals are the floor, not the test. The real question a board should ask is whether a transaction would survive scrutiny from a minority shareholder reading about it for the first time. In promoter-led and family conglomerates — the dominant model across Asia — this is where board credibility is built or lost.

Fourth, dissent must be engineered in, not hoped for. An independent chair who separates the roles of conductor and executive; independent directors who are genuinely expected to challenge, not just attend; structured, management-free conversations with auditors, rating agencies, and proxy advisors — these are not courtesies; they are the mechanism by which a board avoids becoming an echo chamber. Boards fail less often from a shortage of expertise than from a surplus of deference.

Fifth, composition has to be treated as a live decision, not a legacy one. A skills matrix filed away rather than actively used to plan succession is theatre. Long, comfortable tenures without renewal are a governance risk, whatever the individual director's competence.

None of this is exotic. It does not require a new code or a new regulator. It requires boards to spend their scarce time differently — less time ratifying, more time interrogating; less time on the deck in front of them, more time on the decision three moves ahead.

The companies judged well a decade from now will not be the ones with the most elaborate governance manuals. They will be the ones whose boards behaved like stewards when it counted, asking the uncomfortable question in the room where the decision was still reversible, rather than in the post-mortem where it was not.

That is the single point worth taking from the entire governance debate: Fix the boardroom, and the rest of the system follows. Fix everything else and leave the boardroom untouched, and none of it will be enough.

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person, with a cap of 35 kg per household. For households with five members or more, this makes no difference. Smaller households, however, will lose 20 to 80 per cent of their current entitlements. And a majority of AAY households (53 per cent to be precise) have fewer than five members, according to the nationwide Household Consumer Expenditure Survey 2023-24. There are no gainers in this bargain, only losers.

Women living alone will be the worst affected. There are nearly one million of them in the Antyodaya category. According to HCES data, 85 per cent are widows and 74 per cent are illiterate. As recent work by Esther Duflo and others brings out, many of them have to cope with mental stress and social stigma in addition to economic destitution. Their monthly foodgrain rations will crash from 35 kg to 7 kg under the proposed amendment — a reduction of 80 per cent.

Of course, 35 kg per month exceeds the foodgrain requirements of many small households. The surplus, however, can generally be cashed or exchanged for other commodities. AAY's monthly rations are best thought of as an economic resource, not just food to eat.

Oddly, this reduction of entitlements for the country's poorest households is being justified in the name of equity. The argument is that it will reduce the variation in per-capita entitlements within the Antyodaya category.

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This is like reducing the salaries of peons on the ground that it will reduce wage disparities between peons and chowkidars.

The real motive for this amendment is likely to be to save money. The potential savings, however, are small. In 2023-24, the foodgrain allocation for AAY was 10 million tonnes, and offtake was 8.8 million tonnes. Using HCES data on household size, we can easily infer AAY's foodgrain requirements under the proposed approach: 7.6 million tonnes. At best, the proposed amendment will save around 2 million tonnes of foodgrain per year. This is of little value when the government is already struggling with massive excess stocks. It is for the poor that every grain counts.

Instead of chasing minor savings at the expense of the poor, the government should revamp the AAY programme. The AAY lists are very old, and they must be rife with inclusion and exclusion errors. Without cancelling any ration cards, better-off households could be moved to the priority category to make space for those who are unfairly left out of AAY. Expanding the AAY quota would also be useful to ensure full coverage of all destitute households. Even more useful would be to add dal and edible oil to the PDS entitlements of Antyodaya households, as some states have already done off and on. As for the proposed NFSA amendment, it is best thrown in the dustbin.

Drèze is visiting professor, Department of Economics, Ranchi University and Zameer is independent researcher based in Ranch

## What you eat was once medicine. Now, it is addiction



SHASHANK JOSHI

ANNA BRAHMA. In the Vedic vision, food is not mere sustenance. It is Brahman itself — the living substance that becomes body, mind and prana. What we place on the tongue shapes the quality of our thoughts, the strength of our dharma, and the destiny of the nation. Today, that sacred understanding has been inverted. Food is no longer worshipped as medicine. It is engineered as addiction and sold as aspiration.

We are living through a silent metabolic emergency. Ultra-processed foods — loaded with fat, sugar and salt — are being marketed to India's children with cartoon characters, celebrity endorsements, cricket sponsorships and aggressive "buy-one-get-one" tactics. School canteens and digital feeds have become delivery systems for hyper-palatable products designed in laboratories to override satiety and create lifelong craving. The human cost is already visible. Nearly one in three Indian women and one in four men are overweight or obese. Childhood obesity and type-2 diabetes are rising at a pace unseen in our history. Cardiovascular and metabolic diseases have almost tripled in seven years. This is not a failure of willpower, but of the food environment we have allowed to form around the next generation.

Global science is unambiguous. It has linked ultra-processed foods to obesity, diabetes, heart disease, certain cancers and premature death. The WHO and UNICEF have repeatedly warned that repeated exposure to junk-food advertising shapes children's preferences long before they can exercise informed choice. Every time a child reaches for a sugary drink or packaged snack instead of dal, roti and seasonal fruit, an ancient dietary wisdom that sustained this civilisation is being displaced. India's own Economic Survey 2025-26 has sounded the alarm. It calls for clear front-of-pack warning labels, watershed restrictions on advertising, and a precise legal definition of ultra-processed foods. There is a need for stringent regulation of HFSS (High in Fat, Sugar or Salt) marketing and a ban on junk food in schools.

*Sariramādhyam khalu dharmasāadhanam.* The body is the primary instrument of dharma. A generation whose metabolism is compromised cannot fully discharge its duties to family, society or nation. When we allow commercial forces to undermine the health of children for short-term profit, we are not merely creating patients; we are eroding the foundation of future capability. The time for half-measures is over. We need to impose a complete ban on advertising of HFSS and ultra-processed foods between 6 am and 11 pm across television, digital platforms and social media. It's time to prohibit celebrity endorsements, school-based promotions, cartoon mascots and any form of child-targeted marketing of junk food. Finally, we need to make every school a protected nutritional zone: Remove sugary drinks and HFSS products, and ensure only wholesome, sattvik, culturally rooted meals are served.

India once taught the world that food is medicine. We can do so again — not by exporting the diseases of modern lifestyles, but by reclaiming the wisdom that viewed ahara as the first and most intimate form of medicine. From food as medicine to food as marketing was a costly detour. It is time to reverse the journey. Let food be medicine again.

The writer is a Mumbai-based endocrinologist

### 40 YEARS AGO

August 8, 1986



### Calls for N-test freeze

THE SIX-nation group on nuclear disarmament, including India, called on the United States and the Soviet Union to set a new date for another summit between them and to accept a US-Soviet bilateral nuclear test moratorium. The six nations proposed verification and monitoring arrangements and offered to send a group of experts to take up with US and Soviet experts the details of the proposed arrangements.

### Action against rail staff assured

THE RAILWAY accident involving the Amritsar-TataNagar Express appeared to have occurred owing to failure of railway staff to

observe rules regarding granting line clearance to the following train, the Transport Minister, Mohsina Kidwai, informed Parliament. In identical statements in both Houses, the Minister said administrative action has been taken against officials found negligent.

### Reagan's team for Moscow

PRESIDENT RONALD Reagan is sending a high-powered delegation of top US advisers to Moscow next week to discuss nuclear and space arms issues for the next summit meeting. This dramatic move originated from an idea put forward by the Soviet Union, which suggested that such a visit as part of a pre-summit "work plan" would make a "fast start" on the next steps in arms bargaining. The pro-

posal was brought to the US two weeks ago by the Soviet Deputy Foreign Minister, Alexander Bessmertnykh.

### Cell to check proliferation

CONCERNED AT the phenomenal increase in the quantity of illicit arms and explosives in the country, the Home Ministry is examining a proposal for setting up a separate "arms cell" to check their proliferation. Similar cells are also being proposed to be set up at state headquarters for country-wide coordination for arms and explosives control. While the central arms and explosives cell will be under the control and supervision of the CBI to begin with, the state cells would be under their respective CID's.





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# Message from the young: We don't feel at home



KRISHNA KUMAR

**A**DULT MEMBERS of society are so used to being surrounded by the young that they often forget how different the young actually are. They think differently for a variety of reasons their parents don't take seriously. For one thing, the young carry a different sense of history. Even if parents and teachers tell them what all happened before they were born, this knowledge stays marginal to their consciousness. What is central is the history they have seen unfolding since they were about 10 or 11 — the age when awareness bursts forth, and the intellectual capacity to make sense of the world starts to move to a new level.

Many speeches made by young participants of the recent protest carried the fury that collective presence in a crowded, narrow space allowed to erupt. The cramped and winding space itself became a symbol — of the absence of comfortable dialogue with the adult world despite its claims of concern for the future generation. While the nation dreams of making every nook and shrine tourist-ready, its own children have slipped from attention. Many speeches conveyed a sense of betrayal. This was further confirmed by the state's use of brute power.

Parents have long known how difficult it is to win and retain the trust of their progeny after adolescence sets in. Then onwards, children rely on their own sense of things. They seldom articulate their deepest queries and concerns as they are convinced they will neither be understood nor appreciated. By the time they are 14 or 15, they begin to dismiss adult explanations of how the world got where it is.

Theoretically, adolescence should phase out by the end of secondary schooling — around age 18. If we look at this period of human life in a purely technical manner, we will miss out on the historical reality of



ILLUSTRATION: C.R. SASIKUMAR

today. The extreme idealism of the young mind and the craving for self-identity don't find an edifying response in a world where injustice is common, and not an adequate number of people have jobs — many of them unstable and mostly meaningless. Such jobs don't build an identity — the feeling that this is what I do best, and more importantly, others can't do it as well. A large section of the educated young have no stable work lives, let alone a career. The race for career jobs is terrifyingly competitive. Preparation for success in such races consists of cold, bone-chilling drills and, for many, the guilt of wasting parents' money on coaching. The new technological environment doesn't make inner life any easier. Rather, it adds to the emotional turmoil that is often covered up in addictive ways with entertainment and by letting age-mates stay in touch.

Suicide at a young age is an indicator that the social system is in distress. When suicide cases started to be noticed, they were rightly attributed to the stress caused by incoherent syllabi and the pressure of exams. The Yash Pal report of 1993

examined the issue. Its perspective did influence curriculum and pedagogy for a while, but systemic reversals edged it out of circulation. Suicides by educated youth continued to increase at a steady pace, moving into higher education. After its expansion to include students from marginalised social backgrounds, institutional capacity to do justice to the new entrants sharply declined. Rohith Vemula's case was a glaring signal of a rupture in the higher education system. He was no teenager, but his words echo the haunting memory of childhood: "My birth is my fatal accident. I can never recover from my childhood loneliness".

The only members of adult society who might have an inkling of the young person's mind are teachers. However, they are so immersed in their formal routines that they have little time or energy left to relate to the young. Within their own professional domain — education — they are treated as subordinates. Their lack of status means that their reading of young minds counts for nothing in the policy world.

At the cultural level, suicide

cases among young adults were symptoms of intergenerational breakdown. Neither the state nor society acknowledged this. Both chose to sustain the myth that continuity between the old and young was resilient enough to survive the change in values and behaviour. The popular belief was that so long as the older people shared their stories with the young, continuity shall stay intact. Barring a few scholars of social psychology, no one noticed that the idea of continuity became irrelevant after the 1970s. Factors causing discontinuity emerged, but no single cause could be held responsible. Shredding of social cohesion was one, and it reached its peak by the last decade of the 20th century. A damaged national narrative left the adolescent puzzled about adult thought on core issues and the future.

What happened in Delhi recently has confused many sections of adult society. Those who believe in early indoctrination wonder how such a massive expression of resentment escaped their foresight. We will do better next time, they might say. Others who see it mainly in political terms are tempted to discern in it a conspiracy. Didn't the protagonist fly in from overseas, they ask. Then there are seekers of more precise reasons, and they want to focus on the NEET fiasco. However, they cannot easily explain why the NEET scandal resonated with so many others who had not taken the exam.

Arguably, the protest found resonance in a wider section of the young. It vented a deeper anger. It was the anger of the ignored. It demonstrated that youth frustration is not merely a perception: It is real, and neither education nor economic policies have responded to it. Rather, education has contributed to the sharpening of youth discontent and has offered the means to express it. Considering how constrained and fractured the system is, the means education has imparted to the young for expressing their indignation are limited. Any attempt to "fix" education by treating it as a mechanical toy is sure to miss the sharp decline in institutional capacity to make the young feel at home.

*The writer is a former Director of NCERT and the author of Thank You, Gandhi*

## Dear CEOs, Gen Z is watching, your silence has a price



HARI BAPUJI AND PANKHURI AGARWAL

**A**FEW weeks ago, a consumer in Delhi announced on social media that their family switched from Amul butter to Milky Mist. Their reason had nothing to do with taste or price. "The Amul girl has refused to speak up for the students (in the Cockroach Janta Party protests)". Others quickly said they were doing the same. It was a small act, but a telling one: A generation raised on hashtags and group chats had decided that corporate silence was itself a position, and a costly one at that.

What set the CJP apart was as much its style as its substance. Protesters stayed peaceful in the face of provocation, invoked constitutional rights, and reclaimed the language of democracy for themselves. The demands were serious, structural, even, but the tone was anything but grim: Dancing, singing, livestreaming, and memes were integral parts of their protests.

Business leaders were no better attuned to this shift than anyone else. Where some spoke, it was often to dismiss rather than engage. Zoho's Sridhar Vembu criticised the movement as "malicious agenda" hindering national progress, while Skyroot's Suresh Kochhattil urged young people not to be "cockroaches", offering himself as an alternative role model. Three things are at stake for businesses that sit this out.

Gen Z's demands for fair economic opportunity and better governance are, in effect, demands for the conditions that make growth possible. Institutional voids — corruption, nepotism, weak governance — raise the cost of doing business and erode performance. Corruption compromises the policies and procedures behind public goods; nepotism hands opportunity to the less capable; economic inequality breeds poor civic behaviour and drags down competitiveness.

The second is talent. This generation will supply the next wave of employees, entrepreneurs, and leaders needed to realise the demographic dividend. Its values — sustainability, social impact, work-life balance, workplace respect — sit uneasily with a corporate culture still built around putting life on hold for a career. Labelled lazy and entitled, Gen Z has pushed back with "quiet quitting", "acting your wage", and "bare minimum Mondays". A few organisations have taken note. EY, for instance, has piloted a reverse-mentoring programme to help leadership listen across generations.

The third is the market itself. Gen Z is already one of the world's most consequential consumer segments, both in spending power and cultural influence. It makes up close to a third of the global population and roughly 40 per cent of global consumers, with spending projected to reach \$12 trillion by 2030. In India alone, the Gen Z population of over 377 million exceeds the entire population of the US. Their preferences are steadily reshaping expectations around sustainability, transparency, and product design. During the CJP protests, this influence played out visibly: Supporters repurposed campaign imagery from Netflix, LinkedIn, Nike, Coca-Cola, and Lakme into satirical posters calling out these brands' silence.

Business leaders can speak in support of the governance reforms Gen Z is demanding, much as executives globally have done on issues like racial inequality and gun violence. But such statements only land when they are seen as authentic; a company that invests heavily in education-focused CSR, for instance, earns credibility by also speaking up for educational reform. There is also room for more concrete contributions. As India's public examination system comes under scrutiny following the protests, businesses could help redesign it around creativity and problem-solving rather than rote memorisation. Companies can also redirect existing resources rather than simply add new commitments. Indian firms already channel a large share of their CSR budgets into education, skilling, and livelihood programmes. These could be steered more deliberately toward regions with weak economic and employment growth, alongside broadening their hiring net to reach tier-2 and tier-3 cities.

Businesses do not have to agree with every demand these movements raise, and they do not need to pretend otherwise. But each movement is a signal — a clear statement of what an enormous, increasingly powerful generation values. Companies that read that signal early stand to build lasting goodwill. Those that ignore it are, in effect, betting against their own future customers, employees, and shareholders.

*Bapuji is professor of Management and Gourlay Fellow in Business Ethics, Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Melbourne. Agarwal is lecturer and Leverhulme Early Career Fellow, King's Business School, King's College London*

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Insulate ties

BILATERAL RELATIONS should never depend on the fortunes of individual leaders ('India-Bangladesh ties should be Hasina-proof', *IE*, August 7). Shared economic, security and cultural interests require steady institutional engagement. Regular diplomatic dialogue, stronger trade links and people-to-people exchanges can build resilience during political transitions. A mature relationship rests on continuity, mutual respect and long-term cooperation rather than on changing domestic politics.

*A Myilsami, Chennai*

THERE IS visible uncertainty surrounding former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's proposed return and its implications for regional stability ('India-Bangladesh ties should be Hasina-proof', *IE*, August 7). While every political leader has the right to seek justice through democratic and legal means, Bangladesh's future must be shaped by constitutional processes rather than political vendettas or street confrontations. For India, the situation is particularly delicate. As Bangladesh is a close neighbour and strategic partner, New Delhi must maintain a balanced approach by respecting Bangladesh's sovereignty while safeguarding its own security and diplomatic interests.

*Vandana Chopra, Chandigarh*

### Discard old formulas

RECENT POLITICAL developments show that voters increasingly reward performance over rhetoric ("Tamil Nadu to Jantar Mantar to Bankipuri, join the political dots", *IE*, August 7). Parties must avoid relying on outdated electoral formulas and instead address employment, inflation and public services with credible policies. Consistent engagement with citizens between elections is far more effective than symbolic campaigns. Listening carefully to changing aspirations is now essential for remaining democratically relevant.

*S.M. Jeeva, Chennai*



RAM RAJYA

BY RAM MADHAV

THE KASHMIR Valley witnessed the annual ritual of protests and demonstrations by local political parties such as the National Conference (NC) and the People's Democratic Party (PDP) on August 5 against the Narendra Modi government's historic decision seven years ago to nullify Articles 370 and 35A of the Constitution. There were some demonstrations outside Parliament, too, which were joined by some IND alliance partners, such as Congress and the Left parties.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah chose to stay away from Srinagar on that day, perhaps on the pretext of visiting flood-affected areas in Poonch. Several senior NC leaders were absent at the demonstrations in various places across the Valley. People's Conference leader Sajjad Lone limited his protests to a post on X, calling August 5, 2019 a "brutal coup". Mehbooba Mufti and her daughter Iltija were seen on the streets leading motley crowds in protests.

Both the CM and Mehbooba Mufti made the restoration of J&K's pre-2019 status the main plank of their protests. From Poonch, Abdullah posted a message on X saying, "we haven't forgotten & we haven't reconciled far less accepted our current circumstances". He claimed that his party was committed to "reversing all that was done to J&K". Mufti, leading a candle march in Srinagar, insisted that "we will not remain silent until the restoration

## In Valley, parties' protest does not resonate with people

of Articles 370 and 35A".

However, across the Valley, there was a lukewarm response to these demonstrations. The people seem to have realised the futility of the rhetoric of these leaders. They know that there is no possibility of even a debate over the issue in the present political milieu, much less the restoration of the provisions. Abdullah himself said in 2024 that expecting the restoration of Article 370 from those who abrogated it is "foolishness" and "deceiving the public". In fact, his government even omitted any mention of Article 370 in the Lieutenant Governor's address to the J&K Assembly this January. Yet, the ritual goes on.

The people of the UT moved on and are enjoying the benefits of good governance, development and daily life free of terrorism under the post-2019 regime. They see the pathetic condition of democracy across Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir, and their own brethren getting killed by and at the behest of the Pakistani military just for demanding better living conditions. They can see the contrast on this side of the LoC — innumerable benefits in areas like healthcare, education, infrastructure, entrepreneurship and sports. They celebrated democracy by participating in the elections to the UT Legislature in large numbers in 2024.

The problem with the Valley leadership is that they lack any forward-looking agenda and want to take the people backwards. Earlier,

they used to bluff that they would take them back to pre-1953 status, although it was their own leadership which had hollowed out Article 370 over decades after 1956. What happened in 2019 was the removal of a skeleton that became a hindrance in the total integration of the state with the Indian Union.

Instead, they should learn some lessons from the leaders and people of Ladakh. After achieving their long-standing demand of UT status, they came up with a roadmap demanding certain constitutional protections and engaged in discussions with the Centre. The Valley leaders are stuck on the demand for statehood and keep returning to the restoration of Article 370.

Both the Prime Minister and the Home Minister have said that the current UT status is temporary, and statehood will be accorded at an appropriate time. Article 370 was a temporary provision, but the Valley leaders enjoyed it for 70 years. Why can't they bear with this temporary UT status for a few years?

The problem is their bankruptcy of ideas when it comes to the future of the people of J&K. They should remember that Article 370 is history and no mainstream party in the country, including Congress, dares to commit to its restoration. The Valley leaders can serve their people better by thinking about the possibilities and opportunities that the Indian Constitution offers for the overall development of the region.

*The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP*

**Article 370 was a temporary provision, but the Valley leaders enjoyed it for 70 years. Why can't they bear with this temporary UT status for a few years?**



SOUMYA BHOWMICK

THE WORKING vocabulary at the recent ASEAN Foreign Ministers' Meeting, as in every capital that trades for a living, was de-risking and diversification. It is sensible vocabulary, but it is doing less work than it appears to. India is the natural place to examine this vocabulary, because it has already diversified. It imports more than 85 per cent of the crude it consumes, and since the Gulf crisis began in late February the share arriving from West Asia has fallen from roughly half to about a third, with Russian barrels absorbing most of the difference. Few large importers have rearranged their supplier mix that fast, which makes

India a fair case for asking whether rearranging is the same as being safer.

Three tests of its position suggest the difference is not academic. The first test is physical routing. After the Strait of Hormuz became unusable earlier this year, the Gulf producers engineered their way around it, redirecting volumes to Yanbu on the Red Sea coast and leaning on pipeline capacity to Fujairah, which is how Gulf barrels began returning to Indian refiners over the summer. Those redirected cargoes, however, leave through Bab el-Mandeb, a corridor that has deteriorated sharply this month, leaving Middle Eastern seaborne crude with progressively fewer exits. The Russian barrels that now make up roughly half of India's crude intake are no better insulated.

The second test is substitutability, and it exposes something uncomfortable about

how India reads its own resilience. Crude looks diversified largely because crude is fungible, so grades swap, refineries adjust, and a basket assembled from three continents becomes a genuine achievement of commercial reach. Cooking gas offers no such comfort, since India imports around 60 per cent of its LPG, overwhelmingly from Gulf suppliers routed through the same strait,

**Ultimately, every arrangement India counts as protection deserves one question: What would have to go wrong for this arrangement to fail, and does it fail for the same reasons as the one it replaced?**

against storage measured in weeks rather than months. Specialised carriers, rigid-term contracts and unforgiving freight economics mean there is no swing supplier to pivot to. The lesson is that a diversified crude basket is largely a property of the commodity rather than a verdict on policy, and that the products where diversification is hardest are the ones that reach households first.

The third test is legal tenure. The across-the-board American surcharge introduced in February reached its statutory 150-day ceiling two weeks ago and lapsed automatically, and rather than allow rates to revert, Washington shifted the burden onto a different statute, citing forced-labour findings across 60 economies. India was placed in the lower band at 10 per cent rather than 12.5, having amended its trade policy in June to prohibit imports made with forced labour,

which was competent and anticipatory work that bought a real concession. The rate is now carried by an instrument with no ceiling and no expiry, resting on an administrative finding reversible at the issuing authority's discretion. Diversifying export markets does nothing about this, because the risk is not that a market disappears but that the terms of entry are held by someone else.

Ultimately, every arrangement India counts as protection deserves one question: What would have to go wrong for this arrangement to fail, and does it fail for the same reasons as the one it replaced? Where the answer is yes, India has not bought a hedge. It has bought the same risk twice, priced as prudence.

*The writer is with Observer Research Foundation*



Houthi attacks leave 11 civilians injured, says Saudi military

Samy Magdy  
Cairo, August 7

MORE THAN 10 civilians, including a 4-year-old child, were injured in Saudi Arabia on Thursday after a series of attacks by Yemen's Houthi rebels, according to the Saudi military.

The attacks, which took place in the southern region of Najran, near the Yemeni border, came hours after the Iran-backed rebels claimed responsibility for another series of strikes in central and eastern Yemen that killed at least 30 government troops and wounded at least 50 others.

A Houthi leader said Saudi-backed troops were targeted in the attacks and that "hundreds" were either killed or injured. The assaults hit camps for forces of the internationally recognised government in the provinces of Marib and Hadramout, the Yemeni officials said. They spoke on condition of anonymity.

Turki al-Malki, a spokesman for the Saudi military, said the later attack wounded seven Saudi nationals, one Yemeni, two Egyptians and one Pakistani. The Houthis did not release any statement.

"The terrorist Houthi militia carried out these terrorist attacks using indiscriminate shelling against civilian objects, which is a flagrant violation of the Customary International Humanitarian Law through deliberate targeting of civilians and civilian objects," al-Malki posted on X. **REUTERS**

PACT SAYS ARMED ATTACK ON ONE SIGNATORY WOULD COUNT AS ATTACK ON ALL

Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pak sign defence deal amid West Asia crisis

Agreement inked in Mecca after nearly a year of talks

Timour Azhari, Ariba Shahid & Tuvan Gumrukcu  
Riyadh, Karachi, Ankara, August 7

SAUDI ARABIA, Pakistan and Turkey signed a joint defence agreement in Mecca on Friday, wedding Sunni Muslim US allies alarmed at a regional conflagration that has brought Iranian missile fire onto Gulf oil exporters. Iran and its allies have been firing on Saudi Arabia and other Gulf states, and blocking their energy shipments, since the US and Israel attacked it on February 28 in a major escalation after years of regional tumult.

The "Mecca Joint Defence Agreement" is intended to strengthen collective deterrence against any act of aggression and stipulates that an armed attack against any of the three would be regarded as an attack on all, they said in a joint statement.

However, the statement did not give specifics on the commitments each had accepted and it was not clear how far their agreement would bind them to any particular military action in each



Turkish President Tayyip Erdogan, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman and Pakistan's Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif after signing a joint defence agreement in Mecca on Friday. **REUTERS**

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBdOf>

other's defence. Turkish Vice President Cevdet Yilmaz said the agreement was not aimed at any specific country. A Turkish official added that it was purely defensive and did not abrogate any existing agreements the countries had with other states. The three nations share concerns about the increasingly aggressive military stances of both Israel and revolutionary Shi'ite Iran, as their longtime US ally struggles to contain regional upheaval that has caused a global energy crisis.

"Three of the Muslim world's most influential states are con-

**E. EXPLAINED**

**Power projection bid**

ALTHOUGH SAUDI deputy minister for public diplomacy Rayed Krimly has stated that the accord is not intended to establish a military axis or sectarian bloc, the alliance's composition — with Turkey fielding NATO's second-largest military, Saudi Arabia ranking among the world's top oil exporters, and Pakistan being a nuclear power — appears designed to project itself as a regional power.

Thai teen kills 7 in rampage at home and school before shooting himself



Children are being evacuated from Debsirin Nonthaburi School in Thailand's Nonthaburi province on Friday. **AP**

Chalinee Thirasupa & Panarat Thepgumpant  
Bang Kruai, August 7

A TEENAGE Thai student killed at least five people and himself at a school outside Bangkok on Friday after fatally shooting his grandparents, police said, in the Southeast Asian nation's worst mass killing in nearly four years.

Those killed at the school were all teachers and staff, and police said the 14-year-old shooter fired at least 26 bullets using a gun that belonged to his grandfather. An additional 34 rounds were found.

Students streamed out of the Debsirin Nonthaburi School, on the capital's northwestern outskirts, as the wounded were loaded on to ambulances and teachers hugged each other and cried. In photos circulated by emergency workers, one person is seen lying down on a stretcher outside an ambulance, while another is attended to by a medic.

Police said 23 people were

wounded in the incident, the latest in a succession of mass shootings in recent years in Thailand, which has by far the largest number of guns in civilian possession in Southeast Asia, and among the most per capita in Asia, according to a 2017 estimate by the Small Arms Survey.

One 18-year-old student told Reuters he initially thought there were firecrackers going off or someone banging an object. "I didn't think it was a gun at first," he said. "There were many shots: bang, bang, bang. Then it went quiet. Then it started again."

**SECOND SCHOOL SHOOTING** It is the second school shooting in Thailand this year after a teacher died and a student was injured in the south of the country in February.

"This is terrible for something like this to happen," Prime Minister Anutin Charnvirakul told reporters. "I'm sad for those who died and sad for something like this to happen in our country." **REUTERS**

Court blocks Trump's \$400-m White House ballroom project

Reuters  
Washington, August 7

A US federal appeals court ordered President Donald Trump's administration on Friday to stop construction on a \$400 million ballroom on the site of the White House's demolished East Wing, dealing the Republican leader a major setback in a case testing his presidential authority.

"Each President is a temporary tenant, not the owner, of the White House" and cannot fundamentally reshape it without congressional approval, the Washington-based US Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit said in a 2-1 opinion, opens new tab.



Construction of a ballroom at the White House. **REUTERS**

The order upheld a preliminary injunction won by the National Trust for Historic Preservation, which sued last year after the administration tore down the East Wing and began building a 90,000-square-foot (8,360-square-meter) ballroom without seeking authorization from Congress.

Trump signs orders to limit US birthright citizenship, despite Supreme Court ruling

Kristina Cooke, Andrew Chung & Daniel Trotta  
August 7

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump signed two executive orders on Thursday in a new but narrower attempt to curtail birthright citizenship, once again challenging a provision of the US Constitution even though the Supreme Court rejected his previous effort.

Limiting birthright citizenship has been one of the top priorities in the Republican president's crackdown on immigration, with the White House taking particular aim at what it calls "birth tourism," in which pregnant foreigners travel to the U.S. to give birth. After his June 30 setback in the Supreme Court, Trump called on Congress to act, but on



**“That practice of birth tourism is, as of the signing of this order, hereby banned”**

**STEPHEN MILLER,**  
WHITE HOUSE AIDE

Thursday he opted for executive orders, which set policy but do not carry the same weight as laws passed by Congress. The

Supreme Court had struck down as unconstitutional Trump's earlier executive order, which targeted a wide swath of immigrants in the country illegally or temporarily. The administration argues the new directive falls outside the purview of the Supreme Court ruling, as it seeks to reinterpret the narrow, historical exceptions to citizenship at birth and expand who is ineligible.

"That practice of birth tourism is, as of the signing of this order, hereby banned," White House aide Stephen Miller said at the Thursday signing ceremony in the Oval Office. The Center for Immigration Studies, which supports lower levels of immigration, estimated in an analysis in 2020 that between 20,000 and 25,000 mothers came to the U.S. for birth tour-

ism in a year-long period between 2016 and 2017.

There were 3.6 million births in the US in 2025.

The executive orders also limit the rights of children born to foreign government employees in the U.S. and children of people who are classified as alien enemies.

The orders could also affect people born in US territories, should Congress enact a proposed law to end automatic citizenship there. Trump's new orders are likely to face legal challenge. Legal experts said it was unclear what effect the executive orders might have given the Supreme Court ruling, while immigrant advocates called it an attempt to evade the high court's decision. The ACLU predicted it was doomed to fail in court. **REUTERS**

Ukraine attacks Russia retail giant's warehouse

Associated Press  
August 7

UKRAINIAN LONG-RANGE drones hit a warehouse of Russia's biggest online retailer in the Ural Mountains, more than 2,000 kilometers (1,200 miles) from the two countries' border, local officials and the company said Friday.

Ukraine has regularly hit targets in the distant Urals this year and has even struck a Russian oil refinery in western Siberia,

nearly 2,500 kilometers (1,550 miles) from the border. The attacks are examples of how Kyiv has used drone innovation as a key part of its response to the invasion by its much bigger enemy more than four years ago.

Its successes have drawn international interest and drone cooperation agreements with nine countries, with further deals being negotiated with 15 other countries, according to Kyiv officials. Wildberries said its warehouse in Yekaterinburg,

Russia's fourth-largest city, was set ablaze by the attack. Most merchandise wasn't damaged, the company said, unlike at some of the more than a dozen other Wildberries depots struck by Ukraine in recent weeks that have burned down.

The regional governor, Denis Pasler, said three drones hit the warehouse's roof. Artyom Zhoga, the Kremlin's representative in the region, said that 800 people were evacuated.

Ukrainian President Volody-

myr Zelenskyy is pushing to keep up the pace of technology, especially in air defense systems to help stop Russian ballistic missiles that are exploiting Ukraine's shortage of US-made Patriot interceptor missiles.

A joint European anti-ballistic development program is already underway, Zelenskyy said late Thursday, with 10 countries engaged in developing an anti-ballistic shield. Europe is concerned about Moscow's ambitions on the continent beyond Ukraine.

3 inmates killed, 23 injured in prison clashes in Sri Lanka

Reuters  
Colombo, August 7

THREE PRISONERS were killed and at least 23 others injured in two prison riots in Sri Lanka, a senior official said on Friday, as unrest continued across the island nation's overcrowded prison system.

One prisoner was killed and 10 injured in a riot that began late on Thursday at Colombo's New Magazine Prison. A second

riot at Kuruwita prison, about 80 km (50 miles) from the capital, left two prisoners dead and 14 injured, Public Security Minister Ananda Wijepala told parliament. Police and special forces brought both disturbances under control, Wijepala said. Unrest at an open prison in Negombo, about 40 km (25 miles) from Colombo, was also contained after police fired tear gas at protesting inmates, police said.

• AFTER YEARS OF FIELDING REPORTS OF SEXUAL MISCONDUCT, THE COMPANY DEVELOPED INSTRUCTIONAL VIDEOS FOR DRIVERS THAT STATED, 'SEXUAL VIOLENCE IS NEVER THE SURVIVOR'S FAULT'

Uber's strategy for fighting sexual assault suits: 'What were you wearing?'

Emily Steel  
August 7

A 24-YEAR-OLD woman logged onto a videoconference from her bedroom in Florida on a Friday morning in April 2025 to face a deposition in her lawsuit against Uber.

Her driver had already pleaded guilty in criminal court to raping her while she was unconscious during a ride in Tampa one night in 2021. He was in prison, serving a 10-year sentence. The woman, identified as Jane Doe in court documents, was suing Uber in civil court for negligence, arguing that the company should have done more to screen and supervise the driver, a man with prior violent felony convictions.

Publicly, Uber proclaims itself to be a company devoted to handling sexual violence in a

"survivor-centric" and "trauma-informed" way, supporting survivors and treating them with dignity. After years of fielding reports of sexual misconduct, the company developed instructional videos for drivers that stated, "Sexual violence is never the survivor's fault."

But in court filings, Uber argued that Jane Doe had "conducted herself in a negligent and careless manner" and "contributed to causing her own injuries." And it said her claims of pain and suffering were "unrelated to the at-issue accident."

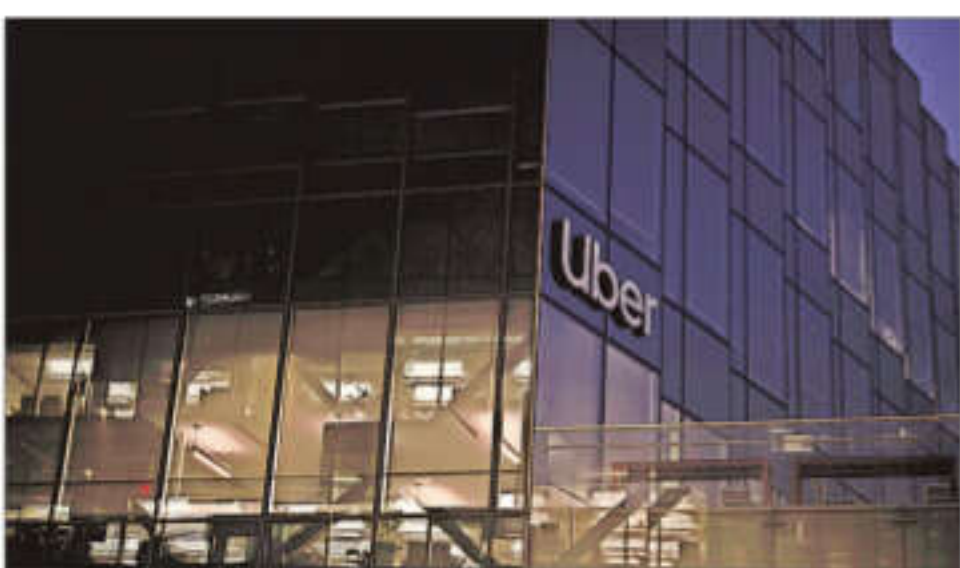
Uber's lawyer Taylor Silverberg zered in on the woman's behavior on the night she was raped. Silverberg asked her exactly how much Tito's vodka she had drunk, how many milligrams of Adderall she had taken and whether she had "felt re-

gret" about mixing the two. And she asked the woman what she had been wearing. "Can you describe the dress?" Silverberg said. "Were you wearing heels or boots or flats?"

Silverberg also probed the woman's childhood, asking if she had felt abandoned by her father or degraded by her mother. She pushed the 24-year-old for details about consensual sex and asked whether she had previously been sexually abused or had sex in exchange for money. That is when her lawyer ended the deposition.

"I am not anywhere near done," Silverberg protested. "It's her lawsuit, and I have an obligation to defend my client to the best of my ability," she added.

Later, she offered an apology: "I know this is hard for you, Ms. Doe. I am sorry. I really am. But —" "I'm grateful it is ending,"



The headquarters of Uber in San Francisco

Jane Doe said, interrupting. "This kills me," she added.

Uber's approach in her case is part of its defense strategy as it battles thousands of lawsuits from passengers accusing the company of failing to protect them from sexual violence they said they had suffered during

rides, according to thousands of pages of court records, including deposition and trial transcripts.

More than 4,000 lawsuits have been filed, so many that thousands were combined to streamline procedural matters. Most remain in the early stages. *The New York Times* reviewed

documents from the three cases that reached trial and about a dozen others that have advanced to the stage when the parties start exchanging documents and conducting depositions. The litigation has revealed a clear pattern: Uber's lawyers scour women's private communications, medical records, therapy notes and other sources for sensitive details, including other sexual assaults, childhood abuse and domestic violence. They grill the women about those issues, their sex lives and their behavior on the night of the incident.

In one case, Uber petitioned a judge to force a woman to turn over details about sexual abuse she experienced as a child by a family member and family friend. In another, Uber compelled a woman to undergo a psychiatric exam to investigate

other sexual assaults she had reported. And in another, a lawyer for Uber asked a woman whether she had been wearing underwear on the night in question and if she had become "extra sexually active" after the Uber incident.

"Focus was shifted away from the actual assault and onto my choices," she said. When she returned home to Oklahoma, she said she needed to take a break from nursing school.

In a statement, Bueno and Brown, partners at prominent law firm Kirkland & Ellis, said that they have an "ethical and professional obligation" to examine the credibility of each claim.

"We believe we performed our jobs as defence lawyers, and perhaps more significantly, our responsibility as women lawyers in these trials with a deep regard

and appropriate deference not just to the seriousness of the allegations but also the impact of the trial on both these plaintiffs and women more generally," they said.

Uber recently agreed to settle hundreds of lawsuits, including some nearing trial.

A woman in Texas says that Uber was negligent after a driver forced her to perform oral sex while driving down the highway. In a criminal trial, a jury found the driver guilty, sentencing him to 11 years in prison. The conviction was affirmed on appeal.

The woman's lawsuit is scheduled for trial in October. Uber has referred to the assault as an "alleged incident" in court documents. During a hearing in June, a judge asked Uber's lawyers whether the company would contest that the sexual assault happened. **NYT**





## GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

### OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER

### RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BOLANGIR

### e-Procurement Notice

25001/895/2627

|                                                  |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. <b>Name of work</b>                           | Construction of different School Buildings in the district of Bolangir for the year 2025-26                 |
| 2. <b>No. of works</b>                           | 7 (Seven) works                                                                                             |
| 3. <b>Time for completion</b>                    | 9 (Nine) Calendar months                                                                                    |
| 4. <b>Approximate estimated cost varies from</b> | Rs. 121.58 lakhs to Rs. 140.65 lakhs                                                                        |
| 5. <b>Mode of Submission of tender</b>           | Tender should be submitted online in <a href="http://www.tendersodisha.gov.in">www.tendersodisha.gov.in</a> |
| 6. <b>Other details are as follow</b>            |                                                                                                             |

| Procurement Officer                                | Bid Identification No. | Availability of Tender online for bidding |                           | Last date and time of seeking tender clarification | Date & Time of opening of Tender |                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
|                                                    |                        | From                                      | To                        |                                                    | Technical Bid                    | Financial Bid                       |
| Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Bolangir | BLGR-Online-14/2026-27 | 14.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M.                  | 25.08.2026 upto 5.00 P.M. | 24.08.2026 upto 5.00 P.M.                          | 28.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M.         | The date will be intimated later on |

● Further details can be seen from the website [www.tendersodisha.gov.in](http://www.tendersodisha.gov.in)

● Any Corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the above e tender website only.

Sd/-  
Chief Construction Engineer  
Rural Works Circle, Bolangir

OIPR- 25001/25118/1/26-27/0016





**CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED**  
Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru.Vi.Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

**E-Auction SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES**  
E-Auction Sale Notice for the Sale of Immovable Assets under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, r/w Rule 8(i) & 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. (Rule 8 & 9)  
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Mortgagee (s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the Secured Creditor, the **Physical possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited** the same shall be referred herein after as Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited. The Secured Assets will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** basis through E-Auction.  
It is hereby informed to General public that we are going to conduct public E-Auction through website <https://bankauctions.in>

**Loan Account Nos. TL01NDL00000051163, Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower, Mortgageors: 1. M/s. Guru Ji Enterprises, (Borrower), Plot No. 76-77, Left Portion Ground Floor, Wazipur Group Industrial Area, North West Delhi-110 052. 2. Mr. Som Dutt Bhandari, (Co Borrower) (Deceased), 3. Mrs. Pooja Bhandari, (Co Borrower), 4.Mr.Vishal Bhandari, (Legal Heir of the Deceased)/(Co Borrower), No 3 & 4 are residing at; Plot No. 66, Block – B, 1st Floor, Jeevan Niketan, LIC Colony, Near 910 Bus Stop, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi – 110 087. 5. Mr.Vikash Bhandari, (Legal Heir of the Deceased), B - 27, 1st Floor, LIC Colony, Near St. MARHKS School, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi – 110 087. Outstanding Amount: Rs.2,11,47,119/- as on 25.07.2026**  
**DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY:**  
All that a piece and parcel of the Property bearing Entire First Floor without roof rights, "the said floor" Part of Property no.66, area measuring 196.96 sq. yds., situated in the layout plan of The Northern Zone Insurance Employees Co-operative House Building Society Limited known as Block-B, Jeevan Colony LIC colony, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi – 110087 and which is bounded as under:- East - Plot No.65, West - Plot No.67, North - Service Lane 15 Ft.wide, South - Road 80 Ft.wide.

**Reserve Price : Rs. 2,60,00,000/-, EMD : Rs. 26,00,000/-, Bid Increment Amount : Rs.1,00,000/-**  
**E-Auction Date and Time : 25.08.2026 – 11 AM to 12 Noon (with unlimited extension of 3 min each)**  
**Last Date of Submission of EMD : 24.08.2026, Date of Inspection of Property : As per the appointment**  
1. All Interested participants / bidders are requested to visit the website <https://bankauctions.in> & [www.foreclosureindia.com](http://www.foreclosureindia.com). For details: help, procedure and online training on e-auction, prospective bidders may contact M/s. 4 Closure, (Contact Person: Mr. Shailendra, Ph. No. 9515160061, Email: shailendra@bankauctions.in).  
2. For further details on terms and conditions please visit:- <https://bankauctions.in> & <https://cholamandalam.com/news/authorities-notices> to take part in e-auction or contact Mr. Ved Prakash Mishra – 9910144252 / Mr. Naveen Kapoor – Ph: 77550 01547 / Mr. Kapil Sharma – Ph: 9205308879.  
**THIS IS ALSO A STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(i) & 9(1) AND OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES 2002 (Rule 8 & 9)**  
Date: 06.08.2026  
Place: Delhi  
Authorized Officer  
Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited.



**BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION**  
Office of the Executive Engineer, Anjanapura & Begur Division, Amruth Nagar, Konanakunte Main Road, Soudamini Layout, Bengaluru-560 062.

**No: EE/ABD/TEND/08/2026-27** **Date:07.08.2026**

**INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER**  
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Single & Two Cover Tender)  
The Executive Engineer, Anjanapura & Begur Division, invites tenders through KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from eligible tenderers registered with CPWD/KPWD/ Railways / MES/any State Govt. organizations for the work details in the table given below.

| Sl.No. | Name of the work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.     | Providing and Supplying of Tipper & Labours for Immersion of Ganesha Idols in ward No. 38 & 39 Gottigere Sub division for the year 2026-27 (2nd Call). Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>5.08 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 6,356/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                     |
| 2.     | Improvements to Roads and Drains at Beretena Agrahara and Lavakusha Nagara in Ward No 33, Naganathapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>29.66 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 29,661/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                                                 |
| 3.     | Providing Name Boards in Ward No. 33, Naganathapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>8.47 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 21,186/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                                                         |
| 4.     | Improvements Roads and Drains at DUO City Layout in Ward No 34, Chikka Thoguru. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                             |
| 5.     | Construction of CC Road at Chikka Thoguru Village Cross Roads in Ward No. 34 Chikka Thoguru. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>25.42 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 25,424/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                                                             |
| 6.     | Providing Name Boards in Ward No. 34 Chikka Thoguru. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>8.47 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 10,593/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                                                                             |
| 7.     | Improvements to Roads and Drains at MICO Layout near Gurukul School in Ward No 35 Vishwapiyanagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>25.42 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 25,424/-</b> Category: <b>ST.</b>                                                                                             |
| 8.     | Improvements to Roads and Drains at 3rd Cross and 4th Cross of Patel Layout in Ward No 35, Visliwapiyva Nagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                             |
| 9.     | Improvements to Roads and Drains at Vinayaka Layout Cross Roads Chikka Begur in Ward No 35, Vishwapiyva Nagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>16.95 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                             |
| 10.    | Construction of RCC Drain at 8th Cross of Yejaman Layout in Ward No 36 Begur. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>38.14 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 76,271/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                               |
| 11.    | Improvements to roads and drains at 5th Cross, Chowdeshwari Layout in Ward No 36, Begur. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>29.66 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 29,661/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                                        |
| 12.    | Asphalting to 1st Cross to 5th Cross Roads of VIP Layout, Akshayanagara in Ward No 37, Yelleanahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>67.80 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                                                    |
| 13.    | Resurfacing to Central Excise Layout and Surrounding Roads in Ward 38, Doddka Kammanahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>67.80 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                                                              |
| 14.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Weavers Colony in Ward No.39, Gottigere. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>67.80 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>ST.</b>                                                                                                                    |
| 15.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Gollahalli and Anjanapura Village Ward No. 40, Anjanapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>76.27 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 76,271/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                                  |
| 16.    | Improvements to roads and drains at Ashraya Colony and Raghavanapalya in ward No. 41, Kothnur. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>67.80 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 1,35,593/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                            |
| 17.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at RBI Layout in ward No. 42, RBI Layout. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>42.37 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 84,746/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                                  |
| 18.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at S.K.Nataraj Layout in ward no 42, RBI Layout. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                           |
| 19.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Muniswamappa Garden in ward No. 43, Beereshwara Nagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>42.37 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                                     |
| 20.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Renukambanagara in ward No. 43, Beereshwara Nagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                     |
| 21.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Avalahalli and Surrounding area in ward No. 44, Harinagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>59.32 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 1,18,644/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                           |
| 22.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at Ashraya Colony and Avalahalli BDA Quarters in ward No. 45, Konanakunte. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>42.37 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                                              |
| 23.    | Improvements to Roads and drains at at Konanakunte Village in ward No. 45, Konanakunte. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 33,898/-</b> Category: <b>ST.</b>                                                                                                         |
| 24.    | Construction of Concrete road and Drain Desilting at Jettappa layout in Ward No. 46, Yelachenahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                        |
| 25.    | Construction of Concrete road and Drain Desilting at Kanakanagar and Faizabad in Ward No. 46, Yelachenahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 67,797/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                               |
| 26.    | Providing Cross Name Boards in Ward No. 46, Yelachenahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>8.47 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 21,186/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                                                  |
| 27.    | Improvements to Roads and Drains at Illyasnagar and surrounding area in Ward No. 47, Chandranagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>25.42 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 25,424/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                             |
| 28.    | Improvements to Roads and Drains at Ward Limit in Ward No. 47, Chandranagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                               |
| 29.    | Improvements to Drains and Culvert at Om Shakthi Temple, Chandranagar and Surrounding area in Ward No. 47, Chandranagara. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                   |
| 30.    | Construction of Concrete road and Drain Desilting at Sharadhanagar Cross roads in Ward No. 48, Vasanthapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>29.66 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 29,661/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-I</b>                                                                                  |
| 31.    | Construction of Concrete road at Doddakalsandra Village in Ward No. 48, Vasanthapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>25.42 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 50,847/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                       |
| 32.    | Providing Cross Name Boards in Ward No. 48, Vasanthapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>8.47 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 21,186/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                                                                    |
| 33.    | Improvements to Drain and Culvert at Maruthinagar in Ward No. 49, Uttarahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>8.47 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 21,186/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-I</b>                                                                                                                 |
| 34.    | Reconstruction of Concrete road and Improvements Of Drains at Nagappa layout in Ward No 49, Uttarahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                    |
| 35.    | Improvements to Drains at Uttarahalli Behind Anjaneya Swamy Temple in Ward No 49, Uttarahalli. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                                              |
| 36.    | Improvements to Drains and Asphalting of 4th cross Naidu Layout in Ward No. 50, Sarvabhooma Nagar. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>33.90 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 33,898/-</b> Category: <b>SC.</b>                                                                                              |
| 37.    | Improvements to Drains and Asphalting of Balance Portion Cross road of Doctors colony in Ward No. 50, Sarvabhooma Nagar. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>29.66 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 59,322/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                    |
| 38.    | Improvements to Drains and other Development Works at BHCS layout, Lakkegowdanagar in Ward No. 51, Subratnayanapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>25.42 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 50,847/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                                        |
| 39.    | Improvements to Drains and other Development works at Banashankari 5th stage NPS Surrounding area in Ward No 51, Subramanyapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>21.19 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 21,186/-</b> Category: <b>CAT-II(A).</b>                                                         |
| 40.    | Improvements to Drains and other Development works at Munivenkatappa layout and Surrounding area in Ward No 51, Subramanyapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>16.95 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 42,373/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b>                                                             |
| 41.    | Improvements to Roads and drains Culverts and Other Development works at Sangameshwara Layout, Ganigara Palya, Talaghattapura Village and Surrounding Layouts Ward No.52, Talaghattapura. Approx. amount put to Tender: <b>119.2 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 1,78,800/-</b> Category: <b>Others.</b> |

1) Tender Documents can be downloaded from KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from **12.08.2026** onwards. 2) Last Date for uploading the Filled Tender Documents: **21.08.2026 upto 04.00 p.m.** 3) Opening of Technical bids: **24.08.2026 after 04.30 p.m.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.  
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Anjanapur & Begur Division.



**DEVELOPMENT SUPPORT AGENCY OF GUJARAT**  
An autonomous Society promoted by Tribal Development Department,  
Govt. of Gujarat (Phone no.079-232-52257)



સામાજિક વિકાસ એજન્સી

**CORRIGENDUM-2**  
Development Support Agency of Gujarat (D-SAG) is developing the National Tribal Freedom Fighters Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla in the Narmada District. D-SAG has issued a Tender Notice on Dated. 18/07/2026 for Construction and Management Agency (CMA) for the Phase-3 (Package-A & B) of the National Tribal Freedom Fighters Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla. In Context to that a corrigendum is issued for  
**Package A Tender ID-325472.** Tender title: Construction and Operation & Maintenance of other buildings package of National Tribal Freedom Fighter Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla, Narmada District, Gujarat.  
And  
**Package B Tender ID-325589.** Tender title: Construction and Operation & Maintenance of Museum and allied works for National Tribal Freedom Fighter Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla, Narmada District, Gujarat.  
**In Package A & B, the following documents have been added:**  
1. Vol IID Technical specs- R&B General Technical Specification Booklet for Civil Work  
2. Amended BOQ & Final Price Bid.  
3. Pre-Bid Response, Presentation and Walk Through  
**Package A, the following documents have been revised:**  
4. Vol IID Technical specifications\_R1  
5. Vol IIE Make List R1- Revised Make List  
**Package B, the following documents have been revised:**  
6. Vol IIA DBR 1\_1 R1- Design Basis Report part 1 of 1- HVAC, FFTG & Electrical  
7. Vol IIA DBR 1\_2 R1- Design Basis Report part 1 of 2- ELV, Security system, Fire alarm, AV system, PHE & Lift  
8. Vol IIA DBR 2 R1- Design Basis Report part 2- Curation & related works  
9. Vol IID Technical specifications\_R1-Revised Detailed Technical specifications for Curation & related works  
10. Vol IIE Make List R1- Revised Make List  
11. Vol IIG Drawing- Revised Set 03\_ Exhibits Sectional details drawings  
12. Vol II F BOQ- Updated Final Price Bid  
13. Vol III Soft Content matrix- Revised Soft Content Matrix  
14. Vol II J Artifact index- Revised Artefact Index  
15. Vol I - Annexure 11\_R2 brief of technical presentation  
16. Vol I - Annexure 10 Penalty in case of non-performance  
17. Vol I -Standard bidding document updated.  
18. List of Tribal Major Movements  
Extension for bid submission for both tender Packages are as per below.  
**Online submission date - 18-08-2026 up to 5 PM.**  
**Hard bound submission - 18-08-2026 up to 5 PM.**  
**Technical Bid Opening - 18-08-2026 at 6 PM.**  
**All necessary documentation corrigendum will be uploaded by 07/08/2026.**  
All bidders are requested to take note of the above and consider the additional documents while preparing and submitting their bids. For detailed scope of work, eligibility criteria, terms & conditions, interested agencies may visit the website <https://tender.nprocure.com/>

**INF-1095-2026-27**

**સમેકિત જનજાતીય વિકાસ અધિકરણ, સાહેબગંજ**  
**ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना।**  
**अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सं०-01/2026-27/आई0टी0डी0ए0, साहेबगंज।**

| क्र० | Identification Number      | प्रखंड   | योजना का नाम                                                       | प्रकाशित राशि (लाख में) | अग्रघन की राशि (लाख में) | निविदा शुल्क | कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि | Tender Call |
|------|----------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|--------------|-----------------------|-------------|
| 1    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 01/2026-27 | तालझर्री | आवासीय उच्च विद्यालय, धनमभियाँ में 80 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण।    | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |
| 2    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 02/2026-27 | पतना     | आवासीय उच्च विद्यालय, जमनेरी में 50 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण।      | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |
| 3    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 03/2026-27 | बखेट     | आवासीय उच्च विद्यालय, अरगरी में 50 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण।       | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |
| 4    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 04/2026-27 | कोरियो   | आवासीय उच्च विद्यालय, चौदवारी में 50 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण।     | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |
| 5    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 05/2026-27 | कोरियो   | आवासीय बालिका उच्च विद्यालय, अदरो में 50 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण। | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |
| 6    | ITDA/ Sahibganj 06/2026-27 | पतना     | आवासीय उच्च विद्यालय, दिबरीकोल में 50 सैय्या छात्रावास निर्माण।    | 275.00                  | 5.50                     | 10000.00     | 12 माह                | 1st         |

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :- 17.08.2026  
2. ई-निविदा प्राप्त की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :- 31.08.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक  
3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 01.09.2026 के 03:00 बजे अपराह्न में।  
4. केवल ई-निविदा ही स्वीकार की जायेगी।  
5. ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग एवं भवन निर्माण विभाग के समुचित श्रेणी के संवेदक ही निविदा में भाग लेंगे।  
6. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- जिला कल्याण पदाधिकारी, साहेबगंज।  
7. निविदा संबंधित विशेष जानकारी हेतु मोबाईल नं०-7739341122 पर कार्यालय अवधि में समर्पक किया जा सकता है।  
8. परिमाण बिपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।  
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।  
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भूतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।  
निवेदित जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट <http://www.jbarkhandtenders.gov.in> के NREP Sahibganj Section में देखा जा सकता है।  
जिला कल्याण पदाधिकारी  
-साह-परियोजना निदेशक,  
आई0टी0डी0ए0, साहेबगंज।

**PR.NO.386851 District(26-27):D**



**HIMACHAL PRADESH**  
**PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT**  
e-mail [ce-roh-hp@nic.in](mailto:ce-roh-hp@nic.in)  
e-Procurement Notice  
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)



सामाजिक विकास एजेंसी

The Executive Engineer HP PWD Rohru Distt Shimla H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites item rate, bids, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover system for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/firms registered with HP PWD Department.

| Sr. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Estimated Cost (Rs) | Starting date for downloading Bid | Earnest money | Deadline for submission bid |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------|
| 1.      | C/o Veterinary Hospital at ,Pujari-4 (SH:-Civil work including WS&SI, Rain Harvesting,Turbine Septic tank-22.5)                                                                                                                                                                           | 6357224             | 10-8-2026                         | 127144        | 18-8-2026                   |
| 2.      | C/o Wire mesh fencing surrounding Govt Sr Sec School Kuthari in Gp Kuthari Tehsil Tikkar dist shimla H.P (SH:- P/F wire mesh fencing )                                                                                                                                                    | 999572              | 10-8-2026                         | 19991         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 3.      | A/R and M/OLink road to village Dhanoti (SH:- Imp. of narrow reaches at RD 1/120 to 1/285)                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2478683             | 10-8-2026                         | 49574         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 4.      | C/o Madanpur to kalmata mandir sarandhi Dhar km 0/0 to 2/00 (SH:- Widening of narrow reaches at various RD and R/wall at RD 0/30 to 0/45, and HPC at RD 0/345 , 0/090 & P/L Kharanja Stone solling at various Rd's)                                                                       | 1119081             | 10-8-2026                         | 22382         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 5.      | A/R M/O Link road to village Thana km 0/0 to 4/00 (SH:- Imp. of black spot on various RD between 0/255 to 0/375)                                                                                                                                                                          | 1447607             | 10-8-2026                         | 28952         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 6.      | R/R damages on Seri Chandigarh road km 0/0 to 6/300 (SH:- C/o R/wall at RD 2/570 to 2/590 , B/wall at RD 3/280 to 3/300 & 3/480 to 3/500)                                                                                                                                                 | 1214365             | 10-8-2026                         | 24287         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 7.      | R/R Damages on Tikkar Deorighat Via Gujandil road km 0/0 to 7/690 (SH:- C/o R/wall at RD 6/735 to 6/755 , 6/780 to 6/700 to 6/712 , 3/645 to 3/655 & B/wall at RD 6/730 to 6/740, P/L G-3 in various patches)                                                                             | 1394420             | 10-8-2026                         | 27888         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 8.      | RR damages on lambidhar karali bandrog khatal road km 0/00 to 5/00 (SH:- P/L kharanja stone soling at various RD and R/wall at RD 3/00 to 3/020)                                                                                                                                          | 1422033             | 10-8-2026                         | 28441         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 9.      | RR damages on Umladwar Pharog road 0/0 to 7/00 (SH:- B/wall at RD 2/300 to 2/340,4/200 to 4/230, and Rwall 3/580 to 3/595, 3/720 to 3/730 P/L G-3 in various patches)                                                                                                                     | 2288518             | 10-8-2026                         | 45770         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 10.     | R/R Damages on Mehndi Tikkar (Portion) road KM 9/00 TO 28/640 (SH :- C/O B/WALL AT RD 14/250-14/300& R/WALL AT RD 14/350-14/370 ,C/O PCC DRAIN AT RD 12/500-16/00 & hume pipe culvert at rd 13/030 & WIDENING OF BLACK SPOT AT RD 14/045-14/075,14/925-15/015,P/L G-3 in various patches) | 2427544             | 10-8-2026                         | 48551         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 11.     | RR damages on link road to village gheota km 0/00 to 2/00 SH C/O Bwall at Rd 0/720 to 0/740, R/wall at Rd 1/215 to 1/230 and Kharanja solling in essential reaches )                                                                                                                      | 1630181             | 10-8-2026                         | 32604         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 12.     | R/R damages on Seri Chandigarh road km 0/0 to 6/300 (SH:- C/O R/wall at RD1/300 to 1/315,1/760 to 1/770 and B/wall at RD in wire crate at Rd 1/640 to 1/655,1/800 to 1/810)                                                                                                               | 1125445             | 10-8-2026                         | 22509         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 13.     | R/R Damages on Tikkar deorighat via gujandil km 0/00 to 7/690SH C/O B/wall at Rd 0/210 to 2/260, 4/500-22 to 5/300 R/wall at RD 6/090 to 6/105,R/wall at Rd 6/570 to 6/581,6/1610 to 1/616,6/10 P/L G-3 in various patches)                                                               | 2654596             | 10-8-2026                         | 53092         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 14.     | RR damages onMehandi Tikkar road 0/00 to 28/00 SH: C/O Rwall at Rd 10/020 to 10/030, R/wall in PCC& stone masonry Cml-6 at Rd 11/355 to 11/375& B/wall at Rd 11/430 to 11/460 P/L G-3 in various patches)                                                                                 | 2685077             | 10-8-2026                         | 53702         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 15.     | RR damages on Gangangar Khangra road 0/00 to 27/00 SH: C/OPCC Edge wall and C/O Embankment P/L GSB, G-2,G-3 in various reaches )                                                                                                                                                          | 2892157             | 10-8-2026                         | 57843         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 16.     | R/R Damages On mehndi tikar road 9/00 to 28/640 , SH :- C/O R/ WALL & B/WALL at RD17/700-17/725 , 17/735-17/795 , 18/040-18/1070 WIRE CRATE IN R/WALL & B/WALL 17/800-17/810, 18/030-18/040P/L G-3 in various patches)                                                                    | 2621070             | 10-8-2026                         | 52421         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 17.     | R/R Damages On mehndi tikar road 9/00 to 28/640 , SH B/wall at Rd 12/550 to 12/570 , R/wall at Rd 10/945 to 10/965, 12/545 to 12/570 & 900 num dia HPC at rd 10/405 and improvement of narrow reaches )                                                                                   | 2205108             | 10-8-2026                         | 44102         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 18.     | RR damages on Ganasidhar Kadiwan Road km 0/00 to 11/300 SH C/O Uline drain and removal of slips P/L CD at Rd 9/990, R/wall at Rd 11/250)                                                                                                                                                  | 1520610             | 10-8-2026                         | 30412         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 19.     | R/R Damages on Ganasidhar Tikkar Baidhar road km 0/00 to 23/500 (SH: C/O Rwall at Rd 4/370 to 4/390, 9/060 to 9/085, 8/600 to 8/612,50, 9/915 to 9/930, B/wall at Rd 9/060 to 9/800)                                                                                                      | 1918966             | 10-8-2026                         | 38379         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 20.     | R/R damages on Pujari kati saraidhar km 0/00 to 16/00 SH: C/O R/wall at Rd 5/765 to 5/800)                                                                                                                                                                                                | 911150              | 10-8-2026                         | 18223         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 21.     | R/R damages on Badshah nallah ramtei kharla road km 0/00 to 6/500 (SH: C/O R/wall at rd 6/454 and B/wall at Rd 6/110 to 6/1253/500 to 3/530)                                                                                                                                              | 1520135             | 10-8-2026                         | 30403         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 22.     | R/R damages on Tutupani kuthari khlagar ghansi road km 0/00 to 19/680 (SH:-9/960 to 9/975,3/210 to 230,3/950 to 3/970,4/750 to 4/770,5/200 to 5/240)                                                                                                                                      | 950623              | 10-8-2026                         | 19012         | 18-8-2026                   |
| 23.     | RR damages on Tutupani kuthari khlagar ghansi road km 0/00 to 19/680 (SH: Rwall at Rd 2/090 to 2/105, 5/450 to 5/470,7/345 to 7/360 B/wall at RD 4/585 to 4/600)                                                                                                                          | 960625              | 10-8-2026                         | 19213         | 18-8-2026                   |

The Bidders are advised to note other details for tenders and letter No.PWD(B) A(3) 1/2020 dated 12.01.2023 issued by secretary PW) to the Govt. of himachal Pradesh Public Works Department from the department website [www.hptenders.gov.in](http://www.hptenders.gov.in), and any corrigendum will be uploaded on the website only.  
Executive Engineer  
HP PWD Division Rohru Distt Shimla HP  
No. 2483/2026-2027/HP



**CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED**  
Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru.Vi.Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

**POSSESSION NOTICE (Rule 4(1)) (For Movable Property / Asset)**  
Whereas the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of **M/s.CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED**, under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002 issued a **Demand Notice Dated 20.04.2026 (Loan Account No.EF01NIC0000062977** calling upon the Borrower / Co Borrowers (1.M/s. K.S. Engineering, 2.Mr. Kuldeep, 3.Mrs. Anju) to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs.34,21,176/- (Rupees Thirty Four Lakh Twenty One Thousand One Hundred Seventy Six Only)** as on **20.04.2026** together with further interest and charges thereafter within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.  
The Borrower / Co Borrowers having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower / Co Borrowers and the Public in general that the undersigned has taken Symbolic possession of the property described herein below in exercise of the powers conferred on him under Sub-Section (4) of Section 13 of Act read



THE MODEL BILATERAL INVESTMENT TREATY IS EXPECTED TO SOON BE SENT TO CABINET FOR ITS APPROVAL

# Protecting Indian cos’ outward FDI part of model BIT review: DEA Secy

Siddharth Upasani  
New Delhi, August 7

ENSURING THE rising foreign direct investment (FDI) by Indian companies is protected is an “entirely new dimension” the government is seeing in its negotiations even as it continues its review of the model Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT), Economic Affairs Secretary Anuradha Thakur said on Friday, adding that it will soon be sent to the Cabinet for approval.

“...with ODI (overseas direct investment) flowing out, every negotiation we also have to bear in mind that our own investors, companies will also need protection. So that is an entirely new dimension that we are now seeing in our negotiations. So, some of these clauses will actually be useful to keep,” Thakur said on Friday at New Delhi-based think tank National Council of Applied Economic Research’s India Policy Forum.

She was responding to a question on whether the government is looking to reduce the five-year timeframe the 2015 model BIT demands foreign investors exhaust in pursuit of domestic legal remedies before seeking international arbitration to settle disputes. Critics have

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often cited this local-remedies clause — which did not exist prior to the 2015 model BIT — as a hurdle for foreign investors.

The Indian Express had reported back in June that one of the principles underpinning the Centre’s review of the model BIT is a reduced timeline of a minimum two years for local remedies before initiation of international arbitration.

BITs are crucial for promotion and protection of investors as they pour money into each other’s countries.

Over the last couple of years, FDI by Indian companies has risen so sharply that it has contributed — along with repatriation of past investments by foreign investors — to a precipitous fall in net FDI into India. This has significantly weakened India’s Balance of Payments (BoP) situation and led to the rapid weakening of the rupee.

India’s net FDI inflows have gradually slumped in the last few years from almost \$44 billion in 2020-21 to less than \$1 billion in 2024-25, before recovering slightly to \$7 billion in 2025-26. While this was driven by foreign investors repatriating more than \$105 billion in 2024-25 and 2025-26 combined, Indian companies have also been

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## ● OUTBOUND SURGE

OVER THE last couple of years, FDI by Indian companies has risen so sharply that it has contributed, along with repatriation of past investments by foreign investors, to a precipitous fall in net FDI into India

THIS HAS significantly weakened India’s Balance of Payments situation and led to the rapid weakening of the rupee over the last year or so

INDIA’S NET FDI inflows have gradually slumped in the last few



years from almost \$44 billion in 2020-21 to less than \$1 billion in 2024-25, before recovering slightly to \$7 billion in 2025-26

investing more and more abroad: from \$11 billion in 2020-21 to \$28 billion in 2024-25 and \$34 billion in 2025-26.

Gross FDI rose from \$82 billion in 2020-21 to a record \$95 billion in 2025-26.

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran had in December said the reversal of India’s net FDI fortunes was partially due to the localisation of global supply chains, with India having to compete not just with other emerging economies but also developed countries who want to onshore their production.

On Friday, Thakur noted that while gross FDI inflows have increased, it was “certainly not enough for a country like ours, which is why we are constantly engaging at the policy level” to increase it.

On rising FDI by Indian companies, she said it is “a good thing as it shows a certain maturity of the Indian private sector”.

However, she rejected claims that foreigners were hesitant to invest in India because of fears of potential action by law enforcement agencies such as the Enforcement Direc-

torate, saying foreign capital looks for returns and stability, which India offers.

“I would say the direction in which (enforcement) agencies are working is to be more procedure driven, more transparent, and laws are also being taken on head-on to actually reduce the criminal content so as to limit only those offences which are very severe,” Thakur said, adding that any frivolous and excessive action was being reigned in. “But to say because of the fear (of investigative agencies) FDI is not coming — I would take it as an input. I think we need to do a lot more outreach as well as allay any other (fears) that foreign investors may have because I do think that investment in India is growing mainly because of what we offer,” she said.

Thakur also said the government is reviewing several clauses and not just the local remedies one and the framework is “open right now”. “In fact, there is a model of what can we place out there and have a negative list, whatever the clause or article may be. So, we are also looking at those kinds of items, the really important red flags for us, set them aside and on the rest, what is the maximum we can put out there,” she said.

# Solar manufacturing push: Govt weighs PLI for local polysilicon production

Pratyush Deep  
New Delhi, August 7

THE GOVERNMENT is preparing a production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for polysilicon manufacturing as it seeks to deepen India’s solar manufacturing value chain and reduce import dependence.

Polysilicon is a key raw material used in solar photovoltaic (PV) modules and India currently relies completely on imports for it.

Speaking at the seventh Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) International Energy Conference and Exhibition, Santosh Kumar Sarangi, Secretary at Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), said the “support scheme” aims to encourage domestic polysilicon manufacturing in the country.

In the solar manufacturing value chain, polysilicon represents the upstream segment which is processed into ingots. These ingots are sliced into wafers, which, in turn, are used to manufacture solar cells. These cells are subsequently assembled into modules, or panels.

There is already a PLI scheme for solar PV modules that covers both upstream — ingot, wafer and polysilicon — and downstream — solar cell and module manufacturing — segments.

However, progress under it has been slower in upstream segments such as polysilicon refining and ingot and wafer production.

The government’s understanding is that polysilicon manufacturing should be treated as an independent industry and not only as part of the solar manufacturing value chain. This is because polysilicon manufacturing is more of a chemical and refining process. Greater refining polysilicon

## ● SOLAR BOOST

POLYSILICON IS a key raw material used in solar photovoltaic modules and India currently relies completely on imports for it

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Real Creator IAS Edition [https://t.me/+2RvD\\_RGf9mliMzg1](https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mliMzg1) can also be used in the semiconductor industry.

### ‘RE bringing down power cost’

Sarangi said the electricity tariff of round-the-clock renewable energy (RE-RTC) is almost matching the nuclear power.

Referring to a recently concluded tender by Solar Energy Corporation of India Limited (SECI), he said the tariff discovered for that RE-RTC tender which assured 90% power availability in each time block and only 50% solar during the daytime, was at Rs 5.25 per unit. “If you look at the profile of this RE-RTC bid, it almost matches the nuclear power,” he said.

He further said that cheap renewable energy is also helping in bringing down average cost of power purchase by distribution utilities.

“If you look at the average cost of power purchased by DISCOMs for the last three years, it has either declined or has remained stagnant. The same was earlier increasing at a rapid pace. But it has largely been stagnant or declined because of infusion of cheaper RE in the portfolio. This has

allowed DISCOMs to lower their average power purchase cost,” he said.

According to Sarangi, combination of solar and wind or solar and Battery Energy Storage System or RE RTC could bring down average power procurement cost for discom from Rs 5.20 per unit on average to Rs 4.85 per unit.

### Cell capacity to reach 100 GW

Sarangi also said India’s domestic solar cell manufacturing capacity is expected to more than triple to 100 gigawatts (GW) within a year, from the current installed capacity of around 32 GW.

The planned capacity expansion assumes significance as India tightens domestic sourcing requirements for solar cells. While the country has built a solar module manufacturing capacity of around 213 GW per annum, its solar cell manufacturing capacity remains far lower, highlighting a key gap in the domestic value chain.

Moving further upstream, Sarangi said the government expects the country’s ingot and wafer manufacturing capacity will reach 80 GW by June 2028.

## ● BRIEFLY

### SBI’s Q1 profit rises by 14%

Mumbai: State Bank of India on Friday reported a 13.73% increase in its June quarter consolidated net profit at Rs 24,113 crore as core income improved and provisions declined. On a standalone basis, the bank’s net profit grew 10.23% on-year to Rs 21,121.22 crore as against Rs 19,160.44 crore in April-June 2025, as per an exchange filing. PTI

### India’s forex kitty at 3-month peak

Mumbai: India’s foreign exchange reserves (forex) rose to a near three-month high of \$692.9 billion as of July 31, data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) showed on Wednesday. Reserves jumped nearly \$10.5 billion compared to the previous week. A larger pile of forex gives the RBI greater capacity to defend the rupee. REUTERS

## ● MARKETS

|                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |
| Sensex                                                                                | NIFTY                                                                                 | Gold ▲                                                                                | US Dollar ▼                                                                           |
| 78,499.17                                                                             | 24,570.65                                                                             | ₹1,49,621                                                                             | ₹95.21                                                                                |
| -455.59                                                                               | -65.35                                                                                |  |  |
| -0.58%                                                                                | -0.27%                                                                                | Silver ▲                                                                              | Oil ▲                                                                                 |
|                                                                                       |                                                                                       | ₹2,31,381                                                                             | \$85.05                                                                               |

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA  
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 6, 2026

● THE COMPANY ARGUES THAT IT NO LONGER ACCESSES PUBLIC FUNDS DIRECTLY AND THEREFORE SHOULD NOT CONTINUE TO BE REGULATED LIKE A SYSTEMICALLY IMPORTANT NBFC

# To list or not to list: The key arguments in Tata Sons’ raging IPO debate

ENS Economic Bureau  
Mumbai, August 7

A NEW Reserve Bank of India (RBI) notification has yet again placed the spotlight on one of corporate India’s longest-running governance debates: Should Tata Sons, the principal holding company of the \$180-billion Tata group, remain a privately held company or become a listed entity?

On Thursday, the RBI included Tata Sons in its latest list of Upper Layer Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFC-ULs) which will lead to its listing on the exchanges. But it simultaneously added an important caveat — Tata Sons’ application for deregistration as a Core Investment Company (CIC) is still under examination.

The final outcome of that application will determine

whether the company ultimately has to launch an initial public offering (IPO) and list its shares on the stock exchanges. The RBI’s decision comes at a time when the debate over listing has intensified within Tata Trusts, the majority shareholder in Tata Sons, and when the company is reporting record profits alongside mounting losses in some of its biggest unlisted businesses.

The central issue is no longer whether Tata Sons qualifies as an Upper Layer NBFC. It is whether RBI accepts its request to stop being regulated as one. In March 2024, Tata Sons applied to surrender its registration as a Core Investment Company after repaying its standalone borrowings.

The company’s argument is understood to be that it no longer accesses public funds di-

rectly and therefore should not continue to be regulated like a systemically important NBFC.

### Who is arguing for listing, & who is opposed?

The debate over listing has increasingly become a governance issue within Tata Trusts. Tata trusts, which own about 66% of Tata Sons, are no longer unanimous on the issue. Chairman Noel Tata is understood to favour retaining Tata Sons as an unlisted company, broadly continuing the position earlier associated with Ratan Tata.

Some former Tata Sons directors, including NA Soonawala and R Gopalakrishnan are also opposed to listing.

On the other hand, trustees of Tata Trusts Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have publicly ar-



Tata Sons had applied to surrender its registration as a Core Investment Company in March 2024. REUTERS

gued that the company should now go for listing. Their case rests on three broad arguments. First, Tata Sons today is significantly larger and more complex than when it decided to remain private. The Tata group has ex-

panded into capital-intensive sectors such as aviation, semiconductors, electronics, batteries and defence manufacturing, all of which require sustained access to long-term capital.

Second, they argue that a listed Tata Sons would improve transparency, governance and regulatory oversight without fundamentally diluting Tata Trusts’ control, given their large shareholding. Third, they believe listing would unlock value for minority shareholders and provide a transparent exit mechanism for the Pallonji (SP) Group, which owns 18.3% of Tata Sons and has favoured listing. InGovern has also argued that listing would bring Tata Sons under SEBI’s Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR), resulting in greater disclosure, stronger governance standards, better oversight of related-party transactions and independent board representation. Opponents, however, continue to believe Tata Sons should remain

privately held to preserve its existing ownership structure, culture, heritage, unique position for the last 100 years and avoid opening the company to public market pressures.

### What happens if Tata Sons is listed—and what if it gets exempted?

If RBI rejects the deregistration application and Tata Sons is eventually listed, several changes would follow. The company would become subject not only to RBI’s enhanced regulatory framework for Upper Layer NBFCs but also to SEBI’s listing regulations. It would need to disclose quarterly financial results, strengthen board independence, comply with stricter governance norms and face greater

scrutiny from investors and markets. Listing would also create a market-based valuation for Tata Sons, potentially unlocking value for minority shareholders including the Pallonji Group, which owns 18.3% stake. Supporters argue that public markets would also provide Tata Sons with an additional avenue to raise capital for future expansion into technology and manufacturing sectors. If RBI approves Tata Sons’ deregistration application, the company will remain privately held with Tata Trusts holding considerable influence in the entity. That would preserve the existing ownership structure dominated by Tata Trusts and spare the company from the disclosure and governance obligations applicable to listed companies.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)



# Flying High on Grit and Grace

Shubhra Gupta

HOW MUCH courage is required to strap yourself into a lean mean machine and take off into the air, flying at supersonic speeds, zero-ing in on a target with snap-shot judgement which will make the difference between life and death, defeat and victory? The best war films deliver those moments, where the viewer and the man in the hot seat are breathing together, in their attempt to seek and find and destroy: the handsomely-mounted, solidly-executed *Operation Safed Sagar* gives us all of the above — combat pilots risking their lives with a smile, families living with bated breath and eternal optimism, and the men on the ground taking those tough calls, win or lose.

The series, with its six 45-55-minute episodes, directed by Oni Sen, with Sandeep Jain, Nikhil Ravi, Barun Kashyap, Abhijeet Singh Parmar sharing story and screenplay credits, is easily among the best battle accounts that I've seen recently. It's not just the men and their machines; it's not just the swagger that goes with the territory — those have been part of the game ever since Tom Cruise top-gunned his way down the tarmac, leaving other actors dying to don those cool aviators and loop the loops.

What gives the show its emotional heft is that we also see them as humans with their aches and pains, strengths and vulnerabilities: the characters feel lived-in, like they've stayed in those quarters and shared the same mess, and merrily 'bounced' at their senior officers' homes (a bonding ritual familiar to air force families, which invite the marauding bachelors into their house, plying them with food and drink, turning the whole thing into a party).

Siddharth plays Flight Commander Ajay Ahuja, the guy who knows all the tricks in the book, and then some. He is called in to shape the callow Golden Arrows into being their most effective selves, centimetre by agonising centimetre. The summon comes via their superior (Jimmy Shergill), and the hard training comes in good stead when war breaks out, and the derring-do Arrows take to the skies to make the peaks safe again.

The operation is termed as a 'little-known' aspect of the 1999 Kargil conflict. Most of the earlier films made on the subject revolved around the army and its troops inching their way up the treacherous, snow-



filled peaks of the Drass and Kargil sector, being picked off by the Pakistani infiltrators who had moved in, taking advantage of the lull caused by the Lahore declaration, an outcome of then Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee's decision to take a bus to the neighbouring country on a *shanti yatra*.

The intention was noble, but was foiled by the machinations of General Parvez Musharraf, who took that opportunity to install his soldiers masquerading as mujahideens on the Indian side of the peaks, despite the Pak premier Nawaz Sharif's (Vinay Pathak) best efforts to keep things on track.

There's a degree of nuance in these details which provide depth, even if some portions feel constructed. But, and this is crucial, there's no attempt at retrofitting uncomfortable state actions; the insertion of real-life TV news clips is merely there to buttress the happenings in the show. It never gives Pakistan an out, and even as it reveals Sharif's increasingly weakened hold on power, as well as the ghastly torture wrought upon a captured Indian pilot in a camp run by a Musharraf loyalist (Danish Husain) with a noble streak, the series doesn't de-

## OPERATION SAFED SAGAR

★★★★

**DIRECTOR:** Oni Sen  
**CAST:** Siddharth, Jimmy Shergill, Vinay Pathak, Manu Rishi Chadha, Aanjan Srivastav, Dia Mirza, Amrita Bagchi, Adil Hussain, Abhay Verma, Mihir Ahuja, Taaruk Raina, Prajakta Koli, Arnab Bhasin, Danish Husain, SM Zaheer

**STREAMING ON:** Netflix

scend into name-calling or bigotry.

The near-naïve Sharif's desire to be seen as the man who was on board with Vajpayee's attempts to mend the frayed ties between the two nations is in keeping with how history has judged him. Even Musharraf's (Manu Rishi Chadha in a career-best performance, scarily and persuasively spot-on) villainy is never turned into an exaggeration: he is who he is, and he will do anything to grab Kashmir, even if it goes against the Geneva Convention. But the show's forays into the American and Chinese territories border on the laughable, making those men into near-clowns, with accented actors playing dress-up.

But *Operation Safed Sagar* makes none of these mistakes when it comes to the Indian *faujdis*: all of them look as if they have earned their stripes, whether it is Siddharth and Shergill, or the young uns' (Abhay Verma, Mihir Ahuja, Taaruk Raina, Arnab Bhasin, each with their quirk), or the other uniformed men who show up briefly (Sanjay Suri, Barun Sobti), or the top honcho (Adil Hussain). Yes, it does turn into an explainer (first we will do this, and then do this) in more

than one place. Yes, there's dialoguing, rather than speaking, but we will make those allowances for men used to giving and taking explicit orders. And yes, there are the aerial dog fights which, while remaining consistently thrilling, can't escape their clear CGI origins.

But none of these are deal-breakers. Siddharth, the leader who leads from the front, is wonderful (and of course we've never forgotten him in *Rang De Basanti*, that 20-year-old film, also featuring falling planes and idealistic youngsters, which has suddenly found a fresh fan following). Can he please not disappear again; he's left a lump in my throat which I wouldn't like to dislodge in a hurry. Shergill is as reliable as ever, as are the others. The ladies — Amrita Bagchi, Dia Mirza, Prajakta Koli — don't have much to do but pine and wait, but don't fare too badly. Especially the former, who personifies the sorrow of a 'forces spouse' left with her memories.

A rousing, moving tribute to our armed forces, *Operation Safed Sagar* is drama minus melodrama, topline patriotism not jingoism: it made my eyes well up, and chest swell with pride, a perfect Independence Day watch.

# More Heart than Craft

Shubhra Gupta

KIDS AND dogs are an irresistible combination. *Ohh My Dog* gives us, yes, dogs with their undying love and loyalty, which make you remember a time when Indian cinema made films which children could watch with delight.

In an Assam village, Apu (Maahi Rai) discovers that his beloved Momo has gone missing. The distraught boy and his mother (Geeta Agrawal Sharma) go to the local cop-station to file a complaint. A policeman (Vijay Mishra) is finally moved at Apu's distress and swings into action, but is too slow for the smart kid with sharp sleuth instincts (a nice Satyajit Ray-Feluda touch there), and he begins tracking his beloved Momo with the help of his teacher (Sulakhyana Baruah).

In a parallel track, somewhere in Bihar, a young man who works on a construction site has gone missing. The dog he'd adopted is the one who goes looking, gathering up a bunch of people for the quest, chief among them being Pankaj Tripathi as the teacher who provides basic education to these boys, living far away from their families. There's a cop (Rajesh Kumar) here too, but he's lax about his duties, and couldn't be bothered by either missing humans, or animals.

When the film stays with the furry four-legged creatures, it is eminently watchable. What makes these dogs different are that they are your non-pedigreed dogs — our hero Oscar looks like a brindle, with a game paw, and a jaunty red kerchief which



never miraculously gets lost through the film — with the streeties resilience and never-die-spirit.

A bunch of kidnappers lurk, an organ-harvesting racket is underway, dog-meat and other unthinkable things are hinted at, keeping Apu and his companion on their toes. A grumpy, grizzled policeman (Pawan Malhotra) is whistled up at the last minute to help in the rescue mission. Both Tripathi and Malhotra played key roles in director Amit Rai's delightful previous outing *OMG 2*, a film which would find it difficult to be made today with our increasingly shrinking appetites for accommodating differences: in this one, Rajesh Kumar is an addition to the adults who can work well with kids.

It's when *Ohh My Dog* gets into explanatory mode, underlining everything, that the film begins feeling stretched and oversimplified. A dash of religiosity feels superfluous, but thankfully it's kept to a minimum. It's left to our doggy heroes Momo and Oscar, along with Apu, to keep things moving, making this a kid-friendly expedition at the movies.

# No Way Home

Alaka Sahani

A FAMILY of four finds itself trapped inside its home when the doors and windows inexplicably refuse to open. With no way out and supplies dwindling, this apocalyptic sci-fi thriller taps into the lingering anxieties of the pandemic, when home, often considered a safe haven, became a place of confinement. As the family struggles to maintain a semblance of routine and communicate with neighbours suffering the same fate, mysterious creatures seem intent on reclaiming their place on the Earth.

The survival tale's most effective idea is its transformation of the home — a place meant to ensure their safety turns into a battleground. Greta Lee (of *Past Lives* fame) and Wagner Moura, who earned an Oscar nomination for *The Secret Agent*, are parents determined to protect their children. Their performances ground the film as the couple fall into familiar survival roles: Jason (Moura), drawing on his skills as an engineer, becomes the hunter and gatherer, while Ann (Lee) instinctively assumes the role of a nurturer. As the pressure mounts, however, these roles begin to blur.

At a time when the world of entertainment is inundated with horror stories, what sets this survival thriller apart is its focus on a family already struggling with unemployment and a mortgage. These everyday anxieties make their predicament more relatable. The details of domestic life further deepen that connection: a sick old dog the family dotes on and the nostalgia of rewatching favourites such as *Annie* (1982) and *Air Force One* (1997). *Annie*, a musical comedy drama set during the Great Depression, seems to offer the family a moment of com-



## THE LAST HOUSE

★★★★

**DIRECTOR:** Louis Leterrier  
**CAST:** Greta Lee, Wagner Moura, Riley Chung, Emma Ho, Noah Alexander Sosnowski, Gabriel Barbosa

**STREAMING ON:** Netflix

fort, while *Air Force One* becomes a date movie for Jason and Ann on a rare evening when they can relax together.

*The Last House* also taps into one of the biggest fears of modern life: a world without internet or telephone connections. Despite technological advancements, meaningful communication with neighbours has become increasingly remote. The film turns this growing social isolation into a survival concern. Forced to reach out, the family begins communicating with neighbours by holding handwritten messages up to their window. But the connection is short-lived as the neighbours begin to disappear or die. In a world that has grown increasingly insular, the family's decision to stay together offers a simple but resonant reminder of the value of community. Written by Matthew Robinson, the film does a fine job of establishing its world and building a sense of dread in the first half. But it struggles to sustain that tension. That apart, the film could have explored its core ideas about isolation, family and the collapse of community better. Still, *The Last House* is an engaging survival thriller and one that can be watched with the family from the comforts of home.

# When Blood Runs Thicker Than the Plot

Yashaswini Sri

ARUN MATHESWARAN'S *DC* IS about vigilantism, a found family, and two people who have been failed by every institution that was supposed to protect them and have decided that the only protection left is violence. *DC* revolves around Devadas, a rebel whose reasons for rebellion are revealed in pieces rather than all at once. Wamiqa Gabbi plays Chandra, a woman pulled into a violent world by forces she did not choose. Their paths collide, their damages align, and what follows is not a love story in any conventional sense.

Lokesh Kanagaraj as Devadas is the film's most compelling element. He does not have the conventional screen presence

of a Tamil leading man: an action star. But as you watch the film, none of that matters. His performance stands out because he understands, from decades on the other side, what a scene needs. He manages to pull off Devadas easily because he is familiar with the craft.

Wamiqa Gabbi matches his energy without trying to overpower it. She does not play Chandra as a woman waiting to be saved. In fact she is as dismayed as the audience. She possesses a powerful rage that works well in the first half, showing she has already risked everything and has nothing left to lose. Their chemistry is built not on tenderness but on a shared understanding of what it means to live in a world that has already taken everything from them. In the



scenes where the writing lets them breathe, the pairing works.

The first half builds the world with

enough style and mood that you stay engaged. Apart from solid acting performances, the movie's pillars are Mukesh G's

cinematography and Anirudh Ravichander's music. The movie is shot quite artistically, drenched in shadows and dim light that make every frame feel like it is hiding something.

Reds and blues dominate the frame in alternating waves, almost like the film is breathing in two colours. Red is Devadas: anger, blood and impulse. Blue is Chandra: cold, distant, the colour of someone who has already shut down emotionally and is watching the world from behind a glass. When the two of them share the frame, the colours bleed into each other, creating a purple haze. This visual grammar gives the film an identity.

The second half is where the film loses its way. The violence keeps escalating, but the stakes do not move. More blood appears on screen, but you understand less about why it matters with each passing scene. Devadas remains angry and Chandra remains damaged.

Sanjana, as Parvathy, is introduced with enough mystery that you expect her to complicate the Devadas-Chandra relationship in ways that force the story forward. The film introduces her, sets her aside, brings her back, and by the climax, you are still not sure what her function was beyond giving the poster a third face. It is a waste of a character and a waste of a good performer.

A film about two people in a world of grey, where the violence is not just physical but moral, where every choice costs something and every alliance carries a price: *DC* has style, atmosphere, two compelling leads, a world-class composer and a premise that asks the right questions. What it does not have is a screenplay that knows how to answer them. The film finds its voice in different shades of red, as promised. It just never figures out what it wants to say, but surely would make you feel quite intensely.

## •STREAMING WATCHLIST



### Hamnet

LIONSGATE PLAY

THE OSCAR-WINNING period drama traces the marriage of William Shakespeare (Paul Mescal) and Agnes (Jessie Buckley), and the devastating loss that

would go on to inspire one of literature's most enduring works. Directed by Chloé Zhao and adapted from Maggie O'Farrell's bestselling novel, *Hamnet* tenderly captures the life they create, the tragedy that shatters it, and the grief they must learn to carry as a family.



## Main Vaapas Aaunga

NETFLIX

DIRECTED BY Imtiaz Ali, *Main Vaapas Aaunga* is a romantic drama rooted in the trauma of Partition. The film follows a grandson caring for his dying grandfather, who is battling dementia, as the elderly man revisits memories of a tragic romance shaped by the 1947 Partition. Starring Diljit Dosanjh, Naseeruddin Shah, Sharvari and Vedang Raina, the film explores how migration, nostalgia and unresolved longing connect generations and how memories of a lost home and a lost love can continue to shape identity.



## The Super Mario Galaxy Movie

JOHOTSTAR

DIRECTORS AARON Horvath and Michael Jelenic's *The Super Mario Galaxy Movie*, takes

Mario and Luigi on an adventure beyond the Mushroom Kingdom and into outer space. The animated comedy follows the brothers and their friends as they face Bowser and his son Bowser Jr while attempting to rescue Princess Rosalina. Chris Pratt, Anya Taylor-Joy, Charlie Day, Jack Black and Keegan-Michael Key reprise their roles, with Benny Safdie, Glen Powell and Brie Larson joining the cast.



## One Hundred Years of Solitude: Part Two

NETFLIX

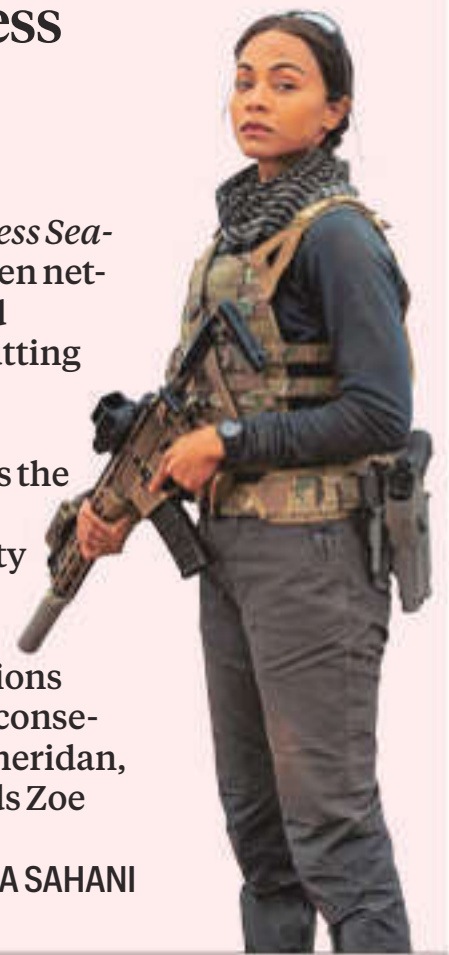
AFTER THE armistice and signing of the treaty of Neerlandia, peace still does not reach Macondo. The Conservatives, fearful of Colonel Aureliano Buendía's threats, plot an attack that brings Fernanda del Carpio from Bogotá to the town. When she marries Aureliano Segundo, she gives Úrsula Iguarán her first legitimate heirs. The other twin, José Arcadio Segundo, absorbed in José Arcadio Buendía's manuscripts accomplishes the patriarch's wild dreams of connecting Macondo with the world.

## Special Ops: Lioness Season 3

PRIME VIDEO

THE SHOW *Special Ops: Lioness Season 3* raises the stakes as hidden networks, foreign operatives and personal betrayals collide, putting national security at risk and threatening to expose the programme and its targets. As the lines between personal loyalties and professional duty continue to blur, the team is forced to navigate increasingly dangerous missions where every decision carries consequences. Created by Taylor Sheridan, the series stars returning leads Zoe Saldana and Nicole Kidman.

ALAKA SAHANI





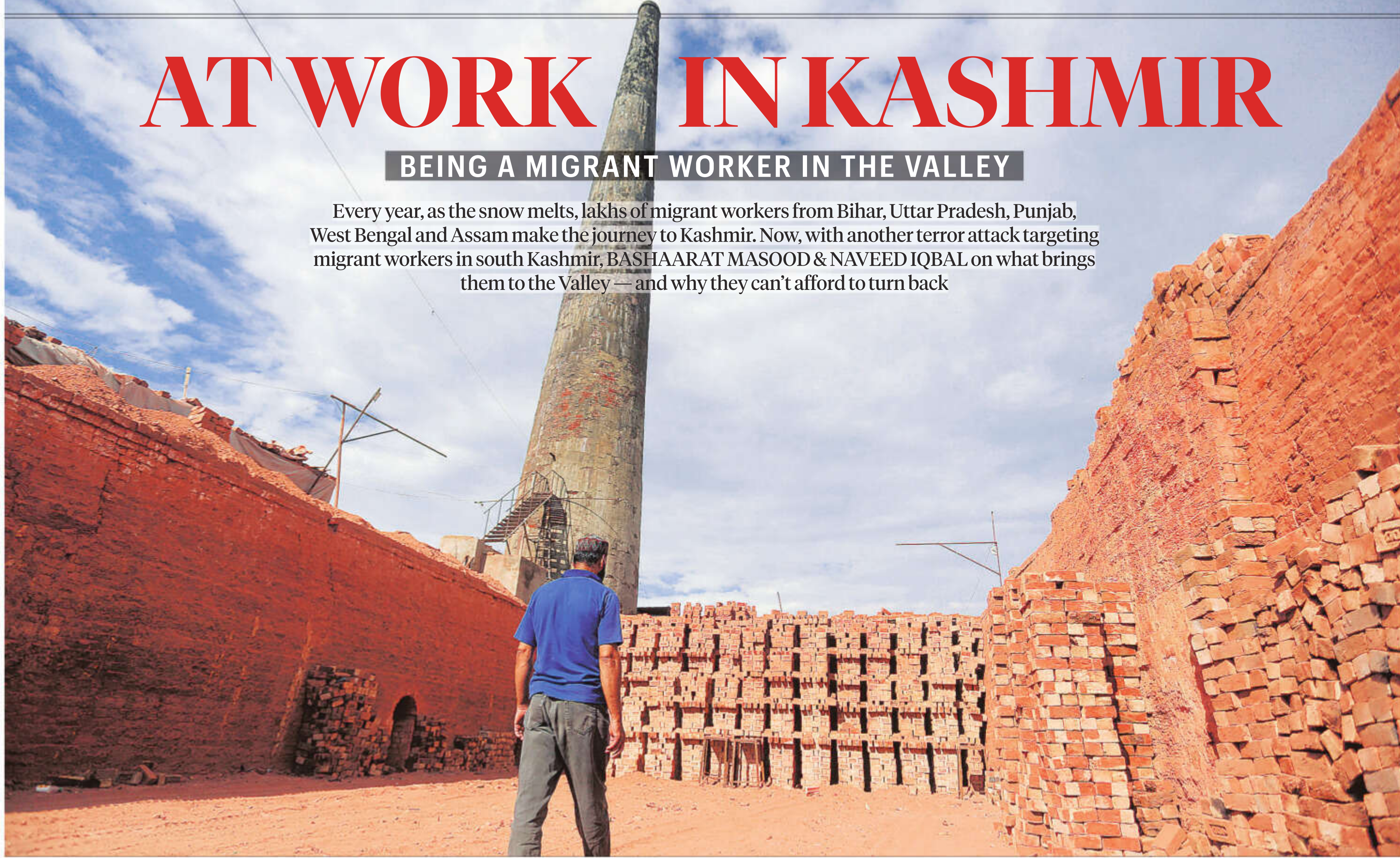
# The Big Picture

SATURDAY, AUGUST 8, 2026

## AT WORK IN KASHMIR

### BEING A MIGRANT WORKER IN THE VALLEY

Every year, as the snow melts, lakhs of migrant workers from Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, West Bengal and Assam make the journey to Kashmir. Now, with another terror attack targeting migrant workers in south Kashmir, **BASHAARAT MASOOD & NAVEED IQBAL** on what brings them to the Valley — and why they can't afford to turn back



PHOTOS: SHUAIB MASOOD

AS HIS motorcycle approaches the narrow lane that leads to his rented room in Alamgari Bazar, downtown Srinagar, Mohammad Manzoor slows down. The road is lined with police and paramilitary personnel conducting routine checks. Manzoor reaches for the helmet hanging from his bike and straps it on. He doesn't want to be noticed.

It's well past 8.30 pm and Manzoor, a mason from Bihar, shouldn't have been out on the streets at this hour. "Police have issued strict instructions that none of us non-local workers should be out after 7 pm," he says. "If they find us on the road, they scold and ask us to hurry home. But what can I do? Construction work often finishes late, and by the time I leave the site, it is dark."

Days after terrorists shot dead two brick kiln workers in Kulgam, south Kashmir, here at Alamgari Bazar, a congested neighbourhood in Srinagar's old city that is home to several migrant workers, the evening is drawing to a close much earlier than it usually does. Police have imposed a strict security protocol, asking migrant workers to return to their rooms by 8 pm and avoid venturing out without reason.

Mohammad Shahbaz begins pulling down the shutters of his tea-and-snacks shop nearly two hours before his usual closing time. Mateen Ansari's eggs-and-biryani cart, which is usually a big draw around this time, has just a couple of customers who are now rushing through their orders.

While the lanes in the neighbourhood are quieter and more cautious than usual, inside the cramped, rundown buildings that are home to many of Srinagar's migrant workers, there is no space or time to put their lives on hold.

In one of the rooms, people sit cross-legged on the floor, eating *dal* and rice; in an adjacent one, some peel onions and eggs, another chops up capsicum and tomatoes and yet another stirs it all into a pressure cooker. Past dinner time, some lie on the floor, scrolling through reels on their cell phones or video call their families hundreds of kilometres away. The conversations drift between Urdu, Hindi and Bhojpuri.

"Kashmir is far safer than it was a decade ago," says a senior police officer. "But whenever terrorists are under pressure to mark their presence, they tend to look for softer targets, and migrant workers become easy prey. Given the sheer size of the workforce, it is impossible for us to provide security to each one of them. That's why we have been advising them to exercise caution."

But Mehfooz Ahmad, a mason from Bihar, says they can't afford to slow down. "We get only six to eight months of work in Kashmir. That's why we mostly work for long hours. We have to pay for rent and food, and still have enough to send back home. These new restrictions are tough. I have to cycle for an hour from my workplace. I now have to leave my worksite at 6 pm and can't work overtime," says Mehfooz, who shares a small room with five others.

#### Why they keep coming

Every year, as the snow melts and temperatures begin to rise, lakhs of migrant workers from Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, West Bengal and Assam make the journey to Kashmir.

While there are no official figures on the migrant workforce in the region, an estimated four lakh non-Kashmiris work in the



At 007 brick kiln in Heewooder village, Budgam; Kamlesh Kumar and his family at the kiln; dinner at a room in Alamgari Bazar, Srinagar, that's home to several migrants

### • RECENT ATTACKS ON MIGRANTS IN J&K

**OCT 16, 2019:** Labourer from Chhattisgarh killed in Pulwama

**OCT 29, 2019:** Five workers from Murshidabad, West Bengal, killed in a terror strike in Kulgam

**OCT 29, 2019:** Worker injured in attack in Shopian

**OCT 5, 2021:** Street vendor from Bihar killed in Srinagar

**OCT 17, 2021:** Two labourers from Bihar killed at Wanpoh in Kulgam

**OCT 18, 2021:** UP carpenter killed in Shopian  
**MARCH 21, 2022:** Worker from Bihar injured in attack in Pulwama

**APRIL 3, 2022:** Two workers from Punjab injured in a militant attack in Pulwama

**NOV 3, 2022:** Two workers, one from Bihar, another from Nepal, injured in a militant attack at a school in Anantnag  
**NOV 12, 2022:** 1 worker from UP killed and another injured in a militant attack in Rakh

Moomin village, Anantnag  
**FEB 24, 2024:** Two workers from Punjab killed at Shallakdal in Srinagar

**OCT 20, 2024:** Six workers killed in attack on project site of Z Morh tunnel in Ganderbal  
**JULY 31, 2026:** Two brick kiln workers from Chhattisgarh killed at Kilam village in Kulgam

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Valley, all of them drawn by the promise of work and decent wages that sustain their households back home, pay for their children's school and weddings.

Their labour is visible everywhere, from the brick kilns on the outskirts of cities and urban centres to the construction sector, where they work as masons, painters, carpenters. They work on apple orchards and saffron farms, pave highways, cut hair in salons and sift through mountains of waste to search for recyclable material.

"There is not a single sector where workers from outside Jammu and Kashmir are not visible. Sectors like construction are completely dependent on migrants," says Faiz Bakshi, General Secretary of the Kashmir Chamber of Commerce and Industries.

Economist Ejaz Ayoub explains that the land reforms that took effect in J&K in the 1970s played a part in the region becoming a destination for workers from outside. "As 'land to tiller' took effect, it created a largely uniform economic class with only a small population below the poverty line (BPL). As per the last Census, the BPL population is just above 10%; the national average is 22%."

There are, therefore, few takers for labour-intensive jobs among Kashmiris, he explains. "Those from stronger economic backgrounds prefer government service to working as farm hands."

On an average, an unskilled worker in Kashmir earns Rs 700 a day while a skilled worker earns Rs 900-1,000. On a fixed unit rate contract, they earn around Rs 1,200 a day, far more than what they would get paid back home.

While there are states that pay more, Ayoub says migrants are drawn to the relatively lower cost of living in Kashmir. "Rents are affordable, there is less space constraint, water is not billed — these are factors that impact what a worker sends home."

#### Life in a brick kiln

Sitting outside his mud hut that's draped in weathered blue tarpaulin sheets, Kamlesh Kumar points to the freshly moulded clay bricks his family has shaped. "Around three thousand rupees," he mumbles, using a twig to make calculations in the mud on how much he is likely to earn from the bricks they have made today.

Every day's hard labour brings the 38-year-old a few hundred rupees closer to his goal of saving Rs 5 lakh for the wedding of his elder daughter. "She is 17. It will take me around three years to save that much money."

Kumar, from Shahjahanpur in Uttar Pradesh, first visited Kashmir in search of work in 2012. Since then, every May, Kumar, his wife, their two daughters and seven-year-old son arrive in Srinagar, head to '007' brick kiln, at Heewooder village in central Kashmir's Budgam, and stay on till the last week of October. Budgam district has over 230 kilns, 199 of those registered.

Spread across more than 25 acres, 007 is barren, hot and dusty, the tall kiln surrounded by small brick huts that are home to 300 workers and their families, mostly from Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand. Children spend all day playing in the mud as their parents knead the clay mix, shape the bricks and lay them out to dry in neat rows. A lone shop, run by a man from Heewooder, caters to most of their needs.

"Most workers come with their families, so we have at least 500 people living and working here. We can't imagine a brick kiln without workers from outside," says Bilal Ahmad Bhat, one of the owners of 007, sit-

ting in his office at the site, from where he monitors every inch of the kiln through high-quality CCTV cameras. "The only Kashmiris here are the owners and truck drivers, and the shop owner."

Bhat says he has in the past tried to get local labourers to the kiln. "This is hard labour under intense temperatures," he says. "The local labourers are not made for it. The few times I have tried to get them, they would come for a few months in the winter but as the temperatures start to increase, they leave, saying they can't tolerate it."

Economist Ayoub points out that there are more than 400 polytechnic colleges and Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) in J&K. "Though they churn out a lot of skilled and semi-skilled workers, Kashmiris prefer government jobs. The dignity associated with going to an office is immensely valued here as a society," he says, adding that even a daily-wage job in an office is considered more respectable than becoming a driver, plumber or an electrician.

By 4 pm, Kumar and his family have shaped 3,000 bricks. For every 1,000 bricks, the contractor gives them between Rs 650 and Rs 850. Which is why, most migrants at brick kilns come with their families — more hands, more bricks.

Kumar's 7-year-old son Sanjit, his hands caked with clay, is now playing with his friends. "What else would he do? I had admitted him to a good school in Shahjahanpur..." He pauses, says the name with pride: "Heaven's Garden. But he goes there only for six months. I still have to pay his fee of Rs 3,600 for the full year."

As Kumar talks about the school, Rafiq

Ahmad Ansari, a worker from Uttarakhand, interjects. "When you can't afford two meals a day, how can you think about education?"

Ansari first came to Kashmir in 1984, when he was 14. But he can barely speak Kashmiri. "I can understand many words but can't speak. Once we come here, we hardly leave the kiln or move into the village; our interactions with Kashmiris are limited." Kumar nods. "We don't have time for anything else. We are here just to earn as much as we can," he says.

Though Kumar says they never felt threatened in the Valley, police have asked brick kiln owners across Kashmir to set up CCTV cameras and adequate lighting on the periphery walls. "For us, Kashmir feels as safe as our UP, or even safer," he says. "We heard about the (Kulgam) killings, but there is no such fear here. In any case, we do not move out of our kiln."

#### 'I never felt unsafe here'

"Shahid, *kativ oosukh* (Shahid, where were you?)," asks a customer, walking into Mohammad Shahid Khan's hair salon at Ghazaliabad in Srinagar. Shahid replies in Kashmiri, saying he had gone to the house of a customer.

"I know every house in this area. I have been here for 29 years now," says Shahid, 39. He was barely 10 when he came to Kashmir from his village in Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh. "My relatives worked at a bakery in Srinagar and I came with them only to visit Kashmir. But I never went back."

Shahid says he learnt his haircutting chops from his friend's father, a barber from Bijnor.

When he was 17, Shahid went back to Bijnor and married there. But he returned to the Valley, and set up his own salon. Though the money was never enough, he ensured his four daughters and son — all born in Kash-

mir — got an education. "All of us went to the local government school," says his 15-year-old son Mohammad Saalim, who is in Class 10. "I can speak Kashmiri well, but in school and at home, we speak Urdu."

Shahid and his family have lived among people of the Valley through some of the most turbulent times — the 2008 Amarnath land row agitation, the 2010 street protests, the floods of 2014, the protests of 2016 and the 2019 abrogation of J&K's special status.

"I never felt unsafe here. The only time I felt a little uncomfortable was during the 2016 protests."

He recalls how they would slip into the alleys when police chased them. "The Kashmiri boys would run fast and we would be left behind," he says. "But almost always, someone in those lanes would open their door and let us in."

Barber shops, run by those from Bijnor, are now part of Kashmir's landscape. "Bijnor is famous for barbers and sweets makers," says Shahid.

For decades, even through some of Kashmir's worst years of unrest, the migrants remained largely untouched. However, that changed post August 5, 2019, after the abrogation. In the seven years since then, over 20 migrant workers have been killed and another 20 injured in terror attacks across Kashmir.

Though the attacks have typically targeted one or two workers at a time, the impact has extended far beyond the immediate victims, striking fear among a much wider and already vulnerable community.

Every such big attack forced workers to pack their bags and leave, but driven by desperation and the lack of opportunities back home, they would come back each time.

#### 'It's too hot at home in Bihar'

Walking through an orchard, Mateen Ahmad pauses to straighten a bamboo pole that's supporting the branches of a young apple tree. "If the pole isn't straight, the tree droops with the weight of the fruit and it affects the colour of the apple," he says.

For over two decades, Mateen, 38, has been working in South Kashmir, managing orchards and tending to trees for 10 months of the year. He leaves for home in Kathihar, Bihar, only after ensuring that the branches are pruned just before snowfall.

In Kathihar, he worked to harvest *makhana* (foxnuts), earning Rs 100 for a day's work. "That was in 2003. When I came to Kashmir that year, I didn't get a lot more for the work on the apple orchards, but over time, the rates went up. I now earn Rs 800-900 a day," says Mateen, who works on a fixed salary and sometimes finds work in other orchards as well.

He says horticulture experts sometimes come to assist him. "But I know my work... a farmer knows his land best. These company *wallas* can't teach us much," he says, laughing.

Mateen has a family of 15 waiting for him in Bihar — wife, three children, the eldest in Class 8, and parents and siblings — but he spends only two months with them. "This is my life now and no one can scare me away," he says, referring to the recent attacks on migrant workers. "I am happy here and will keep returning. This is my home."

There is another reason that keeps him in Kashmir. "*Humko ab ghar par garmi zyada lagta hai* (It's too hot in Bihar). After 20 years in Kashmir, I can't adjust to the heat any longer."



Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,N Subhadra W/o Srinath Babu A V R/o No-1286 Ground Floor, 11th Main 12th Cross, Vijayanagara 1st Stage, Mysore, PO-Vijaynagar Li Stage, Distt-Mysuru, Karnataka - 570017, have changed my name to Swathi A S 0071052742-1

I,ASHU W/O SAMMEER AJMANI, R/o,Ideal-Apartments, H.No.401-A, 14/6, Sector-1A, Dwarka, New Delhi-110045, have changed my name to ASHU AJMANI for all purpose. 0040870677-6

I, KISHOR KUMAR FATNANI, S/o Sh. Arjun Dass Fatnani, R/o A-17, Second Floor, Lok Vihar, Pitampura, Delhi - 110034, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that KISHOR KUMAR FATNANI and KISHOR KUMAR are one and the same identical person and I shall be known as KISHOR KUMAR FATNANI for all future purposes. 0130067757-1

I,Shuaib Malik S/o Haji Irfan Malik R/o-761, Mohalla Krishan Ganj New Abadai, Pilkhua, Hapur have changed my name to Suhaib Malik. 0071052799-1

I,Mahinder singh Mathur, s/o-Inder Singh, R/o-503, opp.SR.SEC-school mohammadpur majri-village, karala, DIST:North west-delhi-110081,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MAHENDER SINGH. 0040870675-11

I,Kamlesh kathuria W/o Virender Kumar Kathuria,R/o-E-1/67, Sultanpur, Po-Sultanpuri,C-Block, Distt-North West Delhi, Delhi-110086,have changed my name to Kamlesh, for all future purposes. 0040870552-6

I, Vivek Singh Kushwah S/o Sumat Singh R/o Ward NO-09, Gram Mehadowa, Bhind, Madhya Pradesh - 477335, have changed my minor son's name from Praddhuman Singh Rajawat Aged 15 Years to Praddhuman Singh Kushwah forever 0071052754-1

I,Mohammad Afzal S/O Nijamuddin,R/o D-14, Street No-01,Chaman Park,Indira Vihar,Delhi-110094,Have Changed My Name To MOHD AFJAL Permanently. 0040870675-4

I,HITHERTO KNOWN AS MD AKHTAR,S/O MD KHALIL, R/O-718/B GALLI,NO-20A,ZAKIR NAGAR JAMIA NAGAR, ND-110025 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MD AKHTAR HUSSAIN. 0040870677-8

I, Jagjit Singh Bharij s/o Kuldip Singh Bharij r/o G-58/A, Santnagar Ext., Tilak Nagar, Delhi-110018 have changed my name to JAGJEET SINGH. 0040870554-2

I, KHURRAM S/o Ateeq Beg R/o-11A/1B, Hauz Rani, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-17 have changed my name to KHURRAM SHAHZAD. 0071052732-1

I, Muskan Manchanda D/o S.K Manchanda, Ex wife of Sidharth Elwadh, R/o. S 497A Second Floor, Greater Kailash-2, South Delhi-110048, I got divorce from my Ex Husband Sidharth Elwadh vide Court Order HMA-864/22 dated 21/3/2023. changed my minor daughter name Annanya Elwathi to Annanya Manchanda aged 11 years. 0071052837-1

I,SUVARNA BHUJANGRAO OGALE,W/o Dr.Tushaba Shinde,R/o C-704, CGRC,DDU Marg,New Delhi-110002,have changed my name,from SUVARNA BHUJANGRAO OGALE to SUVARNA TUSHABA SHINDE OGALE for all future purposes. 0040870677-1

I,Jitesh Kumar,S/O-Dinesh Kumar Tokas R/O-58-B,Munirka Village, South West Delhi,Delhi-110067,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Jitesh Kumar. 0040870552-8

I,Sadaqat S/o Afsar Ali R/o Village-Badarkha, Hapur, UP-245207, have changed my name to Sadaqat Ali. 0040870675-2

I,Mohammad Yahya S/O Shafiquddin R/o-6047,Nawab Road,Basti Harphool Singh,Sabar Bazar,Delhi-110006,Have Changed My Name To MOHD YAHYA Permanently. 0040870675-6

I, Anuradha W/o Mukesh Kumar Chathly R/o 2134, Rani Bagh, Delhi - 110034, have changed my name to Bhawna Chathly permanently. 0040870557-1

I, Mohammad Ghufan S/o Qurban Ali R/o Vait Wait, Hapur, UP have changed my name to Mohammad Gufran permanently. 0071052733-1

I, Amit Kumar s/o-Hari Shankar Singh, R/o-124-E, Pocket-A, Mayur Vihar Phase-II, Patparganj, Delhi-91; have changed my name to Amit Singh. 0040870592-2

I, Nikhil S/o Ashok R/o RZE-122, Nihal Vihal,Nangoli, Delhi-110041 have changed my name to Nikhil Vimal 0040870675-9

I,Shamsuddin, S/o Mohd Umerdin, R/o FA-31, Abul Fazal Enclave, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohd Shamsuddin 0040870552-4

I,SANJAY S/o-BISHAMBER R/o- House Number-A-1/34,Gali Number -5,Kabir Nagar Delhi-110094 Have Changed my Name SANJAY KUMAR S/O BISHAMBER SINGH,For All Purpose. 0040870677-3

I, Jagdish Kumar S/o Late Shri Vishan Dass R/o 2783, 2nd Floor, Street No.6, Chuna Mandi, Paharganj, New Delhi-110055 have changed my name from Jagdish Kumar to Jagdish Kumar Patni for all purposes in future as per the affidavit sworn in before the Notary Public on 06.08.2026. 0040870555-1

Certified that Jainendra Kumar, S/o-Khazan Singh, R/o-H.No.603, Street.No.5, Chandralok, Shahdara, Delhi-93, and Jainendra Kr.S/o-Khazan Singh,R/o-H. No.603, Gali.No.5, Chandralok,Shahdara, Delhi-93, whose Date-of-Birth is 02/08/1966 DL.No.DL05 19910306013) is the same person. 0040870552-10

I, hitherto known as PALLAVI REKHI W/O VIMAL BHOLA R/o Flat 302, Tower - K, Microtek Greenburg, Near St Xavier School, Sector 86, VTC: Nawada Fatehpur(112), PO: Sikanderpur, District: Gurgaon, State: Haryana, PIN Code: 122004, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PALLAVI BHOLA. 0071052677-1

I,Bimla W/o-Partap, employed as office Assistant in Northern Railway, Delhi Division, Govt of India, R/o-DY-2414/25, Vishal Nagar, Sonipat Haryana-131001; declare that name of mine and my husband has been wrongly written as Bimla Devi and Paratap in my service record. The actual name of mine and my Husband are Bimla and Partap.0040870592-1

I,Nisha Panjawani,D/o Harish Kumar Panjwani, R/o-Hemant Gulati,R/o Flat.No. A223,DLF The Primus,Sector-82, Sikanderpur,Gurugram (Haryana)-122004, have changed my name to Nisha Gulati. 0040870675-8

I, ARJUN, S/O PRATHEESH GOPINATHAN NAIR, RESIDENT OF FLAT NO. B-702, ANANT CGHS LTD. Plot NO.25A, SECTOR-04, DWARKA, KAKROLA, NEW DELHI-110078, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME ARJUN P NAIR, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040870552-3

I, Muskan Manchanda D/o S.K Manchanda, Ex wife of Sidharth Elwadh, R/o. S 497A Second Floor, Greater Kailash 2, South Delhi-110048, I got divorce from my Ex Husband Sidharth Elwadh vide Court Order HMA-864/22 dated 21/3/2023. changed the name of my minor daughter namely Aradhya Elwadh to Aradhya Manchanda aged 14 years. 0071052841-1

I, TURAMBE SWATI RAJENDRA, Spouse of No. 17003725K (HAV) TURAMBE RAJENDRAKUMAR BHARAT, resident of Village- Ghalwad, P.O.- Ghalwad, Teh- Shirol, Dist.- Kolhapur, Maharashtra-416103, have changed my name from TURAMBE SWATI RAJENDRA to TURAMBE SWATI RAJENDRAKUMAR, vide affidavit IN- DL71223610442937Y, dated: 07/08/2026, before Notary, Advocate: Ajay Massey, Regd.No.-54075, New Delhi. 0071052738-1

I, Ashok Bhagat S/o Ramchandra Bhagat R/o E-90, JJ Colony Phase-3, Sector-3 Dwarka, N.S.I.T Dwarka, South West Delhi- 110078, I have changed the name of my minor daughter Nirasha Kumari to Vaishnavi Kumari aged 11 years. 0071052845-1

I, Aman Kumar S/o Vijay Kumar, 154, Tarun Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-34 have changed my minor daughter name from Tiyaasha to Tiyaasha Singla. 0071052796-1

I,Shivender Pratap Singh S/o Ganga Ram R/o Nagla Ghari, Chhinkaura Garhia, Mainpuri, UP,have changed my name to Shivendra Pratap Singh. 0040870675-1

I,GAGANDEEP SINGH, S/O MUKHTIAR SINGH BHALLA, R/O-B-52, Third-Floor, Asha-Park Extn., Fateh-Nagar, Tilak-Nagar,New Delhi-110018,have changed my name to GAGANDEEP SINGH BHALLA. 0040870677-5

I, Atul Khandelwal S/o Rajendra Kumar Khandelwal R/o-704, Gali Aheriyaan, Deeg Gate, Mathura have changed my name to Atul Kumar Khandelwal. 0071052727-1

I, G.S. GROVER S/o-GURPRATAP SINGH GROVER, R/O-D-9, SECOND FLOOR, PAMPOSH ENCLAVE,NEW DELHI-48,have changed my name to GAGANDEEP SINGH GROVER for all purposes. 0040870592-3

I,Deepika Handa W/o Hitesh Seth R/o H/7/10, 3rd-floor, Sector-26,DLF Phase-1,Sikanderpur Ghosi(68),Gurgaon,Haryana-122002,have changed my daughter's name from Dhrisha Seth to Dhrisha Handa. 0040870677-4

IRishikesh Kaushik, S/o Sh. Sachida Nand Tiwary, R/o B-501, Saffron, Niho, Scottish Garden, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad-201014 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Drisana Kaushik to Drisana Mishra Kaushik for all purposes. 0040870550-1

I RENU BIDHURI W/O Dinesh R/O H.NO-168/2, Alijanj, Kotla Mubarakpur South Delhi-110003 Have changed my name to Renu 0040870675-10

I,AGASTYA NAIN S/o Sh.Saurabh Chaudhary, R/O H.NO. B-24, Rampuri, Ghaziabad, UP-201011, have changed my name to ABHINAV CHAUDHARY, permanently. 0040870552-5

IKrishnakumar Kottapalli Alias Kothapally Krishna Kumar Alias Krishan Kumar Kothapalli Alias Krishna Kumar K S/O Kottapalli Raj Kumar R/O 24-2-68/1, Kasimpally, Bhupalpalay, Jangedu, PO-Jhenaig, Distt-Jayashankar Bhupalpalay, Telangana - 506169, have changed my name to Kottapalli Krishna Kumar 0071052745-1

I,Priti Gupta W/O. Sandeep Gupta R/O.BA-265,Tagore Garden, New Delhi-110027 have changed my name to Preeti Gupta for all Purposes 0040870675-3

I,Surjit Singh Chawla S/o Darshan Singh R/o WZ-26B/3, Upper Ground-Floor, K.h.1527 Gali-No.2,Ratan-Park,New Delhi-15,have change my name to Surjit Singh for all purposes. 0040870677-7

I,Manjit Singh Makkar s/o Trilok Singh Makkar r/o WZ-443C-1, MS-Block, Harinagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to MANJEET SINGH MAKKAR. 0040870554-1

I, mother of Thomas Mathew K resident of Kalathiparambil, Alangad PO, Katampazhipuram, Palakkad Distt, Kerala have changed my name from SALEENA MATHEW to SALEENAMMA vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Reg no. 337 Bhim Singh Indora, Delhi. 0130067759-1

I, Anisha Bhardwaj R/o T8-501, RPS Savana, Near K.R. Mangalam World School, Sector-88, Kheri Kalan, Faridabad (HR)-121002 have changed my minor daughter's name from Prisha Upreti to Prisha Bhardwaj for all future purposes. 0071052801-1

I,Inderjeet Singh,s/o-Satnam Singh,R/o-B-301,Anupam-Apartment Near Karkardooma Court,East Arjun-Nagar,Delhi-110032,have changed my name to Inderjeet Singh Arneja,for all future purposes. 0040870675-12

I, Yameen S/o Abdul Aziz R/o-16, Mohalla Chhapiwara, Pilakhuwa, Hapur have changed my name to Yameen Khan. 0071052725-1

I,Virender kathuria,S/o Pran Nath, R/o-E-1/66-67,Block-E-1,Sultanpuri, Po: Sultanpuri, C-Block,Distt.-North West Delhi,Delhi-110086, have changed my name to Virender Kumar Kathuria,for all future purposes. 0040870552-7

I, KM. SHALINI W/o Saurabh Kumar R/o Flat No. A-810, Ace City, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 201306, India, have changed my name from KM. SHALINI to SHALINI. Henceforth, I shall be known by the name SHALINI for all future purposes. 0071052788-1

I,Yasmeen W/O Mohammad Yahya,R/o-6047,Nawab Road,Basti Harphool Singh,Sabar Bazar,Delhi-110006,Have Changed My Name To YASMIN BANO Permanently. 0040870675-5

I,SATYA PARKASH AGGARWAL/SATYA PARKASH/SAT PARKASH/SATYA PRAKASH,S/O-LATE SH.DEVI SAHAI AGGARWAL,R/O-H.NO.1188-A,GALI NO.80,SHANTI NAGAR, DELHI-110035,That all the names mentioned above are same and one person i.e. myself SATYA PARKASH AGGARWAL 0040870677-9

I, SANGEETA, D/o Sanat Dhara, R/o J-3/81, 1st Floor, R/S J-Extension, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi -110092, declare that name of mine and my father has been wrongly recorded as SANGEETA DHARA and SANAD HALDER in my Class 10 Certificate. The actual name of mine and my father are SANGEETA and SANAT DHARA, which may be amended accordingly. Henceforth, I shall use only the name SANGEETA, D/o SANAT DHARA, for all purposes. 0040870559-1

I, Ishcha Gupta, d/o Praveen Kumar Gupta, r/o Pragatisheel Apt, Sec 9, Rohini, Delhi, state my father's name is wrongly written as "Praveen Gupta" instead of "Praveen Kumar Gupta" in 10th marksheet. Both are same person vide affidavit dt 06-08-2026. 0130067758-1

I,DHARAM PAL GUPTA,S/O SEWA RAM R/O/HNO.J-646,GALINO.1-1/2,KUSHAK NO.2 SWAROOP-NAGAR DELHI-110042,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DHARPALL GUPTA,FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040870552-2

I Vinay S/o Krishan Kumar R/o D-16 Vasant Kunj South West Delhi 110070 have changed my name to Vinay Kumar for all future purposes 0040870565-1

I, AMAN S/O PREM PRAKASH GANGWAR, R/O PLOT NO. 93/94-A, F/F, Maharani Enclave extn., Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-59, declare, BRIJ BHUSHAN and PREM PRAKASH GANGWAR are one and the same person. 0130067760-1

I,SHAHINA PARVEEN alias SHAHANAH PARVEEN,W/o-Hamid Husain,R/o-H.No. A/52,Street No.-15,Chauhan Bangar,Delhi-110053,declare that SHAHINA PARVEEN and SHAHANAH PARVEEN both names are same and one-person. 0040870677-2

I, Vinay Kumar, S/O Subhash chand, R/O Machrouli, Gangoh, Saharanpur, U.P., do hereby declare that in my son Aviral Sharma's Class 10th Marksheet/Certificate, my name has been wrongly printed as 'Vinay Sharma'. My correct and legal name is 'Vinay Kumar'. All future purposes may please note. 0050294594-1

I,SALINI RAWAT,ddaughter of,Shatrughan Rawat Presently,residing at Madhuban Tola Dihu,East Champaran,Bihar-845420,have changed my name,from SALINI RAWAT to SHALINI RAWAT,vide-Affidavit date-06.08.2026 0040870552-9

I, Rajesh Mishra, S/o Vinod Kumar Mishra, R/o House No. 44, Delhi Administration Flats, Nimri Colony, Ashok Vihar Phase-4, Delhi-110052, have Changed my daughter's name Samayra to Samayra Mishra for all future Purposes. 0040870625-1

I,Anita Kumari Shaw,W/o Sanjay Kumar Shaw,R/o C-2-201,Saviour-Park,Mohan Nagar,Ghaziabad (Uttar Pradesh)-201007,have changed my name Anita Shaw,for all Purposes. 0040870675-7

LOST & FOUND

ORIGINAL SALE DEED DATED-26-04-2007,OF PROPERTY NO. WZ-E-217,GROUND FLOOR,RISHI NAGAR,SHAKUR BASTI, DELHI-110034 HAS LOST.FINDER CONTACT SEEMA SABHARWAL AT M.NO.8447662502. 0040870677-10

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Mr. Madhusudan Garg has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Green Park Extension, New Delhi. (Bank) to avail a Loan for purchase of Entire First Floor of Property No. A-147, (217 sq. yds.), Block-A, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024, (property) from Mrs. Shilpi Sachdeva, who has represented that she is the absolute owner of the said property by virtue of Sale Deed dated 05.08.2024 (Doc. no. 2024/95194) executed by Mrs. Sardeep Walia, Mrs. Reena Walia, Mr. Praval Arora, Mrs. Sukrita Arora & Mr. Akshay Kumar Arora. She has further represented that the Conveyance Deed dated 18.04.2000 (Doc. no. 4182) & other documents have been misplaced/lost and FIR bearing LR No. 25.05.94/2018 dated 19.01.2018 has been lodged with P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi. If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said Property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale, or on the basis of lost document/s or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 07 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.

**Amit Kumar, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.**

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

It is informed to the general public that my client **Satya bir Singh**, Son of Late Shri Ram Singh, resident of House No. 26, Gali No. 3, Block A Himgiri Enclave, Burari Road, North Delhi, Delhi-110084, has disowned his son **Dipin Kumar Jainth** and daughter-in-law **Annu Jainth** from all his movable & immovable properties and has severed all ties with them, due to their wrong and immoral conduct, if any person deals any kinds of transaction with them in future, then my client will not be responsible for it.

Sd/-  
**BRAJESH KUMAR YADAV Advocate Ch. No. L-3, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-54**

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

It be known to the general public that my clients namely **Yashpal Gandhi & Smt. Usha** both Resident of: Mohalla-Jawahar Nagar, Mohindergarh, Haryana-130029 have debarred and disowned their son namely **Sachin Gandhi S/o Sh. Yashpal Gandhi** & their daughter-in-law namely **Saravjot Kaar W/o Sh. Sachin Gandhi** both resident of Flat No.22, Pocket-II, Sector-23, VTC, Rohini, PO: Rohini Sector-7, North West Delhi, Delhi-110085 from their movable and immovable properties, due to their rude and arrogant behavior towards my clients. Any person dealing with them, shall deal on his/her/their own risk/responsibility, my clients shall not be liable of any transaction/dispute or illegal activities in any manner, if anybody deals with them, he/she shall deal on their risk and consequences.

Sd/-  
**VIVEK KUMAR PANDIT (Advocate) Ch. No. 221, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-54**

**"IMPORTANT"**

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**कार्यालय अतिरिक्त परियोजना समन्वयक समग्र शिक्षा, चूरू**

क्रमांक :- अतिरिक्त/समसा/चूरू/2026/354 दिनांक :- 04/08/2026

**Notice Inviting Bid**

Bids of Furniture Supply in Various School at Churu District are invited from interested bidders up to 2.00 pm 25.08.2026. (Estimated Cost 318.00 Lacs) Other Particulars of the bid may Be visited on the Procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state.

**UBN - RSE2627WSOB00905** **ADPC**  
**Raj.Samwad/C/26/9030** **SMSA, CHURU**

**WB HIDCO**

**Request For Proposal No. 01 of 2026-2027**

R.F.P. is invited for the work “Selection of Consultant for Architectural and Detail Engineering Including MEP Works for Construction of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee Memorial Complex with 125 ft Tall Statue at Eco Park in New Town, Kolkata.” in the detailed RFP notice available on websites:-[wbenders.gov.in](http://wbenders.gov.in) and [wbhidcoindia.com](http://wbhidcoindia.com) & in e-tender portal. Last date of Bid submission on 01.09.2026 upto 2.00 P.M. Details may also be available in the website [www.wbhidcoindia.com](http://www.wbhidcoindia.com).

**General Manager (Engg)-IV WBHIDCO**

**कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल दुमका**

**अत्यकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना**

निविदा संख्या- 05/2026-27/RWD/EE/DUMKA दिनांक- 06.08.2026

1.कार्यपालक अभियंता ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,कार्य प्रमंडल, दुमका द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार E-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

| क्र. | आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या | प्रखंड      | कार्य का नाम                                                                                              | प्रशासनिक स्वीकृति की राशि (लाख में) | कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि | टेंडर कॉल |
|------|-------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------|
| 1    | RWD/DUMKA/08/2026-27                | जामा        | ग्राम खिलकिनारी सिडो-कान्हु चौक से मचाडीह आर0इ0ओ0 रोड भाया हेडबहिरी एवं परगाडीह तक पथ निर्माण कार्य।      | 614.977                              | 15 महीने              | प्रथम     |
| 2    | RWD/DUMKA/09/2026-27                | जामा        | पंचायत-तफरी में ग्राम-अगीया से बहिल भाया करहिया तक पथ निर्माण कार्य।                                      | 374.445                              | 15 महीने              | प्रथम     |
| 3    | RWD/DUMKA/10/2026-27                | जामा        | पंचायत-चकनिया में पी0डब्ल्यू0डी पथ से कोलहरिया पथ भाया मुस्लिम लोन्हा तक पथ निर्माण कार्य।                | 255.413                              | 12 महीने              | प्रथम     |
| 4    | RWD/DUMKA/11/2026-27                | शिकारीपाड़ा | पी0डब्ल्यू0डी रोड (हुदकान्दर से शिकरी) से बेहराणहाडी भाया तलपामारा सीतासाल राजुपाड़ा तक पथ निर्माण कार्य। | 1045.670                             | 18 महीने              | प्रथम     |
| 5    | RWD/DUMKA/12/2026-27                | शिकारीपाड़ा | आर0इ0ओ0 रोड कोलपाड़ा से नीम टोला तक पथ निर्माण कार्य।                                                     | 389.522                              | 15 महीने              | प्रथम     |

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि 21.08.2026  
2. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय 12.09.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।  
3. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि Online के माध्यम से जमा किया जाएगा।  
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि 15.09.2026 एवं समय पूर्वाह्न 11:30 बजे।  
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, दुमका।  
6. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का सम्पर्क संख्या- 9931527613  
7. विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए [jharkhandtenders.gov.in](http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)/नोटिफ बोर्ड में देखा जा सकता है।

**कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,कार्य प्रमंडल दुमका**

**PR 386931 (Rural Work Department)26-27"D**

**Government of Jharkhand Rural Works Department JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROADS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (JSRRDA) 3<sup>rd</sup> Floor, F.F.P. Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi 834004**

**NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (National Competitive Bidding Through e-Procurement)**

**Re-e-Tender No.- 24/ 2026-27- Ranchi, Dated: 07.08.2026**

**PR No- 368582 dated 29.04.2026 (2<sup>nd</sup> Call)**

The undersigned on behalf of Government of Jharkhand invites item rate bids through e-Procurement from the eligible bidders registered\* in appropriate class with any State/Central Government/State /Central Government Organization for construction and maintenance for five years of the works (List of schemes shall be displayed in the website [pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in](http://pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in)) of Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojna PM-JANMAN (Batch-II & III, 2025-26).

| Sl. No | Distriet Name | Block Name    | Package No.     | Re-Package No.                            | Road Name / Bridge Name                                                                                 | Road /Bridge Length (Kms/m | Construction Cost (Rs. in Lakh) | Maintenance Cost (Rs. in Lakh) | Total Cost (Rs. in Lakh) | Earnest Money (Rs. in Lakh) | Time period (in Months ) |
|--------|---------------|---------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1      | Garhwa        | Bhawanath-pur | JH07MTC-046     | <b>JH-07-PMJANMAN-II-GAR-03 /2025-26</b>  | L023-PWD Road Township To Arsali                                                                        | 3.5                        | 322.49                          | 32.37                          | 759.77                   | 16.00                       | 15                       |
|        |               | Bhawanath-pur | JH07MTC-052     |                                           | L024-PMGSY Road To Phulwar                                                                              | 3.85                       | 370.6                           | 34.31                          |                          |                             |                          |
| 2      | Koderma       | Jainagar      | JH13MAR-S102    | <b>PMJANMAN-II-KOD-01/ 2025-26</b>        | L021-Kharkopa PMGSY Road to Gariai                                                                      | 1.548                      | 143.27                          | 13.11                          | 156.38                   | 4.00                        | 12                       |
| 3      | Latehar       | Mahua-tand    | JH14JAN-XCL-008 | <b>PMJANMAN-II-LAT-01 (2025-26)</b>       | L023-PWD ROAD TO SIRSI                                                                                  | 9.465                      | 875.11                          | 73.4                           | 948.51                   | 19                          | 18                       |
| 4      | Palamu        | Bishrampur    | JH17JAN2-ACP021 | <b>JH-17-PMJANMAN-II-PAL-01 / 2025-26</b> | L025-Wanshakti aarapur reo road hatat to pachghara tak                                                  | 4.455                      | 411.21                          | 38.71                          | 1001.71                  | 21.00                       | 18                       |
|        |               | Bishrampur    | JH17MTC-020B    |                                           | Construction of H.L. Bridge over Sinjo Nala at ch-1550m in L022- itko Panchayat Sachriwalay To Sinjo R  | 44.760m                    | 265.46                          | 3.01                           |                          |                             |                          |
|        |               | Bishrampur    | JH17MTC-21B     |                                           | Construction of H.L. Bridge over Thiki Nala at ch-2280m in L023- Khumbhi Khurd More To Theki Road       | 52.600m                    | 280.29                          | 3.03                           |                          |                             |                          |
| 5      | Palamu        | Chainpur      | JH17JAN2-ACP011 | <b>JH-17-PMJANMAN-II-PAL-05 / 2025-26</b> | L043-Ramkanda Daltonganj rd red road to Hsira to karma via Temari                                       | 4.175                      | 354.68                          | 31.74                          | 649.59                   | 13.00                       | 15                       |
|        |               | Chainpur      | JH17ACP-B13     |                                           | HL RCC Bridge over Sukradih River at CH 2+400 of Ramkanda Daltonganj rd red road hsiira to Karma via Te | 40.640m                    | 260.6                           | 2.57                           |                          |                             |                          |
| 6      |               |               |                 |                                           |                                                                                                         |                            |                                 |                                |                          |                             |                          |





**PATRATU ENERGY LIMITED**  
(CIN: U40106JH2012SGC000765)  
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building H.E.C, Dhurwa, Ranchi- 834004  
Email- chiefengineerproject223@gmail.com/  
gmproject-juunl@jharkhandmail.gov.in

**Tender Cancellation Notice**

Due to unavoidable circumstances EOI Notice No.: 11/PR/JUUNL/2026-27 for “Appointment of Insolvency Resolution Professionals Liquidator for voluntary winding up of Patratu Energy Limited (PEL)” is hereby cancelled.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्र हित में ऊर्जा बचावों। कृपया अपनी  
शिकायतों को 18003456570 (कॉल सेंटर) पर दर्ज कराया।

PR No. 380270

Sd/-  
Director, PEL cum General  
Manager (Project)

PR 386933 (Jharkhand Urja Utpadan Nigam Ltd) 26-27 (D)



CROSSWORD

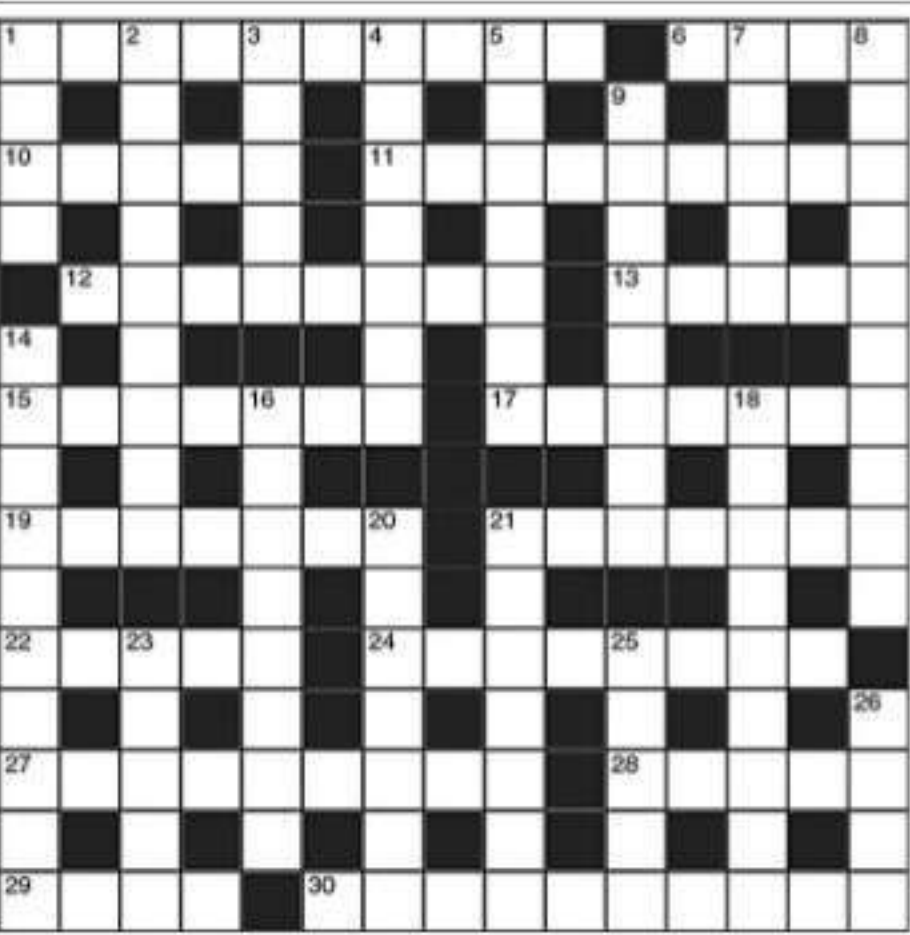
6062

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS



**ACROSS**  
1 Bottom of the flying class? (10)  
6 He shows Sam there's nothing to be upset about (4)  
10 Soundly examine a European language (5)  
11 Tradesman shows how he hopes to leave hospital? (9)  
12 Once said to be a bishop (8)  
13 Share out everyone has to go back for (5)  
15 Type that has the right inclination (7)  
17 A returned high ball is hard to stop (7)  
19 Take a liberty? (7)  
21 The month's weather forecast for London district (7)  
22 Deserted area is in a bad way (5)  
24 Final change of venue at Latvian capital (8)  
27 Mix the meat with it then (2,3,4)  
28 Giant bird on a pole (5)  
29 A bit of a teaser but no real difficulty (4)  
30 Worker in biblical community went to America (5,5)

**DOWN**  
1 A burning issue that's illuminating (4)  
2 They're a blend of the main races (9)  
3 There's a moral in the thickness of thieves (5)  
4 Look in public transport for what women wear (7)  
5 Change round at domed building (7)  
7 One may be driven to sleep here (5)  
8 Carriers of bricks (10)  
9 Threatening to readjust my ration (8)  
14 Useful outlet if housewarming gets out of hand (4,6)  
16 Thought that I made gin perhaps (8)  
18 I can't earn redress as the race was easily won (2,1,6)  
20 Girl gives the first mate a nil return (7)  
21 Film star who saved men in watery ditches (3,4)  
23 Comments written on the staff (5)  
25 A symbol to be encountered coming up (5)  
26 Old South American found in California (4)

**SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6061** **ACROSS:** 1 Blow-out, 5 Run up, 8 Perpetual, 9 Fee, 10 Deal, 12 Duty-free, 14 Reform, 15 Annoys, 17 Grateful, 18 Used, 21 Lac, 22 Insolvent, 24 Auden, 25 Retired **DOWN:** 1 Biped, 2 Oar, 3 Over, 4 Taurus, 5 Relaying, 6 Nefarious, 7 Peeress, 11 Affianced, 13 Friesian, 14 Regalia, 16 Hussar, 19 Dated, 20 Clot, 23 Ear

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

There is no revenge so complete as \_\_\_\_ - Josh Billings (11)

**GENRE**  
O \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

**RYCGIN**  
O \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

**RSDOS**  
O \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

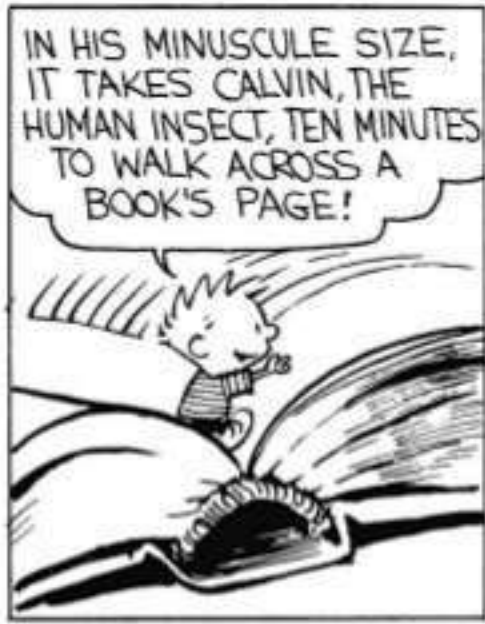
**AORUFV**  
O \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

**ANSWER:** There is no revenge so complete as **forgiveness** - Josh Billings



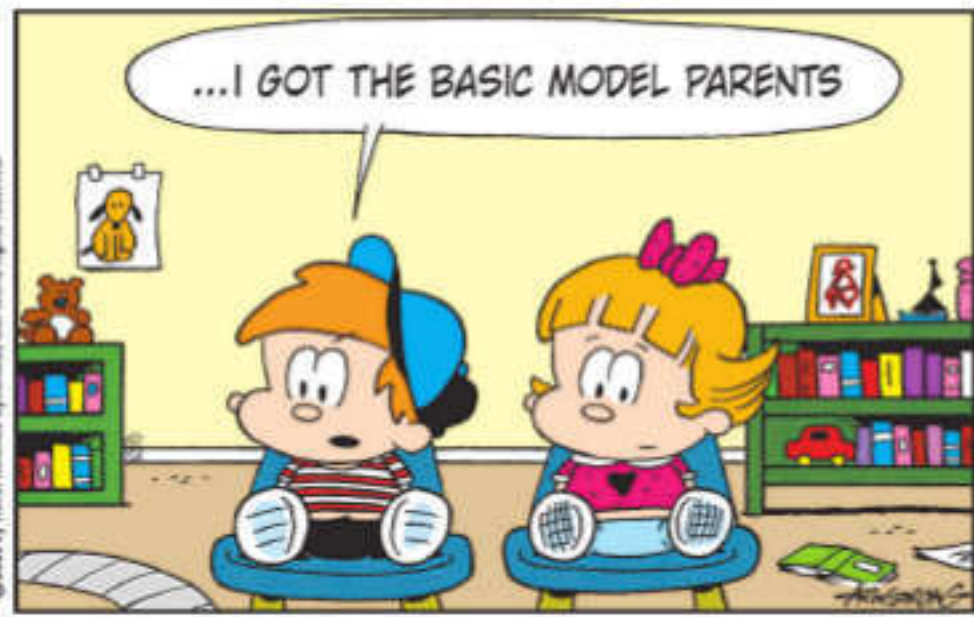
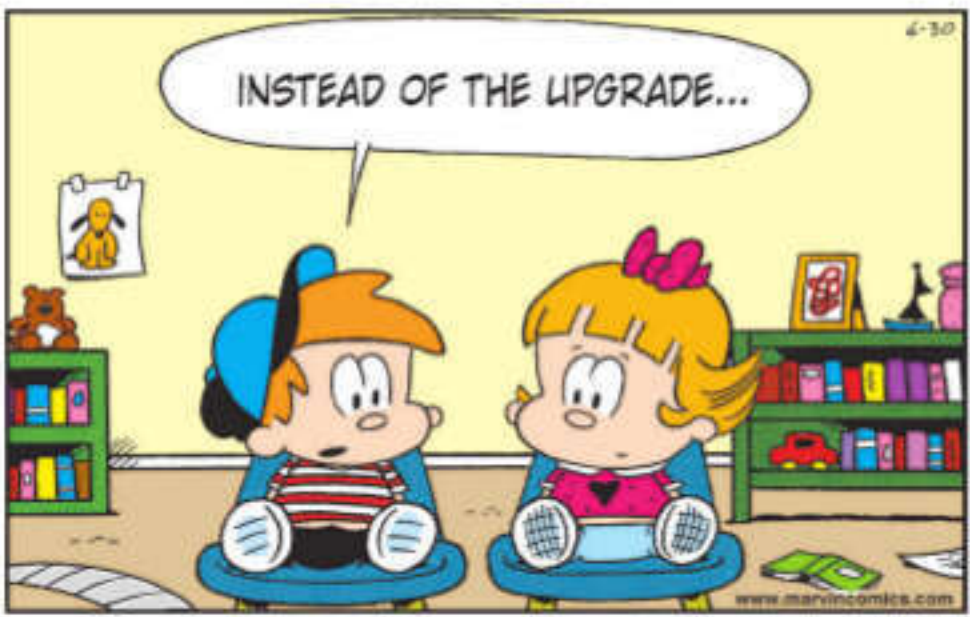
CALVIN & HOBBS

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



**DIFFICULTY LEVEL**  
4s **INSTRUCTIONS**  
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

**DIFFICULTY LEVEL**  
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

**SUDOKU 6404**

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
|   |   | 2 |   | 3 |   | 7 |   |   |
|   |   | 1 |   |   |   |   |   | 3 |
| 3 | 7 |   | 4 |   |   |   |   | 5 |
| 7 |   |   |   | 8 |   |   |   |   |
|   | 3 | 9 |   |   |   | 8 | 4 |   |
|   |   |   |   | 5 |   |   |   | 9 |
| 2 |   |   |   |   | 6 |   | 3 | 4 |
| 6 |   |   |   |   |   | 2 |   |   |
|   | 8 |   | 5 |   |   | 1 |   |   |

**SOLUTION SUDOKU 6403**

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | 9 | 8 | 5 | 6 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 6 | 4 | 2 | 7 | 9 | 3 | 1 | 5 | 8 |
| 3 | 1 | 5 | 2 | 8 | 4 | 9 | 6 | 7 |
| 1 | 7 | 3 | 8 | 5 | 9 | 4 | 2 | 6 |
| 2 | 5 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 1 |
| 9 | 8 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 3 | 7 | 5 |
| 5 | 3 | 7 | 9 | 1 | 8 | 6 | 4 | 2 |
| 8 | 6 | 9 | 4 | 7 | 2 | 5 | 1 | 3 |
| 4 | 2 | 1 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 7 | 8 | 9 |

CORPORATE BRIEFS



**NBCC** NBCC Ltd, has signed a landmark agreement with the Government of the Republic of Seychelles for the construction of the Ile Aurore Housing Project, comprising 1008 affordable housing units along with associated infrastructure in Seychelles. The agreement was signed recently in the presence of Sebastien Pillay,

Vice President of the Republic of Seychelles, and Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy, Chairman & Managing Director, NBCC (India) Limited. The project envisages the development of 1008 affordable housing units along with associated infrastructure, aimed at enhancing urban living standards and supporting sustainable development in Seychelles. The project will be funded through a Line of Credit of USD 75 Million extended by the Export-Import Bank of India & is expected to contribute significantly to improving housing availability while promoting sustainable urban development in Seychelles.

**IRCTC** The Indian railways have recently launched an all-new IRCTC Beta Website recently, marking a significant milestone in the digital evolution. Building on its legacy of enabling seamless travel planning & booking, the revamped platform focuses on delivering an intuitive user experience. The new platform's optimized workflows have resulted in measurable improvements in booking speed in comparison of data of 1st and 2nd fortnight of the month. Recent data indicate a more than 5% increase in bookings completed within the 3-minute tatkal window & a 3% rise in the 5-minute tatkal booking window and over a 2% increase in the 30-minute window, demonstrating the platform's ability to facilitate quicker booking experience. Furthermore, the online ticket booking system has significantly offloaded the PRS by providing a comprehensive digital platform.

**GNN** Vikramaditya Singh Malik, Ghaziabad Municipal Commissioner recently held a meeting with the department officials to expedite house tax-related work. The municipal commissioner primarily discussed increasing house tax collections & raising awareness among taxpayers. Anirudh Singh, Chief Tax Assessment Officer; Jang Bahadur Yadav, Additional Municipal Commissioner; Zonal in-charges from all zones & other officials were also present in the meeting. The Municipal Commissioner stated that in order to increase house tax collection & ensure the convenience of citizens, a detailed meeting was held with the team regarding the software update process. Besides, the team was instructed to update the software wherein taxpayers will be able to view their current, past house tax accounts & ledgers. GMC has also decided to increase the number of e-POS machines in all wards. The concerned team has been asked to complete the implementation of these instructions within a week.

**UJVNL DEHRADUN** UJVNL Ltd becomes the highest corporate Income Tax contributor among Uttarakhand State PSUs. In recognition of this outstanding accomplishment, the company was honoured at a special ceremony organised on the occasion of the 167th Income Tax Day. On behalf of MD of UJVNL Ltd, Mr. Ajay Kumar Singh, the award was received by DGM Anupam Gupta & Vinod Nainwal along with other officials. Ajay Kumar Singh said that UJVNL Ltd paid Rs 124 crore as corporate income tax for the Financial Year 2025-26, the highest amount contributed by any State Government PSU in Uttarakhand. Furthermore, the company has been earning profits and registering remarkable year-on-year growth in its annual turnover and overall financial performance. The Corporation's financial strength continues to improve steadily.



**MUTHOOT** Dr. Sara Gerge Muthoot, Director of St. George's School, Paul George Global School, New Delhi & The Muthoot Group was conferred the prestigious JANANI National Award 2026 for Excellence in Business Leadership at JANANI. The award was presented by the Hon. CM of Kerala, V.D. Satheesan, in presence of eminent dignitaries, policymakers, educationists, industry leaders and changemakers from across the country. Dr. Sara George Muthoot exemplifies this philosophy through her visionary leadership, unwavering commitment to excellence and steadfast dedication to nation-building through education.



**POWERGRID** Hon. Prime Minister of India, Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for one transmission project & dedicated two significant transmission projects of Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd. S. Abdul Nazeer, Hon. Governor of Andhra Pradesh; Pusapati Ashok Gajapathi Raju, Hon. Governor of Goa; N. Chandrababu Naidu, Hon. CM of Andhra Pradesh; K. Pawan Kalyan, Hon. DCM of Andhra Pradesh & other officials were also present at the event. The PM dedicated two key transmission projects implemented by POWERGRID including the transmission system for Kurnool wind energy zone/solar energy zone (AP) – part-A & part-B, developed at an investment of approximately Rs 3,547 crore, & the transmission system for solar energy zones in Ananthpuram (2,500 MW) & Kurnool (1,000 MW), developed at an investment of approximately Rs 823 crore. These projects have been developed to facilitate the evacuation of renewable energy and for a seamless transfer to beneficiaries across the National Grid.



**NCC** recently organised a Cyclothon in New Delhi to commemorate 79 years of India's Independence. The initiative aimed to inspire the youth to embrace fitness, environmental responsibility, & sustainable living while reinforcing the core values of patriotism, discipline, unity, & national service that form the foundation of the National Cadet Corps. The cyclothon was flagged off by the Union Minister of Youth Affairs & sports, Mansukh Mandaviya, in the presence of the Minister of State for Defence, Sanjay Seth, renowned boxer MC Mary Kom and renowned tennis player Leander Paes. The event commenced from Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium and concluded at the same venue after successfully covering the designated route through prominent landmarks of the National Capital Organised under the theme "Clean India, Green India, Fit India". The event encouraged participants & the public to adopt cycling as an eco-friendly & sustainable mode of transport while promoting environmental conservation, reducing carbon emissions, and embracing healthy lifestyles.



**PNB** In a solemn ceremony, PNB handed over a personal accident insurance claim of Rs 1 Crore to Smt. Sunita Malik, wife of Late Shri Dharmendra Kumar Malik (Inspector, Uttarakhand Police), following his tragic demise in a road accident. Shri Malik maintained his salary account under the PNB Rakshak Salary Scheme at the Survey of India Branch, Dehradun, which provides comprehensive financial protection to defense and police personnel. The claim was settled in the presence of Shri Anupam (Zonal Head), Shri Abhinandan Singh (Circle Head), along with other senior dignitaries from the Uttarakhand Police and PNB. We express our deepest condolences to the family and remain committed to serving those who serve the nation.

**CONCOR** Shri Ajit Kumar Panda has taken over the charge of Chairman & Managing Director, Container Corporation of India Ltd., a Schedule 'A' Navratna CPSE. An officer of Indian Railway Service of Mechanical Engineers (1990 batch), Shri Panda has a wide spectrum of expertise ranging from railway operations, infrastructure, production, logistics and public-private partnership. Previous to this appointment as CMD, Shri Panda has been Director (Projects & Services), CONCOR, Executive Director, RVNL, Director, Railway Board and Chief Works Manager, Mancheswar Railway Workshop. He is a graduate of NIT Rourkela and M. Tech from IIT Delhi.



**GDA** will conduct an e-lottery for the allotment of 350 residential plots under the Madhuban Bapudham Housing Scheme. The application process for the scheme was conducted through the Janhit Portal from May 11, 2026 to June 4, 2026 and will be held on August 19th and 20th. The e-lottery is conducted to ensure transparent & fair allotment based on the received applications. The e-lottery will be conducted at Hindi Bhawan, Lohiya Nagar, Ghaziabad, in the presence of a committee constituted as per the instructions of the VC, GDA. The e-lottery process will begin at 11:30 am on both days. The GDA has appealed to all applicants to obtain information and results related to the e-lottery only through the official channels issued by the Authority.

**USTM** has achieved a significant milestone with the grant of recognition under section 12 (B) of the UGC Act, 1956. This landmark recognition further reinforces USTM's position as one of the leading private universities in Northeast India and opens new avenues for academic growth, research, innovation, and institutional development. The UGC 12(B) recognition enables the University to become eligible for various UGC- funded schemes, research grants, academic development programmes, faculty development initiatives, and collaborative projects, thereby enhancing opportunities for students, faculty members, and researchers. Expressing his happiness, Mahbubul Hoque, Hon. Chancellor of USTM, said "I congratulate every student, faculty member, staff, alumnus, and stakeholder who has contributed to this remarkable achievement".

**IREDA** has announced its un-audited standalone and consolidated financial results for the Quarter ended 30 th June 2026, showcasing significant growth across several financial metrics. In the first quarter of FY 2026-27, the company reported a strong financial performance. Profit after tax rose by 37 per cent to Rs 337 crore from Rs 247 crore in the same period last year. Revenue from operations increased by 15 per cent to Rs 2,250 crore, while the loan book grew by 19 per cent to Rs 94,936 crore. Net worth also strengthened, rising 14 per cent to Rs 14,133 crore. Reflecting improved asset quality, the net NPA ratio declined to 1.23 per cent from 2.06 per cent a year ago. Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty, CMD & Director (Finance), IREDA, said: "Our Q1 FY27 performance reflects the continued strength of IREDA's business fundamentals and focus on quality growth".

**SCOPE** organised an interactive programme titled 'A Framework for Stress-Free Working' addressed by Sunil Bajpai, Principal Chief Commissioner, Income Tax & Atul Sobti, DG, SCOPE. Dr. Vasundhara Upmanyu, JS, DPE was also present. The programme included a special presentation by Bajpai & aimed to equip executives with actionable tools to cultivate a balanced, healthy, & stress-free work environment. Over 60 senior officials from several Public Sector Enterprises participated in the programme. Through its various endeavors and unique programs, SCOPE continues to cultivate overall wellness and holistic development, reinforcing its ongoing commitment to building a motivated, healthy, and highly productive workforce for the nation.



**CCIC** Secretary (Textiles) Neelam Shami Rao inaugurated the 'Weaves of India' festival at CCIC in the presence of senior officials from the Ministry of Textiles & CCIC. Showcasing 116 traditional handloom weaves from across India, the exhibition celebrates the country's rich weaving heritage through sarees, shawls, home linen, bags & durries. National award-winning weavers are interacting with visitors, demonstrating traditional techniques and encouraging support for India's master weavers and indigenous crafts.





EPL clubs  
junk gambling  
sponsorships,  
says report



Aston Villa had made a controversial agreement with Visit Rwanda. REUTERS

Reuters  
August 7

AS ENGLISH Premier League clubs bid goodbye to gambling front-of-shirt sponsors, a diverse new group of commercial partners including sovereign investors and fintech firms are stepping in, Nielsen said in a new report.

In 2023, Premier League clubs collectively agreed to stop featuring gambling sponsorship on the front of soccer kits, with the agreement taking effect from the start of the 2026-27 season.

"With the enforcement of the voluntary collective ban on front-of-shirt gambling partnerships, the landscape that has defined the last decade is being fundamentally rewritten," Nielsen wrote in its report published on Thursday.

"New analysis from Nielsen Sports has today revealed that while the 'Betting Era' is drawing to a close, a more diverse and strategically complex phase is emerging, dictated by massive software conglomerates, sovereign investment, and the continued rise of fintech."

The report highlighted Crystal Palace's agreement with AI and enterprise technology system Temporal, Aston Villa's controversial agreement with Visit Rwanda and Everton's partnership with financial services company CMC Markets as examples of the shift.

"For challenger organisations, particularly in fintech and AI, sponsorship is being used to build global credibility at scale," said Andy Milnes, Nielsen's market lead for sports in Britain and Ireland.

"While the exit of gambling logos creates a short-term financial gap for some, it opens the door for a more diverse commercial ecosystem.

"The challenge for clubs now is to move beyond reporting historical deal values and toward proactive analysis that attracts these emerging industry giants."

While the Premier League's current ban does not apply to shirt sleeves and training kits, Britain is also considering further regulations to prevent unlicensed gambling companies from sponsoring sports teams in any way.

"We anticipate a secondary 'Tech Gold Rush' where software infrastructure firms become the dominant FOS category by 2028," Milnes added.

WARM-UP MATCH

# Sri Lanka rack up runs but Brar, Suthar stake claim for Test series

Pacer, spinner emerge as contenders for spots in playing XI after opening day

Shankar Narayan  
Mumbai, August 7

INDIA ARRIVED in Colombo with only one warm-up match before the two-Test series against Sri Lanka starting on August 15, leaving little time to settle the two biggest selection questions in their bowling attack: who partners Mohammed Siraj in Jasprit Bumrah's absence, and who shares the spin workload with Ravindra Jadeja. At the end of the opening day of the three-day warm-up match against the Sri Lanka Cricket XI at the Nondescripts Cricket Club on Friday, Gurnoor Brar and Manav Suthar had strengthened their respective cases, while Prasidh Krishna struggled to make a positive impression.

Sri Lanka Cricket XI finished on 363/8 in 90 overs, with Nishan Fernando's fluent 66 and Ravindu Rasantha's authoritative 71 laying the platform through a commanding 110-run opening stand before captain Sonal Dinusha anchored the middle phase with a composed 52.

Although India fought back steadily through the afternoon and evening sessions, the hosts ensured the visitors had to work hard in sultry conditions that tested every bowling option under consideration.

The strongest audition for the second seamer's role came from Brar, who looked increasingly threatening as the ball aged. After producing the day's biggest lbw appeal in the opening session without success, the right-arm returned with greater rhythm and purpose, exploiting bounce and angles to repeatedly discomfort the batsmen. His sustained barrage of short-pitched bowling unsettled Dinusha, who was struck on the gloves, beaten for pace and repeatedly forced onto the back foot, struggling to handle the steep bounce.

Brar eventually earned his reward by forcing Pavan Rathnayake into a miscued hook before continuing to beat the outside edge with the older ball. Even during the final session, he found late movement, extracted steep bounce and regularly drew uncertain responses from the batsmen. His figures of 1/49 in 12 overs understated the sustained pressure he created and arguably strengthened his case to partner Siraj in Galle.

Siraj extracted seam movement and awkward bounce with disciplined lengths during the morning, twice surprising Rasantha with steep lift, and later returned with a hostile spell featuring sharp bouncers that repeatedly hurried the lower order. Although boundaries occasionally came off shorter deliveries, he probed away across all three sessions, repeatedly asking questions that deserved greater reward than the scorebook ultimately showed.

Prasidh, by contrast, endured a mixed day that is unlikely to strengthen his claim. He struggled for consistency in his opening spell, offering scoring opportunities with overpitched deliveries and width before tightening his lengths after lunch. There were occasional deliveries that jagged back into the right-handers, but he lacked sustained penetration and rarely looked capable of breaking partnerships, particularly compared to Siraj and Brar. On a surface that rewarded patience, Prasidh never quite settled into the disciplined rhythm India would have wanted.

### Spinner slots

The contest for the second spinner's berth — in case India plays three fast bowlers — also tilted firmly in Suthar's favour. Given a longer spell in the morning session than Kuldeep Yadav, the left-arm spinner



Gurnoor Brar looked more threatening as the ball aged. CREIMAS

### Gill skips Day 1 due to finger injury

INDIA CAPTAIN Shubman Gill did not take the field on the opening day of the practice match against SLC XI after sustaining an injury to his right finger during practice. Gill picked up the niggle during a training session on Thursday and as result, KL Rahul is leading the side in his absence. PTI

showcased the attributes that have impressed selectors. He generated drift, overspin and bounce, repeatedly luring batsmen forward before dismissing the well-set Rasantha with a teasingly flighted delivery that induced a miscued lofted drive.

Reintroduced only in the 88th over after not bowling since the 54th, Suthar immediately struck again, trapping Dinusha lbw with one that kept

low, finishing with impressive figures of 13-1-33-2.

### Kuldeep's moments

Kuldeep enjoyed moments of promise but lacked Suthar's control across a long spell. The wrist-spinner consistently mixed his pace, produced sharp turn and repeatedly deceived batsmen with the wrong'un, collecting two wickets after tea, including Ahan Wickramasinghe off a top-edged



Manav Suthar (right) celebrates a Sri Lankan wicket with Ravindra Jadeja. CREIMAS

sweep and Anjala Bandara lbw. However, he also released too many boundary balls whenever he erred in length, allowing the batsmen to sweep and drive with confidence. His figures of 18-0-76-2 reflected both his wicket-taking ability and his inconsistency.

Jadeja underlined why he remains India's first-choice spinner. He maintained relentless accuracy, extracting drift and occasional turn while creating pressure with dot balls before removing Pasindu Sooriyabandara and later inducing Ramesh Mendis into edging to slip. He finished with 14-2-64-2, complementing Suthar effectively as India's spinners assumed control once the ball softened.

With two days remaining, there is still time for the challengers to alter the pecking order. But after the opening day's evidence, Brar and Suthar have taken an early lead in the race for the remaining bowling spots.

**BRIEF SCORES: Sri Lanka Cricket XI 363/8 in 90 overs (Ravindu Rasantha 71, Nishan Fernando 66, Sonal Dinusha 52; Manav Suthar 2/33, Ravindra Jadeja 2/64, Kuldeep Yadav 2/76, Gurnoor Brar 1/49) vs India.**

BRIEFLY



Arjun Erigaisi will compete under the banner of Gen.G Esports. CGM

### Four Indian Grandmasters eye Esports World Cup glory in Paris

INDIAN GRANDMASTERS Nihal Sarin, Aravindh Chithambaram, Pranesh M and Arjun Erigaisi are set to battle it out against a tough field, including world number one Magnus Carlsen, in the chess competition of the Esports World Cup, to be held here from August 11 to 15. Nihal, Aravindh, and Pranesh, representing esports and gaming content powerhouse S8UL Esports, will be joined by Grandmaster Arjun Erigaisi, who will compete under the banner of Gen.G Esports. Together, they will be eyeing a share of the USD 1.5 million (Rs 14.2 crore) prize pool against an elite field led by defending champion Carlsen (Team Liquid). He will be joined by Hikaru Nakamura and Alireza Firouzja (Team Falcons), Nodirbek Abdusattorov (Natus Vincere), Hans Moke Niemann (GodLike Esports), alongside several other Grandmasters from around the world. PTI

### Mandaviya seeks on-camera trials for major events

SPORTS MINISTER Mansukh Mandaviya on Friday stressed on the need for on-camera selection trials before major international events such as the Asian Games and reduced dependence on foreign coaches as he took stock of the National Sports Federations' operations at a conclave here. He said India urgently needs a strong indigenous coaching ecosystem to counter the reliance on foreign coaches, who have got high-profile positions in sports such as shooting, and boxing. "We need to build a repository of quality Indian coaches. Along with training athletes, we must invest equally in training our coaches by providing them the best opportunities and international exposure," Mandaviya said. PTI

### Ashfaq breaks U20 national record in 400m

MOHOMMED ASHFAQ broke the U20 national record to qualify for the men's 400m semifinals while Amanat Kamboj finished sixth in women's discus throw finals with a personal best effort on the second day of the World Athletics U20 Championships in Eugene. The 19-year-old Ashfaq clocked 45.81 seconds to finish second behind USA's Jayden DeLeon (45.63s) in the first round heat 5 and fourth overall to make it to the semifinals. Ashfaq bettered his own previous national record of 46.05 seconds, set earlier this season in April. Compatriot Piyyush Raj, however, failed to proceed after finishing fifth in Heat 6 and 35th overall with a time of 47.78 seconds. PTI

### England striker Toney charged with assault

ENGLAND STRIKER Ivan Toney has been charged with assault at a Soho nightclub, London's Metropolitan Police said on Friday, with the 30-year-old due in court next month. The charge relates to an assault that allegedly took place on December 6 last year at a nightclub on Wardour Street. "Ivan Toney, 30, of Northampton, was charged on Thursday, 31 July with assault causing actual bodily harm," the police said in a statement. "He will appear at Westminster Magistrates' Court on Thursday, 24 September." Toney plays for Saudi Pro League club Al-Ahli and scored 42 goals last season. REUTERS

### East Bengal FC keep quarters hopes alive

EAST BENGAL FC gave a dazzling display to score a comprehensive 5-0 victory over South United FC in their final Group A match of the Durand Cup, keeping their quarterfinal hopes alive in the tournament. Dani Ramirez (6'), Mohamad Basim Rashid (24'), Hardik Bhatt (73'), Bipin Singh (81') and David Lahliansanga (90+5') scored for the Red and Gold Brigade. The result took East Bengal FC to six points from three Group A games, leaving them comfortably placed in the race to qualify for the quarterfinals as one of the tournament's best second-placed teams. South United FC concluded their campaign with the heavy defeat. PTI

# Brook's time will come as Test Captain: McCullum

Express News Service  
New Delhi, August 7

BRENDON MCCULLUM has said that Harry Brook's "time will come" as Test captain, even as he threw his weight behind the return of Joe Root as England's red-ball skipper. Brook, the Three Lions' ODI and T20I leader, was Test vice-captain when Ben Stokes suddenly announced his shock retirement, yet was overlooked for captaincy.

"Everyone knows the affection that I have for Harry," white-ball head coach McCullum told *Sky Sports*. "He's a wonderful player and he's doing a fine job as white-ball leader. I think his time will come in the Test job."

McCullum added, "I'm looking forward to working with him and hopefully grow-

ing and developing him into the leader that he can become. At some stage in the future, he will have a very important role in that capacity. But for now, Joe will do an amazing job."

The England Cricket Board (ECB) sacked the former New Zealand wicketkeeper-batter as Test coach in July after a string of poor results in the longest format and off-field episodes — the latest one being Stokes' breach of curfew that led to his suspension for the second Test against New Zealand.

Stephen Fleming has since replaced McCullum as England Test head coach, and the Kiwi voiced his support for his compatriot and "close mate". "I had a great time in my four years but now it's going in a different direction. I think Flem (Fleming) will be excellent," McCullum said.



England Test vice-captain Harry Brook (right) was overlooked for the lead role, while Brendon McCullum was sacked as Test coach. AP

"He's a little bit like me, but better — that's how I would sum him up. He'll do a great job, and the ECB have done incredibly well to get someone like him to commit to English cricket for

the period that he has. It's an outstanding achievement."

Fleming, however, will not be available for the Pakistan series and Marcus Trescothick will be the interim coach. The

53-year-old is currently spending time with family, and his first assignment will be the tour of South Africa in December.

"We talk pretty much every day, we're close mates," McCullum said of Fleming. "We've done a lot together and he's one of those guys who I trust completely. We both just want what's best for English cricket. We want to set this up so that English cricket can be successful across all three formats of the game."

"That is going to take some give and take at times, we both understand that, but we will work very closely together and give everyone the best opportunity to get the success that we all want to see."

Earlier, England's squad for the first Test was announced with Ollie Pope and Dan Lawrence recalled to the side.

REVOLUTION BEARS FRUIT

# Foreign expertise, better systems power India's CWG judo breakthrough

Prithish Raj  
New Delhi, August 7

INDIAN JUDOKAS recorded the best medal haul at the Commonwealth Games (CWG) 2026 with two gold, one silver and one bronze. This was the first time Indian judokas had won a gold medal at the CWG.

The historic medal haul came despite the Judo Federation of India functioning under an interim body. The body held elections last month in July after a four-year delay. The CWG medal haul comes on the back of a historic bronze medal at the Asian Championships earlier this year won by Takhellambam Inunganbi.

However, the improvement among the Indian judokas is not a sudden result but a gradual growth story, after

an investment in foreign coaches, tougher training regimes, and a focus on nutrition and rehabilitation.

Three of the medal-winning judokas, Harsh Singh (gold in men's 60kg), Yamini Mourya (silver in women's 57kg), and Unnati Sharma (bronze in women's 63kg), belong to the Judo campus program of IIS headed by British combat sport expert Gary Hall.

"We are really pleased with the progress of the judo program. We have a new coaching structure with both foreign and Indian coaches, and along with focus on physiotherapy, the results are visible now," Gary told *The Indian Express*.

Gary, a former Taekwondo athlete, joined Inspire Institute in Bellary after leading the GB Karate team to major

international success, including ten Olympic medals through his high-performance program. "Indian combat athletes, especially judokas, have all the talent and they are skilled on the mat, but they need to improve on their tactical acumen. There are certain improvements, but it will become better once Indians compete more at the global level," said Gary.

### Sudden popularity

28-year-old Yamini, who won the silver medal, didn't expect that the medal would bring her this much attention. "Judo has grown in the last four years. I didn't know that the medal would make me so popular. It was just a judo competition for me, and I wanted to win the medal," Yamini said.



Yamini Mourya (left) and Harsh Singh bagged CWG medals in the women's 57kg and men's 60kg categories, respectively. PTI

Yamini attributed the professionalism brought in Judo as one of the reasons. "I have been doing Judo for a long time. But one thing that has changed after I joined IIS is the



professionalism in nutrition, training regime, and diet," she said. "Before joining the program, I had no idea about the importance of nutrition or recovery after a training session.

**The historic medal haul came despite the Judo Federation of India functioning under an interim body**

These are the things that have made us better than before."

Harsh, the first Indian male judoka to win gold at the CWG, was a promising national-level player, but after joining IIS, his mindset and technique both improved massively. "I think I was doing well before joining IIS at the national level. However, once I joined, I realised how different it is to compete at the elite level," said Harsh.

"I have been working with

a foreign coach, which has resulted in my improvement and technique being much better than before," said Harsh. "Also, the recovery and rehabilitation from injuries are much better now as compared to before," he added further.

### Need more exposure

While the medal haul is a good reflection of India's improvement, the quality is still far away from the global or the continental level.

"We need more fights at the international level. Right now, we don't have enough sparring partners in India. Once we go to international camps, we also learn from the athletes of other nations. I think the next step is for us to get more exposure at the international level," explained Harsh.

Gary concurs with his ward on the international exposure, but he also points out that India needs to develop a culture for Judo. "Combat sports like Judo come from culture," said Gary. He cites the example of France. "France adopted Judo, and nobody expected them to become this good. But the reason they are good is because of the culture of Judo clubs and kids doing it regardless of thinking of it as a career," said Gary.

Gary is confident that the show at CWG is just a teaser of the good times that could come for Indian judo. "This is the result of a good system that looks at holistic development. Indian judokas are talented, and I think the good times for Indian judo are coming now," concluded Gary.



Vini Jr extends contract with Madrid till 2032



Vinicius Junior. AP

Express News Service  
New Delhi, August 7

AFTER MONTHS of a will he, won't he-saga, Brazilian forward Vinicius Jr pledged his future to Spanish giants Real Madrid after agreeing to a contract extension till 2032. With that, rumours of him going to Premier League champions Arsenal were put to rest.

"Real Madrid C.F. and Vinicius Jr. have agreed on the extension of our player's contract, which links him to the club until June 30, 2032," the club said in a statement on Thursday night. Vinicius has scored 128 goals in 375 matches since joining Madrid at age 18 and has helped the club win 14 titles, including La Liga three times and the Champions League twice.

"His contribution to all these titles has been pivotal due to his gameplay, assists, and goals, including those scored in the last two Champions League finals won by Real Madrid: the Fourteenth (Paris, 2022) and the Fifteenth (London, 2024)," the club wrote further.

Financial terms of the extension were not disclosed.

Vinicius wrote on Instagram: "Eight years at the Bernabeu are too few... 6 more years, and forever!" Los Blancos enter the 2026-27 season with a new coach – Jose Mourinho, for a second stint – and renewed expectations among fans.

He is set to work under Jose Mourinho for the first time after the Portuguese coach returned for a second spell in charge at Real in June.

The appointment followed a disappointing campaign for the record 15-time European champions, who finished runners-up to arch-rivals Barcelona in La Liga, exited the Champions League in the quarter-finals and ended the season without a major trophy.

Tying down Vinicius represents another significant step in an active summer for Real.

The club have also strengthened their squad with the arrivals of winger Yan Dione, midfielder Bernardo Silva, Ibrahima Konate, left back Marc Cucurella and wing back Denzel Dumfries for the season.

RAPID AND BLITZ CHAMPION

Classicist Pragg finds his short-form tunes

He termed the St Louis triumph as his finest feat in Rapid and Blitz

Mayank Chaudhary  
New Delhi, August 7

"I DON'T remember winning a strong Rapid and Blitz event in the last few years. In fact, ever." That admission from R Pragg-nanandhaa after his St Louis triumph revealed a little more than just surprise. He is a man who has beaten the best in Classical chess. At Norway Chess, Tata Steel Masters, the London Classic, GCT Romania or the UzChess Cup, the titles kept coming his way. But the faster formats had always been a blind spot. Until Friday, when the Indian Grandmaster finally bridged the gap, winning the Grand Chess Tour's Saint Louis Rapid & Blitz event in what he called "the best Rapid and Blitz performance that I've shown."

With the margins so narrow and the field so stacked, it was Praggnanandhaa's clinical consistency that stood out. Ever since he seized the lead on Day 1 after three rounds of Rapid and never let it slip, not even when Javokhir Sindarov and Wesley So turned the heat up.

After ending the penultimate day on top, holding a 1.5-point lead over Sindarov and a 3-point cushion over So, he kept holding on to his lead on the final day even as the Uzbek rival came agonisingly close. His day may have started slowly, with Sindarov shrinking the gap to just 0.5, but the Indian never squandered his grip on the title race, winning the event with a round to spare.

While he stopped short of calling it a domination, he was in control throughout the event. "I don't think it was a domination as such because the fight was still on almost till the very end. If I'd lost to Javokhir, then there was still a lot of fight in the last game. I believe there were some moments that went my way, but overall I like to believe I played quite well and managed to keep control in most of the games, so that's good," he told Chessbase India.

Pragg's Blitz campaign had a method to the madness. He played safe, sharing points in eight games against Sindarov, So, Aronian, and Caruana, four players who finished just behind him in the Blitz standings.

Against the bottom four ranked players, he cashed in ruthlessly, accumulating seven points from eight games with Real Creator IAS Edition https://



R Praggnanandhaa won St Louis Rapid and Blitz title on Friday. LENNART OOTES/ST LOUIS RAPID AND BLITZ  
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD\_RGf9mljMzg1

E. EXPLAINED

What is Grand Chess Tour?

The Grand Chess Tour is an elite circuit spanning Classical, Rapid, and Blitz events with a \$2 million (19 cr) prize pool. The top four players in the season standings qualify for the GCT finals, a knockout event where the year's best compete for the title. Praggnanandhaa sits second in the GCT standings after his Saint Louis win, just half a point behind Caruana. With the Sinquefeld Cup remaining, a solid performance there will confirm his spot in the finals for the second straight year. From there, he will have a shot at the overall title, a prize no Indian has ever won. ENS

six wins.

The title not only filled Praggnanandhaa's pocket with \$50,000 (approx. ₹47.5 lakh) but also earned him 13 Grand Chess Tour points for finishing as the sole leader. The haul thrust him into second place on the GCT leaderboard, just half a point behind Fabiano Caruana. With that, he is now primed to qualify for the tour finals for the second consecutive year.

Consistency code

Ever since the high of 2024, when Indian chess produced the youngest-ever world champion in D. Gukesh and the country claimed a historic

I don't remember winning a strong Rapid and Blitz event in the last few years. In fact, ever."

R PRAGGNANANDHA, ON WINNING ST LOUIS CHESS

double gold at the Olympiad, the question has lingered: can India match that high again?

Renewed enthusiasm and a string of strong performances made that hope feel anything but meaningless. But the months that followed told a different story, with the Indian men's chess team hitting a quiet patch. The home World Cup ended without a podium finish, the Cyprus Candidates proved disappointing, and Gukesh's form took a noticeable dip.

Amid the quiet, one family has continued to shine. The brother-sister duo of R Vaishali and Praggnanandhaa have kept the light burning. It began with Vaishali stunning the world by winning the Candidates, becoming the first Indian woman to do so and earning the right to challenge Ju Wenjun for the world title.

Praggnanandhaa could not match his sister's feat in the parallel Open event, crumbling under expectations in his second Candidates appearance. But he continues to prove that he is India's most reliable name on the big stage.

Timed to perfection

Pragg's scintillating form has come at the perfect time for

India. In a little over a month, the team will defend their Olympiad gold medal on Uzbekistan's home soil in Samarkand, where a formidable challenge awaits from the hosts, the USA, and China.

The Olympiad has traditionally been Gukesh's hunting ground. The world champion has made the event his own, obliterating opponents and racing to individual gold medals on the top board in both 2022 and 2024.

He was the driving force behind India's gold medal charge in Budapest. But form is a fragile thing, and right now, Gukesh is enduring one of the lowest phases of his career. That makes India's path to glory far less certain.

Arjun Erigaisi has been a model of consistency, but a maiden big-ticket title remains elusive. Nihal Sarin, for all his talent, is yet to make a defining mark in Classical chess. The weight of expectation, then, falls squarely on Praggnanandhaa.

His Olympiad journey, in a way, reflects India's rise. He played on Board 3 in 2022, Board 2 in Budapest and now, with Gukesh enduring a lean patch, there is a real possibility that Praggnanandhaa could be asked to spearhead India on Board 1 ahead of Gukesh or Arjun.

The Sinquefeld Cup awaits Praggnanandhaa next, the last Classical stop before the Olympiad. His performance in the final GCT event will be watched closely, not just by him, but by a nation hoping for momentum heading into Samarkand.

Rakshitha Sree, the shuttler beating India's next big stars

Shivani Naik  
Mumbai, August 7

IN THE grand jostle of India's next big thing in women's singles badminton, Devika Sihag and Tanvi Sharma have taken the lead in 2026 with Super 300 titles. But there's a hidden gem in 19-year-old Coimbatore teen Rakshitha Sree Santhosh Ramraj, who enjoys a 4-0 head-to-head against Sharma and a 2-0 win-loss advantage over Sihag.

Ranked 9th best in India and 49th in the world, the Hyderabad-based shuttler, training at the Pullela Gopichand Academy for many years, is awaiting her breakthrough. "She needs that one big tournament with a title for her confidence. Maybe this is the week. The potential is enormous," coach B Sai Praneeth said, after she defeated last week's champion Tanvi Sharma at the Super 300 Korea Masters quarters. She plays the semis against compatriot Ashmita Chaliha on Saturday.

The 61-minute 18-21, 21-19, 21-18 battle wasn't devoid of a psychological edge. Tanvi, playing her 8th match in two weeks, actually played better than she has against Rakshitha before. The Taipei Super300 winner took the opener from 8-13 down. And she did well to get into striking range, raising the ante from 13-15 down in the second to leading 17-16. But Rakshitha has that knack to impose her effortless stroke-making on a cliffhanging match. She played the decisive rallies better to tease out an escape and push a decider.

In the third, once again, Tanvi's errors into the net - unforced but not entirely unprovoked - gave Rakshitha the 4-point surge to break the 15-all deadlock and race to the win.

"I'm not concerned about Rakshitha's win-losses in terms of her game. The game is there," Sai Praneeth says, "what needs to get better is the body language when she is trailing." The coach was happy with how she dealt with being behind in points against Japanese Manami Suizu on Thursday, and how she navigated the tricky, nervy endgame phase against Tanvi.

Young players

"All these players are very young at 18/19. When they don't get points on court, they get nervous, body language at a crucial level stoops. It will come with experience, even for Tanvi. I just tell Rakshitha to play simple. It's easy for a coach to constantly say, but it's tough for players," he says of all the previous times Rakshitha hasn't converted and fallen behind in the Indian race.

"I just tell her, 'be ready' for the next point. 2/3 mistakes happen, it's ok, not the end of



Rakshitha Sree defeated Tanvi Sharma (below) in 61-minute battle to enter the semifinal of the Korea Masters. BAI



the world. She has good strokes and power, decent speed. Tanvi's negatives also came from pressure. Happens," he explains.

Electric smash

Rakshitha has evolved into a player with an eclectic smash. It's a power-hit, smoothly executed with deceptive menace. Coaches have consistently drilled into her the need to stay aggressive, something that doesn't come easy to her. In comical precedent, Rakshitha would smash the shuttle, burying it in the court, turn around, and let out a belated, lame shriek prompted by the coaches, saying, "I forget to yell sometimes," she had once said.

Sai Praneeth understands and relates to the confidence deficit.

"When she's playing well, she has aggression. But if trailing, her irritation with the court drift would show on her face. So we are changing that. Every player gets annoyed; the trick is to not show it. I learnt late too," he recalls with a laugh about transparent Indian faces giving away their dismay.

"She needs to understand otherwise she will lose the next 2-3 points!" he says.

9 Indian women find themselves in the Top 52, besides PV Sindhu, to make up one-fifth of the top tier.

Their average age is 19. It's

E. EXPLAINED

The coaches for All-India matches

Ashmita vs Rakshitha was to be a Round 1 match, but two seeded pullouts shuffled the draw a day before the Korea Masters began. Since Rakshitha is not on the national team yet due to her lower ranking, Indian national coaches are permitted to sit for All-India matches - so Sai Praneeth and Park fetched up (for Tanvi), though they were absent when Shriyanshi Valishetty played Tanvi. Against Ashmita, it'll once more be a battle of nerves, but also two of Indian badminton's best smashing swerves. ENS

meant Rakshitha has had to patiently watch teammates like Sharma hit the headlines, while she hasn't made a deeper run yet, despite being rated high by coaches and beating peers in matchups.

"It's obvious she has felt disappointed with herself when you see others go on to win. It's not about envying them but wondering why she isn't getting wins. When Srikanth won, we would all wonder too, and that helped us raise our game. So, it's good Tanvi, Unnati do well so Rakshitha ups her game too," the coach says.

Rakshitha took a big call to move to Hyderabad for training, and her mother and sister shifted too. The talent was evident, but the temperament has taken time.

Saturday semis will see two attacking Indians have a go, with Ashmita's fine win over top seed Hina Akechi, another come-from-behind 20-22, 21-15, 21-19 win, where coach Park Tae Sang was in a state after she almost blew up a 18-11 lead in the decider.

Gauff backs gene-testing but criticises the animosity it creates

Reuters  
August 7

COCO GAUFF agrees with mandatory gene-testing in the name of fairness, but she also has concern about unintended consequences the Women's Tennis Association might be inviting around a polarizing, politicized topic.

Mandatory testing for the DNA segment known as the SRY gene was approved as part of the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics for all tennis participants. Gender-based screening is already part of the Olympic testing process in many other sports at the Games.

Track and field, boxing and winter skiing events are among the Olympic sports with governing bodies already over-seeing gender screening.

After defeating Kayla Day at the National Bank Open in Toronto on Wednesday, Gauff tried to sensitively share those concerns and the potential for a negative impact. "So, yes, I guess I kind of agree with trying to protect the fairness in women's sports," Gauff said. "But I also do not like the attack that it is creating," the 22-year-old continued. "People who don't really care, but just want to use this as a reason to attack the trans community. So I'm not really a big fan of that either."



Coco Gauff. REUTERS

cussed by athletes across sports in recent weeks, with multiple WNBA players weighing in on gender-related questions in news conference settings. Indiana Fever guard Sophie Cunningham can relate to Gauff's perspective. Cunningham said in a story published by ESPN last month that she wants to "protect young girls in the locker room," adding that "they shouldn't have to go against biological men" in competitive sports.

Fans in some opposing cities protested Cunningham's stance with their voices and signs in or around the arenas in

I kind of agree with trying to protect the fairness in women's sports. But I also do not like the attack that it is creating."

COCO GAUFF, ON GENE TESTING.

Portland, Chicago, Minnesota and Seattle.

Minnesota Lynx head coach Cheryl Reeve and Cunningham discussed the topic prior to the Fever-Lynx game in Minneapolis, a moment both later described as coming from a place of "love." "A lot of people hide behind screens and love that type of thing. She had stories about her point of view and I had stories about my point of view," Cunningham said. "We left with love and respect and I think that's what it's all about." Reeve said she felt it was necessary to clear up the framing of the public conversation around transgender athletes.

"It is not the case that we have quote 'biological men' in girls' locker rooms," Reeve said. "The way it's being phrased — the innuendo there — that somehow transgender women are predators of some kind in the locker room."

Norway FA demands Infantino's resignation

Reuters  
Stockholm, August 7

NORWEGIAN FOOTBALL Federation (NFF) President Lise Klaveness called for the resignation of FIFA President Gianni Infantino on Friday, saying that he no longer had the confidence of the football community. "He does not have the institutional trust required to govern FIFA stably in the times we are in. There is no going back for Gianni Infantino," Klaveness told reporters following the NFF's monthly board meeting.

"The international football cooperation is very much in trouble, and we must have a reason to get together now, and we want to ask the FIFA president to resign now."

The comments come amid the ongoing bitter conflict among governing bodies sparked by FIFA's abandoned proposal to sell a slice of the World Cup's commercial future, and the Norwegians are hoping that other UEFA countries will row in behind their call for Infantino to step down.

"We will see which other countries eventually join in, if that becomes the strategy from the UEFA board - we talk to them a lot, and they have to manage that, and you will have to ask them the question," Klaveness said. "We are not going to ask for an extraordinary (UEFA board) meeting, we will ask him to resign in our dialogue with FIFA."



FIFA's proposal to sell a part of World Cup's commercial rights, which was later abandoned, has made Infantino unpopular. REUTERS

The 45-year-old Klaveness, who is a qualified lawyer, began by going through a long list of concerns that the Norwegian FA has expressed to FIFA during her tenure, which began in March 2022.

Among them were questions around the awarding of tournaments, the inaugural FIFA peace prize that was awarded to U.S. President Donald Trump in December, and the overturning of a ban for American forward Folarin Balogun during the recent World Cup following a call from Trump.

As an outspoken critic of Infantino, Klaveness' name has been put forward as one of the

possible successors to the Swiss-Italian administrator, but she waved away speculation that she might stand for election. "I register these names, and that my name is also mentioned, that is registered. It's not a theme at all - we have no reason to comment on that or any other candidacy, nor are we ready for it," she said.

Klaveness later told Reuters that world football needs to move beyond "Game of Thrones" -- the fantasy TV drama known for its ruthless power struggles -- and focus on real governance reform in a sport she describes as being in "crisis". She said Norway did not vote for Infantino in the

As an outspoken critic of Infantino, Klaveness' name has been put forward as one of the possible successors to the Swiss-Italian administrator

2023 election and will not support him in March.

"It's very divided, very polarised. It's a crisis, really. And then we need a leader to gather this and he's not in a position to gather it now. So for the sake of football, we ask him to resign," Klaveness said. "Sometimes polarisation and crisis can be of use, but it's only of use if we can gather now around, not just 'Game of Thrones' and who should be here or there, but to actually implement this governance reform. But he cannot do it."

Looking ahead, Klaveness stressed that whoever leads FIFA next must focus on meaningful reform and ensure the organisation remains a governing body rather than competing commercially with its confederations. "Regardless of who will be re-elected or elected, it needs to be about real implementation of governance reforms now. It needs to be about lasting change, where the checks and balances also works," she said.

FA bans solid pitchside barriers after player's death

Reuters  
August 7

THE FA has banned solid pitchside barriers across the National League System following the death of former Arsenal academy player Billy Vigar, the governing body said on Friday.

The FA launched a review of the safety of walls and boundaries last year after the 21-year-old suffered a significant brain injury when he hit his head on a concrete barrier beside the pitch in the Isthmian League Premier Division game while playing for seventh-tier side Chichester City.

"Any existing solid brick, breeze block or concrete barriers must be removed as soon as reasonably practicable, or covered with suitable protection if they cannot be removed for structural reasons," read the statement.

"We have informed clubs at this level that they will be required to take action as a result of these changes."

The review was conducted by independent health and safety experts for the 2026-27 season, and the FA and Premier League will provide funding to help implement the changes.